THE OFFICIAL ART BOOK OF

ZERO-SUM: OMEN

DRAFT LAYOUT · v1.0





FOREWORD

Every number in this world is spinning. This book is about the people who live under them.

The Tally began as a question: what would a world look like if luck were a currency everyone could see? Our answer was a city that counts and a ring of lands that remember older ways of counting: thread, karma, contracts and books of the dead.

We built every style from that history. The brass of the Basilica, the scrap of the Remainder Wards, the gaudy charms of the street, the gold leaf of the fortunate few, and the painted, breathing lands beyond the gate.

The Zero-Sum: Omen team

"A WORLD WITHOUT LUCK IS A WORLD WITHOUT LOSS."

Comptroller Lucan Thale

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A ledger of the Tally, as drawn so far.

Page numbers in the corner of each spread. Placeholder stamps mark pass-1 art kept for layout; colour-key and design-figure stamps mark the designed stand-ins.

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PART I

FIXED ART SPEC

The numbers and rules every artist, modeller and animator works to (docs/ART_SPEC.md).

1. Art Direction v3: painted world, inked manga
2. Style frames: versus, impact, gag, manga page
3. Registers, line, shading, colour
4. Scale and proportion
5. Cameras and the battle stage
6. Light by land
7. Faction costume keys

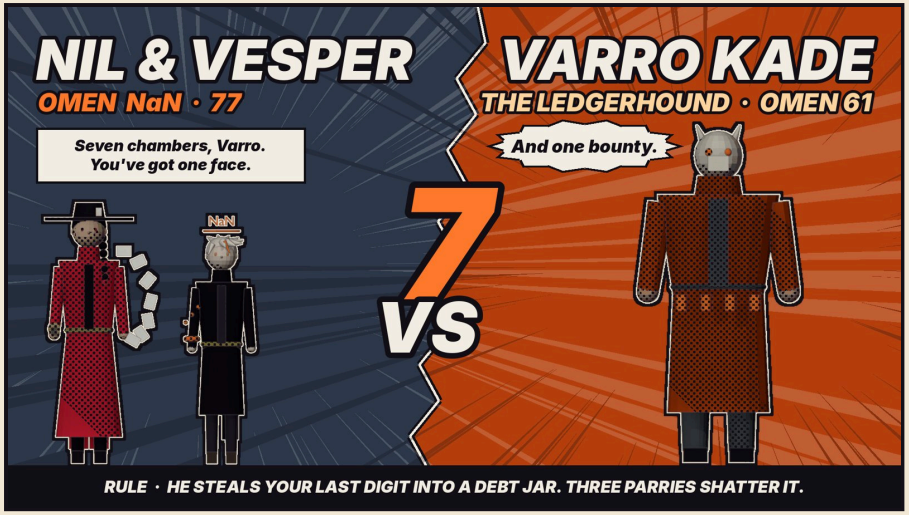
ART DIRECTION v3 · PAINTED WORLD, INKED MANGA

v2 stays (painted Ghibli-spirit worlds, Edgerunners-spirit people, Cyberpunk-art-book method). v3 adds a coloured-manga layer learned from the methods of Berserk, One Punch Man and versus-battle manga, with witty humour as a core register. Method, never likeness.

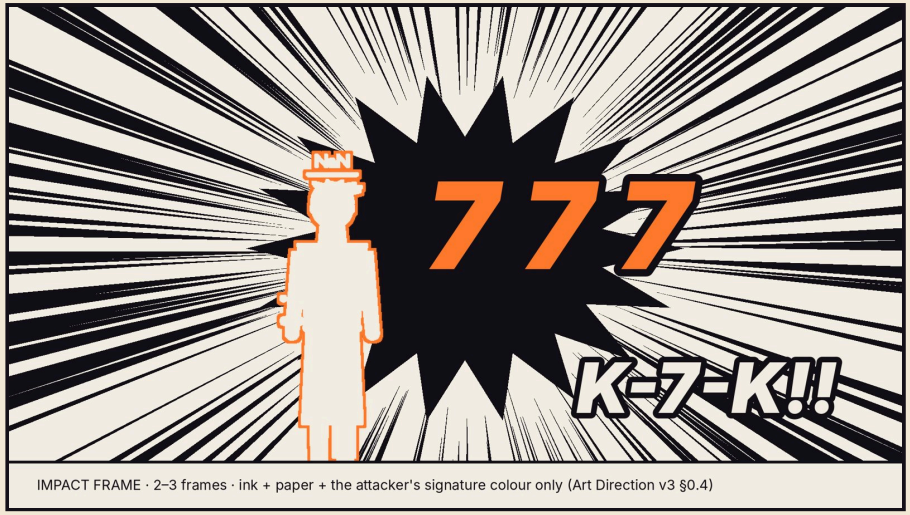
INFLUENCE	WHAT IT DOES	WHAT WE TAKE	WHAT WE NEVER TAKE
Berserk (Kentaro Miura)	Weight, scale and dread through ink: dense hatching, spotted blacks, monumental low-angle compositions, grit on every surface	Ink density as drama: bosses, the Basilica and Noise storms get hatching and heavy blacks; low angles that make Auditors feel huge; texture on armour, stone, brass	Gore, body horror, cruelty for its own sake (our rating is Teen); any character, armour or panel likeness
One Punch Man (Murata's art, ONE's writing)	Hyper-detailed, perfectly choreographed fights, then a deadpan gag face that deflates the whole spectacle; comedy and awe in the same chapter	Two registers (§0.2): spectacle drawn at full power, then a simplified deadpan beat; fight choreography you can follow panel to panel; scale shots with debris	Copying the bald-hero gag, costumes or specific panels
Versus-battle manga (the "VS" face-off tradition of fighting manga)	The face-off: two fighters split by a diagonal, names and stats, before the clash	The Versus card before every boss and duel (§0.5)	Real logos or game UIs
Cyberpunk 2077 / Edgerunners	Neon colour as emotion, era-based costume logic, kinetic impact frames	Kept from v2 (§2.2, §8): neon in Meridian and combat, eras, colour-step slow-mo	—
Ghibli backgrounds	Air, light and lived-in detail	Kept from v2 (§2.1): every land painted	—

	SERIOUS	GAG
Line	Full variable-weight ink; hatching in shadows; spotted blacks	Clean thin line, 30% of the detail
Faces	Full anatomy, sharp eyes, sweat and grit	Simplified: dot eyes, flat mouths, NIL's deadpan "..." face, Hina's chibi rage
Colour	Full cel (2 tones + rim) + screentone midtones	Flat fill, one tone, pastel background swap
Camera	Low angles, foreshortening, Dutch tilts	Flat, front-on, centred (the comedy of stillness)
Timing	Holds before impact, smear frames, impact frames	Hard cut, hold 0.6–1.0 s on the deadpan, then snap back

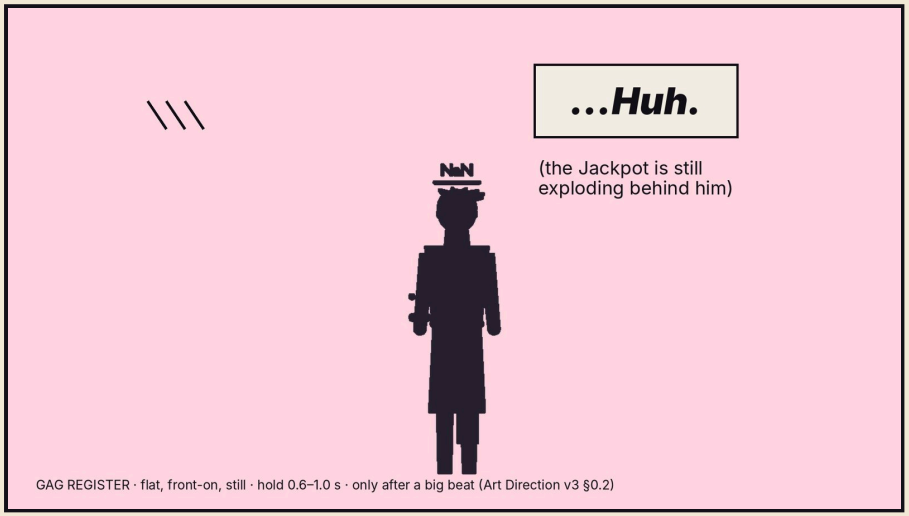
ART DIRECTION v3 · STYLE FRAMES



VERSUS CARD BEFORE EVERY BOSS (§0.5)



IMPACT FRAME: INK + PAPER + SIGNATURE COLOUR (§0.4)



GAG REGISTER: FLAT, FRONT-ON, STILL (§0.2)

Treatment studies built locally from the 3D blockouts (tools/style_frames_v3.py): screentone, heavy ink, speed lines, digit SFX and balloons. Final art redraws the figures by hand over these layouts.



CUTSCENES AS MANGA PAGES · FIGHT BEATS

Cutscenes are animated manga pages: panels slide in on beats, the camera pushes inside a panel, balloons pop with sound, one splash per scene. Cheap, deterministic in Unity Timeline, on-style.

BEAT	FRAMES (60 FPS)	VISUAL
Anticipation	6–10	Wind-up key pose, held; speed lines start converging
Smear	2–3	Smear frame with speed lines in the striker's colour
Impact frame	2–3	Full-screen inversion: black and paper-white plus the attacker's signature colour only; jagged burst shape; the stopped digit drawn huge in the burst
Hit-stop	5–13	Freeze on impact (GAME_FEEL §2) with screen shake
Aftermath	20–40	Debris silhouettes, dust with flat shadow, the enemy's Omen ticking down
Gag beat (optional)	36–60	Deadpan reaction in GAG register (e.g. Vesper blowing smoke off the barrel, NIL: "Fourteen.")

ART SPEC · REGISTERS, LINE, SHADING, COLOUR

REGISTER	FOR	LOOK
A · Concept / art book	Key art, store page, art book	Painterly semi-realistic concept art over 3D bases; human overpaint
B · In game	Gameplay, cutscenes, UI	Painted world (gouache backgrounds), inked people (flat cel, coloured lines)

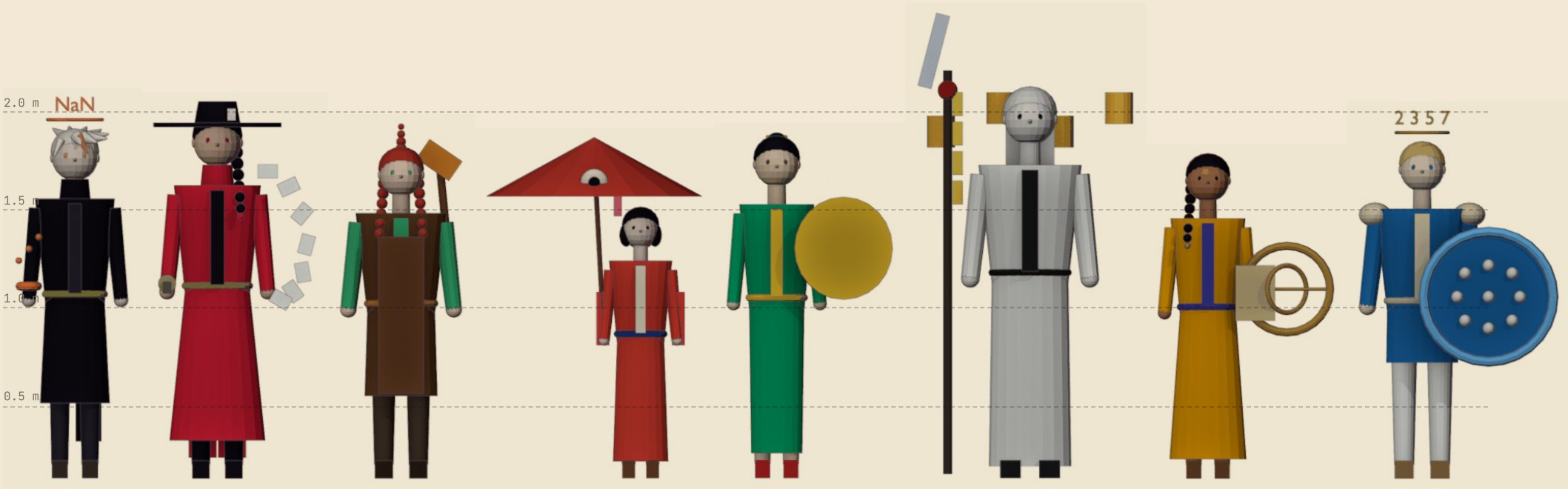
TURNAROUND STANDARD

- FRONT · LEFT · RIGHT · BACK, orthographic, one baseline, 1 m = 260 px
- Relaxed A-pose; props in their canon hand
- Every story outfit gets its own full turnaround
- Sheet extras: height bar, palette hex, canon locks, 64 px silhouette test

ELEMENT	RULE
Outer contour	4 px at 1080p for a 600 px-tall character (scale linearly); tapered at ends
Interior lines	1.5–2 px; folds only where the cloth turns
Line colour	Coloured: local colour × 0.45 value, never pure black (except ink-black garments, which get `#3A2E3A`)
Shading	2 tones + 1 rim. Shadow = local colour multiplied by the land's shadow tint (Meridian `#5E4F7A`, Hyakki `#2E3A6B`, River `#3E5A4A`, Śūnyapura `#6B4A5A`, Kroton `#4A5E7A`, Crossroads `#6A3E5A`, Basilica `#4A4A5A`) at 35%; one hard-edged shadow shape per form
Rim light	One rim from the background's key light colour, 2–4 px, on the side away from camera
Highlights	Hair and metal only; flat shapes, no gradients
Saturation	The signature colour is the most saturated thing on the character (Character Bible §0)
Palette	Max 4 main colours + 1 accent per character; NPCs 3 + 1
Skin	Real, varied tones; never grey-shifted; flushed cheeks only for children and comedy
Eyes	Heroes: large, coloured iris, one hard catch-light; NPCs: smaller; keepers: calm, half-lidded

ART SPEC · SCALE AND PROPORTION

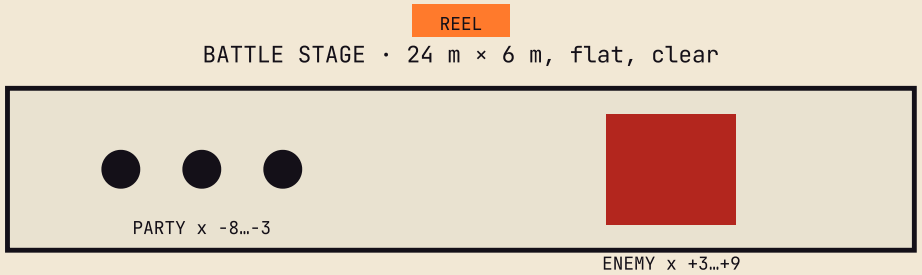
Heroes and secret recruits at one scale (1 m = 260 px in the model sheets). Adults are 7.5 heads tall; children 5–6; elders 6.5; bosses 8–9. Heights are canon locks.

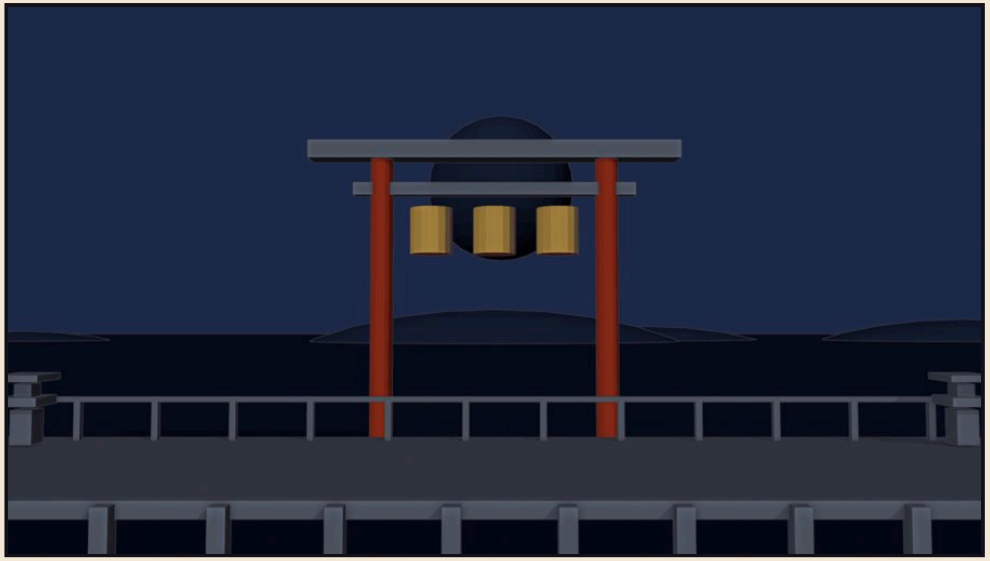


CLASS	HEIGHT RANGE	SHOULDER WIDTH	NOTES
Heroes	1.35 (Hina) – 1.95 (Bai Si)	0.20–0.27	Each hero's height is a canon lock (Character Bible)
Children	1.20–1.35	0.22–0.24	Tobi, Niko, Penny, Little Lantern
Elders	1.45–1.70	0.24–0.25	Ofuku, Liu Shun, Vidya Rao
Heavies	1.88–2.15	0.29–0.37	Collectors, Varro, Ox-Head and Horse-Face
Bosses	1.8–2.5	by design	Rahu & Ketu and Jin Chan use special bodies

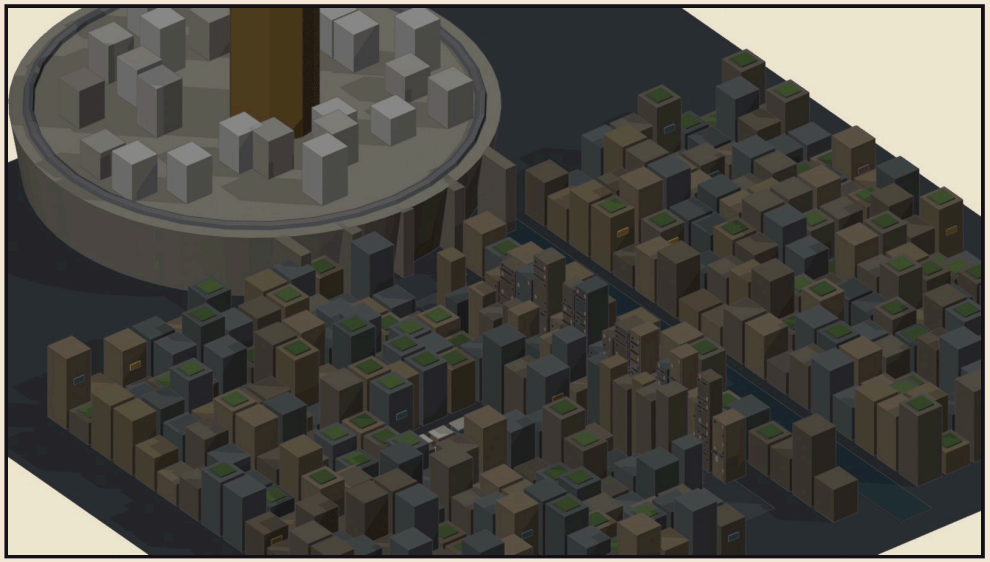
ART SPEC · CAMERAS AND THE STAGE

CAMERA	PROJECTION	ANGLE	USE
Battle (front view)	Perspective, 30 mm (≈ 40° vertical FOV)	Eye at 1.7–3.2 m, 17 m from the stage line, pitch 0–5°	All fights; side-on
Exploration (2.5D)	Orthographic	Pitch 57° down, yaw –38°	Map, towns, overworld
Plan (top-down)	Orthographic	Straight down	Level design, minimap, art book plans
Cinematic	Perspective, 18–85 mm	Free	Cutscenes; respect the 180° rule toward the reel





BATTLE · FRONT VIEW



EXPLORATION · 2.5D



ART SPEC · LIGHT BY LAND · FACTION COSTUME KEYS

LAND	TIME	KEY LIGHT	FILL / AMBIENT	ATMOSPHERE
Meridian Undercity	Rainy dawn / dusk	Window amber + Nixie signage	Wet slate blue	Rain, haze, wet ground
Hyakki	Summer night, full moon	Lantern gold	Indigo moonlight	Mist over water, fireflies
River Empire	Golden afternoon (harbor) / misty dark (Courts)	Low sun	Jade bounce	Incense, lantern smoke
Śūnyapura	Monsoon break	Sun through cloud	Wet sandstone bounce	Rain sheets, puddle mirrors
Kroton Nova	Hard noon	White sun	Aegean sky blue	Heat haze, sharp shadows
Crossroads	Sunset → neon night	Sunset orange / neon	Dusk violet	Dust, card storms
Basilica	Interior, no sun	Nixie amber	Brass bounce	Still air, motes

FACTION	BASE COLOURS	MATERIALS	MUST HAVE	NEVER
Basilica	Steel white, brass, olive	Enamel, brass, wool	Steel numerals; gear motifs	Glowing numbers
Collectors	Rust, gunmetal	Riveted leather, glass jars	Debt jars; peaked caps; masks for captains	Clean surfaces
Charm Bazaar	Magenta, sign yellow, cyan	Plastic, nylon, stickers	≥ 3 cultures' charms worn at once	Matching outfits
Remainder Wards	Ash, old brass, moss	Patched cloth, scrap	A cracked tube on a cord	New clothes
Yokai Courts	Violet, vermilion, foxfire cyan	Silk, paper, lacquer	Fox ears / tails, paper charms	Neon
Luck Exchange	Jade, gold, lacquer red	Silk, gold leaf	Gold numerals; abacus motifs	Rust
Ten Courts	Ink black, rice paper, seal red	Lacquer, lamellar	Brushes, seals	Bright colour
Observatory	Indigo, saffron, brass	Cotton, mirror-work	Astrolabe pins	Steel
Synod	Bronze, chalk, Aegean	Bronze, linen	Sieve shields, prime glyphs	Composite numbers on gear
The House	Casino red, ivory, gold	Satin, felt	Cards, waistcoats	Dust
Open Hand	Road dust, gold mark	Homespun	Open-hand cord; a die	Badges

PART II

THE WORLD

How the Tally works: the god of luck, the logic of luck, the schools of power, the people, the money, the politics and the past (docs/WORLD_ENCYCLOPEDIA.md).

1. Hap, the god of luck
2. The logic of luck
3. The six schools of power
4. How people use power
5. History and timeline
6. Politics and power
7. How things operate
8. Jobs
9. Stores
10. Factions and their styles

THE GOD OF LUCK · HAP



FRONT LEFT RIGHT BACK

"Hap deals. People choose."

Hap is the Tally's one god of luck: the will inside chance. Hap never commands; it deals. Every land built its own way of talking to Hap, and those ways became the many ledgers. In TR 702 the Basilica's Even Hand engine closed around the god itself: the amber eye over Meridian is Hap's eye, caged. The Rounding shaves the god every dawn, and the shavings became NIL: the part of luck that refused to be counted.

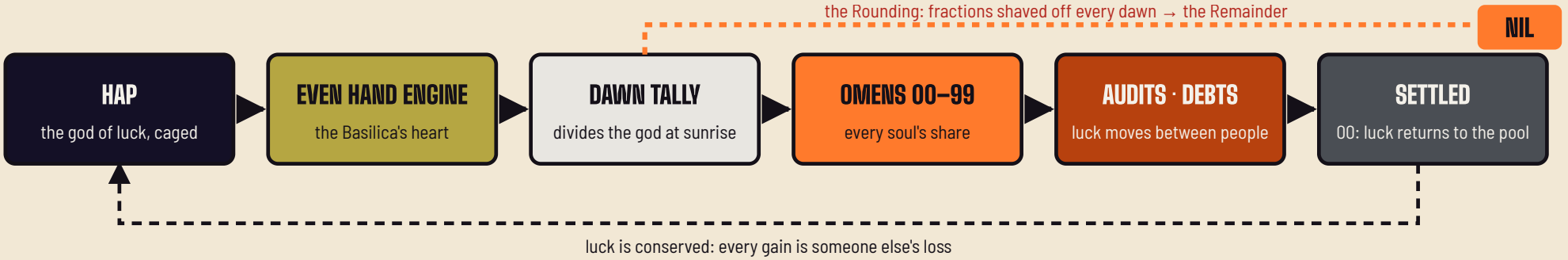
- Never the same face twice (each land's face, in its art style)
- Dice eyes and orbiting digits 0–9 never change
- Never a monster, a boss, or a stand-in for a real deity
- Speaks only in dreams, coincidences and the finale



The Open Hand: Hap's symbol

THE LOGIC OF LUCK

RULE	WHAT IT MEANS	CONSEQUENCE
1. Luck is real and finite.	Luck is the substance Hap dealt into the world: the chance that things go your way. Under the Basilica it is conserved: the total never changes.	For your luck to rise, someone else's must fall. Every gain is a transfer.
2. Every soul holds a share.	The Basilica divides the caged god into shares every dawn. Your share is your Omen, 00–99, floating over your head.	Everyone can see everyone's luck. It decides loans, jobs, marriages and how dangerous a staircase is for you today.
3. Luck acts through numbers.	Luck resolves events by the digits they produce. A dropped coin, a dice roll, a door code, a clock time: each is a little lottery the world runs. Higher Omens tilt them.	Numbers are everywhere because numbers are where luck happens.
4. Resonance.	At the Naming Rite (age seven) each soul states a lucky digit. That digit resonates: luck flows more easily through it.	People wear their digit, choose house numbers, wedding dates and jobs by it.
5. Stopping.	Auditors can summon a Fate Wheel (a visible strip of the digits an event could produce) and stop it, choosing which digit the event takes. Skill and resonance decide how well.	This is the only "magic" in the world, and it's licensed (§3).
6. Settlement.	At Omen 00 a soul is Settled: misfortune finds them within days and their remaining luck flows back to the pool.	Debt collectors drain Omens; a 01 is a death sentence with a short delay.
7. The Rounding.	Every Dawn Tally rounds each share down to a whole number. The fractions vanish… into NIL.	Nobody noticed for three centuries.
8. Noise.	Where the books don't balance, luck stops being dealt and starts boiling: Noise storms scramble numbers and spawn Noiselings.	The Deficit is growing; storms are more frequent every year.



HOW A FATE WHEEL WORKS

The in-world physics behind the one verb: stop the number.

1

An Audit begins when two Omens contest the same outcome (a fight, a deal, a debt).

2

Each Auditor's will draws a wheel of digits from the event. Faces are the possible outcomes; a face's width is its odds, shaped by the Auditor's Omen, resonance and tools (charms, enhanced faces).

3

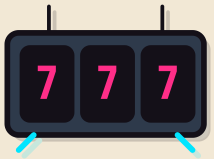
The tens of every strike are fixed by training and gear (tens are safe); the ones are fate and must be stopped (ones are fate).

4

Three stopped digits fall into the reel, the shared ledger of the moment. When the digits form a pattern, the world itself pays out: a Pair is a coincidence, a Jackpot a miracle, a Zero-Sum a perfectly balanced book that cancels the other side's next move.

5

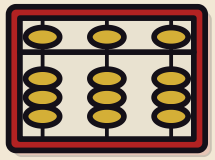
The loser's staked luck (Balance) drains toward the winner's side. Nobody dies in an Audit; they are rounded down, and may Settle later.



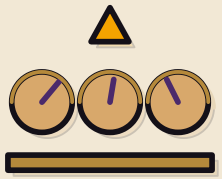
Neon sign



Torii with three lanterns



Golden abacus



Observatory dials

THE SIX SCHOOLS OF POWER

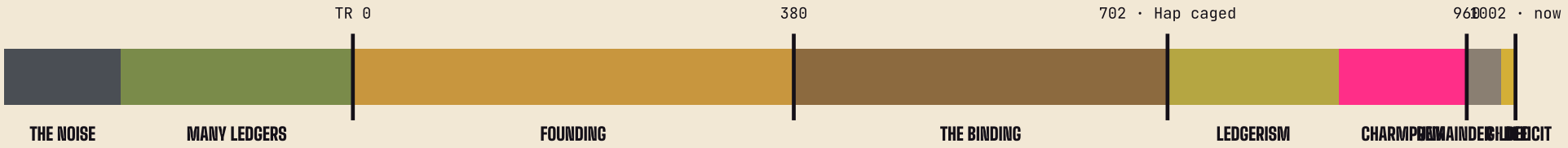
SCHOOL	LAND	SOURCE OF POWER	HOW IT LOOKS	SIGNATURE TECHNIQUES	PRACTITIONERS
Ledger Auditing (licensed)	Meridian	Brass wrist-wheels that tap the Basilica's count	Steel numerals, Nixie amber light, ledger lines	Debt Jar (steal a reel digit), Seizure (freeze a face), Interest	Basilica Auditors, Collectors, Varro, Thale
Shrine Binding	Hyakki	Belief: charms, shrines and old objects with souls	Paper talismans, foxfire, ukiyo-e waves	Omamori wards, illusion faces (foxfire), tsukumogami awakening	Shrine keepers, yokai, Hina, Tamamo
Brush Writing	River Empire	The written word in the Book of Life and Death	Ink strokes, gold leaf, red seals	Ink (rewrite a digit), Interest (compounding), Oracle sticks	Judge Cui's clerks, Exchange brokers, Jinling, Bai Si
Karma Weaving	Śūnyapura	Deeds recorded and returned; zero as the place that holds everything	Geometric light, rangoli patterns, brass instruments	Karma (bank and spend), Place Value, eclipses	Observatory astronomers, Shunya, Rahu & Ketu
Sieve Geometry	Kroton Nova	Number properties: primes, ratios, the thread's measure	Marble, mosaic glyphs, white light through holes	Prime pierce, Sieve (strike out faces), Factor	Synod knights, Prima, Archon Seventeen
Dealing	Crossroads	Contracts: luck bought, borrowed and owed	Cards, neon, dust, the black book	Deals, Wagers, Loops	The Stranger, croupiers, Fibi, the House
The Remainder (unique)	—	The god's lost change	NaN glitches, orange digits that refuse to round	Splice, Carry, Divide by Zero	NIL only

Licensing: since TR 760 only Ledger Auditing is licensed. Every other school is folk practice: tolerated at home, illegal in Meridian unless registered.

HOW PEOPLE USE POWER

USE	WHO	HOW
Protection	Everyone	Charms widen good faces a little for everyday lotteries (slips, accidents, exams). Weak everywhere, strongest in their home land.
Lending luck	Luck banks, the Exchange	Lend Omen points at interest; repayments are drained at dawn by licensed Auditors.
Insurance	Insurers (Meridian)	Pool many small Omens to cover one big misfortune; premiums are paid in luck-ins.
Law	Courts	Disputes between Omens are settled by Audit under a magistrate (a formal, non-lethal duel).
Medicine	Clinics	Doctors can't create luck, but Omen clinics move luck from donors to the critically ill ("luck transfusion"), for a price.
Work	Trades	Builders, pilots and miners need high Omens for safety; low Omens are pushed into dangerous jobs, which is how the Remainder Wards grew.
Games	Casinos, festivals	Legal small Audits for show; big Audits for money are illegal in Meridian, legal in Lucky Strike.
Faith	Temples, shrines, the outlawed Open Hand	Offerings ask for a land's way of luck; the Open Hand leaves a die in an open palm for Hap.

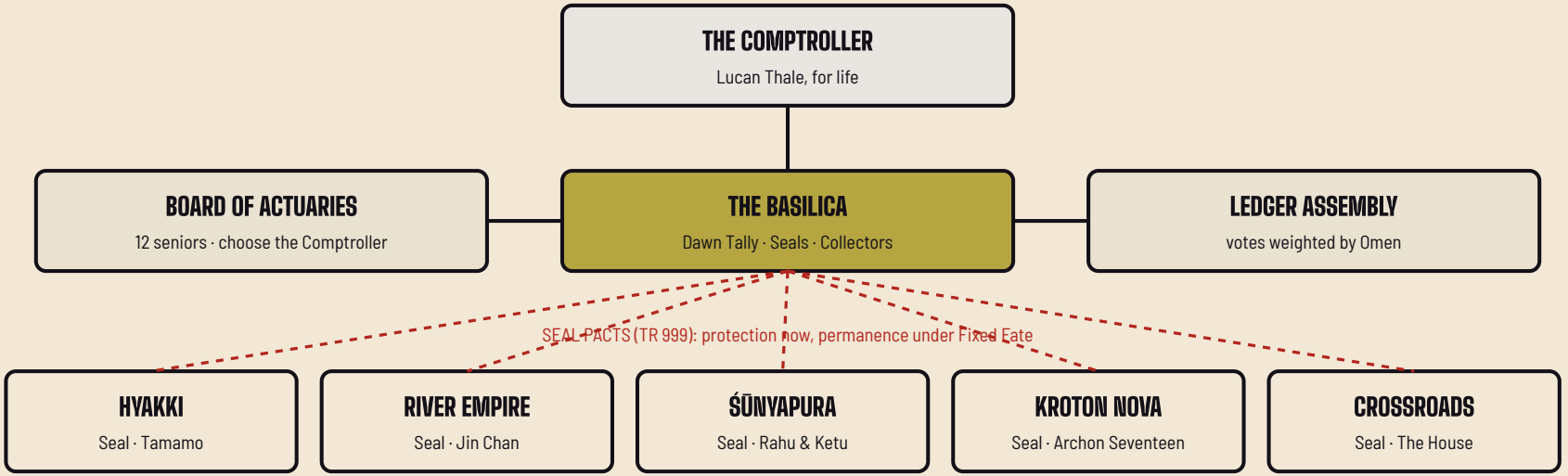
HISTORY AND TIMELINE



WHEN	ERA	EVENT
Before reckoning	The Noise	Hap deals freely; nobody keeps accounts. Fortune moves like weather.
Ancient	The Many Ledgers	Each people learns to talk to Hap: the Moirai's thread (Kroton Nova), Chitragupta's records (Śūnyapura), the Book of Life and Death (River Empire), Enma's ledger (Hyakki), the black book (Crossroads).
~1,000 years before TR		Zero formalised in Śūnyapura; place value travels the trade roads.
TR 0	Founding	Meridian founded as a trading town at the crossroads of the Tally.
TR 120		The first Charm Bazaar: every caravan's charms on one street.
TR 380–690	The Binding	Meridian's actuaries copy, buy or seize each land's ledger.
TR 512		Kroton Nova's thread is "borrowed" for a century; the Synod hardens.
TR 640		The Exchange opens in Bāfā Harbor under Meridian charter.
TR 702	The Basilica	The engine completed; the Final Binding cages Hap; the first Dawn Tally; the Rounding begins. Worship of Hap outlawed in Meridian.
TR 760 →	Ledgerism	Brass-and-steel style; Auditing licensed; the Collectors founded.

WHEN	ERA	EVENT
TR 850 →	Charmpunk	Immigrant quarters fill Meridian; every culture's charms on one door.
TR 911		The Lucky Strike casino opens on Basilica money; the House's first deal.
TR 960 →	Remainder	A storm destroys Lucan Thale's street (he is 12); the Undercity fills with low Omens.
TR 962	The Deficit	Śūnyapura's observatory first measures the leak. Noise storms begin.
TR 985		Thale becomes Comptroller.
TR 990 →	Gilded Fortune	The 99s flaunt gold leaf, jade and gardens.
TR 999		Thale proves the Rounding, finds Hap in the engine, drafts the Final Audit, signs the Seal pacts.
TR 1001		Varro Kade becomes a Collector. The Ghost Train's loop count reaches 1,596.
TR 1002	Now	NIL wakes in Rain Alley 9. REMAINDER DETECTED. The game begins.
TR 1002 (finale)	The Open Hand	Depends on the ending: Balance, Overflow, Positive-Sum or Divide by Zero.

POLITICS AND POWER



LAND	WHO RULES	THE BASILICA'S GRIP	WHAT THE PACT PROMISED
Meridian	The Comptroller; the Board; the Assembly	Total	Order
Hyakki	The Yokai Courts with human village councils	Toll gates on shrine roads; Collectors in harbours	Yokai never fade (Tamamo)
River Empire	The Chancellor of the Exchange (de facto); the Ten Courts below	The Exchange is half a Basilica office	Jin Chan's bank holds the frozen luck
Śūnyapura	City council of scholars and guilds; the Observatory	Surveyors rewriting measurements	Rahu & Ketu made whole
Kroton Nova	The Pythagorean Synod (the Archon)	The Sieve "accelerated"	Purity
Crossroads	The House (by money), the sheriff (by law)	Basilica finance	The night never ends

Luck is wealth, health and safety at once, so whoever controls the count controls everything. The game's politics is unmasking that.

HOW THINGS OPERATE

Money

Two currencies: **fen (small coins of brass, everyday trade across the Tally) and luck** itself (Omen points, traded at the Exchange and lent by banks). Prices are posted in fen; luck is for big things (loans, licences, medicine).

Law

Disputes go to an **Audit court**: a magistrate oversees a formal Audit between the parties' Auditors (or themselves). Crimes are punished in luck (Omen fines) or time. The death penalty doesn't exist; Settlement does the work, which is worse.

Transport

Meridian: cliff lifts and stairs between the Undercity and the plateau (lift fares are by Omen: the lower your number, the higher the fare, "for safety"). Between lands: ferries (Hyakki), river junks (River Empire), rail (Crossroads), the monsoon road (Śūnyapura), the Aegean packet boats (Kroton Nova).

Education

Children learn their digit's meaning before the Naming Rite at seven; the Basilica's schools teach arithmetic as morality.

The day

The **Dawn Tally** at sunrise recomputes every Omen (a beam sweeps each city; clocks strike 0). Debts are drained in the hour after. Markets open at the second bell.

Health

Omen clinics transfuse luck; doctors still heal bodies. The poor sell luck-ins to pay for medicine and then need more medicine.

Media

Omen boards in squares; the *Daily Tally* broadsheet (every Omen change of note); radio plays in the Crossroads; street criers in Bāfā.

Architecture rule

Floors 4, 9 and 13 are skipped in lifts; buildings face east for the Dawn Tally; the Basilica's eye is visible from every street in Meridian (a planning law).

JOBS IN THE TALLY

JOB	WHERE	WHAT THEY DO	TYPICAL OMEN	TOOLS / LOOK
Auditor	Everywhere (licensed in Meridian)	Stops Fate Wheels in disputes, debts and duels	50–90	Wrist-wheel, field coat
Collector	Meridian	Drains debts at dawn; hunts bounties	40–60	Debt jars, rust armour
Actuary	Basilica	Computes the Dawn Tally; the Basilica's mathematicians (NIL's coat is an actuary's)	50	Ledgers, slide rules
Ledger-priest	Basilica	Performs the Dawn Tally and the Naming Rite	50 (steel)	Mitre, chained ledger
Dawn-bell ringer	Meridian	Rings the bells that start the Tally; the city's clocks strike 0	30–60	Bell ropes
Nixie-tuber	Meridian	Repairs the Nixie tubes that display Omens and signs	20–50	Glass, wire, gloves
Charm-smith	Bazaar, everywhere	Makes and repairs charms from every culture	20–70	Forge, anvil (Maeve)
Luck-broker	Exchange	Trades Omen points like shares	70–99	Abacus, ticker
Pawnbroker of luck	River Empire, Meridian	Lends against charms and future luck	60–90	Ledgers, safes (Jinling)
Omen clinician	Meridian, River Empire	Luck transfusion from donor to patient	60–80	Brass cannulas, Nixie meters
Insurer	Meridian	Pools luck against misfortune	70+	Contracts

JOBS IN THE TALLY (CONT.)

JOB	WHERE	WHAT THEY DO	TYPICAL OMEN	TOOLS / LOOK
Shrine keeper	Hyakki	Keeps shrines, paints daruma eyes, sells omamori	any	Brush, charms (Ofuku)
Ferryman	Hyakki	Carries travellers between the islands	any	Oar (Tetsu)
Oracle-stick reader	River Empire temples	Reads the fortune sticks	any	Cylinders, poem books
Astronomer	Śūnyapura	Measures the sky and the Deficit	any	Astrolabes (Shunya)
Stepwell diver	Śūnyapura	Recovers what falls into the wells	any	Rope, lamp (Meera)
Synod knight	Kroton Nova	Guards the Sieve	prime	Sieve shield
Croupier / dealer	Crossroads	Runs legal Audits for money	any	Cards (Fibi)
Sheriff	Crossroads	Keeps the peace in the loop	any	Badge (Vance)
Luck-in seller	Remainder Wards	Sells single Omen points for food	01–10	Nothing left to sell
Rounding-sweeper (urban legend)	Meridian	Said to sweep up dropped fractions at dawn; nobody has seen one	—	A broom made of digits

STORES AND SERVICES

STORE	LAND	WHAT IT SELLS	SIGN	IN PLAY
Charm stall	Meridian (Bazaar)	Every culture's charms	Hand-painted lucky number + a charm silhouette	Markets (charms)
Luck pawnshop	River Empire, Meridian	Loans against charms or future luck	Three gold coins on a red board	Markets (fen, Deals later)
Omen clinic	Meridian	Luck transfusions, Omen checks	White cross made of two 1s	Story; healing at a price
Nixie repair	Meridian	Tubes for Omen displays and signs	A glowing tube in the window	Face enhancements
Forge	Meridian (Celtic quarter), Kroton	Charm upgrades, horseshoes	An anvil with a clover	Forge nodes (Maeve)
Noodle stall	Everywhere	Food priced in sevens and eights	Steam and a number	Rest (Teahouse/Campfire)
Teahouse	Hyakki, River Empire	Tea, gossip, a place to rest the party	Paper lantern with a digit	Teahouse nodes
Shrine	Hyakki, Śūnyapura	Omamori, daruma, offerings	Torii / temple bell	Shrine nodes
Oracle-stick temple	River Empire	Fortune sticks	Smoke and a cylinder	Oracle sticks
Gem bazaar	Śūnyapura	The nine planetary gems	Nine coloured lamps	Navaratna gems
Agora stalls	Kroton Nova	Gems, wheel crafting at a "prime discount"	Prime numerals on marble	Markets
Casino / card room	Crossroads	Legal Audits for money	Neon dice	Wagers
Motel	Crossroads	Rooms on Route 7	"VACANCY" with the C burnt out	Campfire nodes
Open Hand shrine	Everywhere	Nothing: a stone hand and a die	An open palm carved in stone	Open Hand nodes

FACTION

The Basilica

Steel white	Brass	Olive	Nixie
#E8E6E1	#B5A642	#6E6B4E	#FF7A2C

SEAT	Meridian
WANTS	Order; the Final Audit
POWER	Ledger Auditing; the Dawn Tally
STYLE	Ledgerism: brass, steel, white enamel, cathedral arches; steel numerals
UNIFORM / LOOK	White-and-brass vestments, gear-crested mitres (priests); olive field coats (Auditors)
RANKS	Comptroller → Ledger-priests → Senior Auditors → Clerks → Novices
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	Wrist-wheels, chained ledgers, Seal stamps



Ledger-priest



Basilica Auditor

FACTION

The Collectors

Rust	Gunmetal	Debt glow	Bone
#B7410E	#4A4E54	#FF7A2C	#E3DCCB

SEAT	Meridian
WANTS	Debts paid; bounties
POWER	Licensed debt Auditing
STYLE	Rust armour, gunmetal, glass debt jars with orange glow
UNIFORM / LOOK	Rust trench armour, peaked caps, hound-skull masks for captains
RANKS	Chief Collector → Captain (masked) → Collector → Hound handler
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	Debt jars, chains, Debt Hounds



Collector



Varro Kade, the Ledgerhound

FACTION

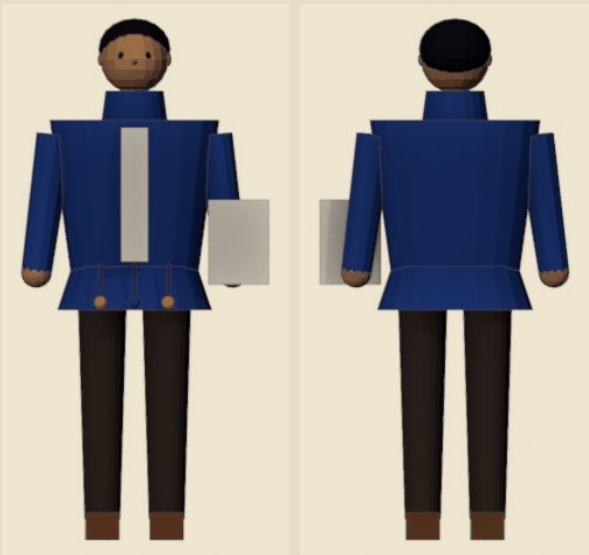
7 Charm Bazaar guilds

Magenta	Sign yellow	Cyan	Clover
#FF2E88	#F5E400	#00E5FF	#3BB273

SEAT	Meridian
WANTS	Trade, survival, folk luck
POWER	Charm-smithing (every culture's)
STYLE	Charmpunk: plastic gold, neon, stickers, every culture at once
UNIFORM / LOOK	Puffer jackets hung with charms; painted numbers; fake holo-halos
RANKS	Guild masters → stallholders → runners
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	Charms, Nixie pendants, forged horseshoes



Charm Bazaar local



Gus Mendoza

FACTION

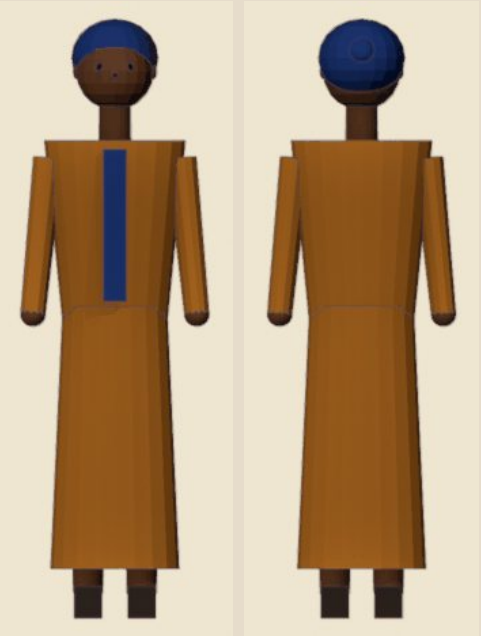
The Remainder Wards (not a faction: a people)

Ash	Old brass	Moss	Leather
#8A7F72	#C8963E	#5E7D4A	#6B4226

SEAT	Meridian Undercity
WANTS	To get through the week
POWER	Mutual aid; luck-ins
STYLE	Remainder: scrap brass, patched cloth, salvaged Nixie tubes, rope
UNIFORM / LOOK	Ponchos, patched coats, a cracked tube on a cord instead of a glowing Omen
RANKS	Elders, block captains
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	Tools, salvage



Wards mechanic



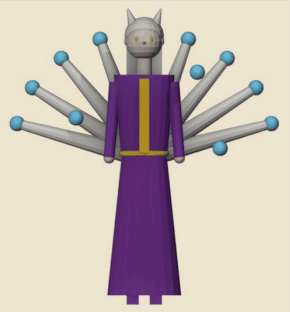
Ama Okoro

FACTION

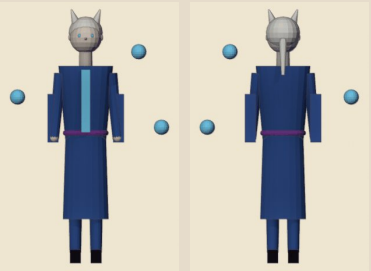
The Yokai Courts

Violet	Vermilion	Foxfire	Gold
#8E44AD	#E34234	#7FDBFF	#F4C430

SEAT	Hyakki
WANTS	To keep existing
POWER	Shrine Binding; belief
STYLE	Ukiyo-e flatness, vermilion, foxfire cyan-violet, paper and lacquer
UNIFORM / LOOK	Court robes, fox ears and tails for kitsune; tsukumogami are their objects
RANKS	Tamamo → kitsune retainers → yokai of every kind
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	Foxfire, illusion faces



Tamamo, the Nine-Tailed Auditor



Ao (Kitsune twin)

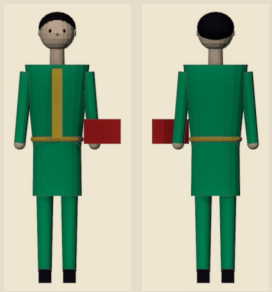
FACTION



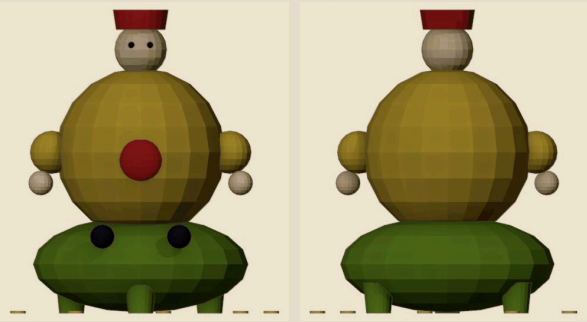
The Luck Exchange

Jade	Gold	Lacquer	Paper
#00A86B	#D4AF37	#B22222	#E9E2D0

SEAT	Bāfā Harbor
WANTS	Profit
POWER	Brush Writing for contracts; interest
STYLE	Gilded Fortune: jade, gold leaf, red lacquer, live price boards
UNIFORM / LOOK	Jade mandarin-collar suits, gold trim, pocket abacus, ear tickers
RANKS	Chancellor → Directors → Brokers → Runners
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	Abacus fans, contracts, Debt Junks



Exchange Broker



Chancellor Jin Chan

FACTION



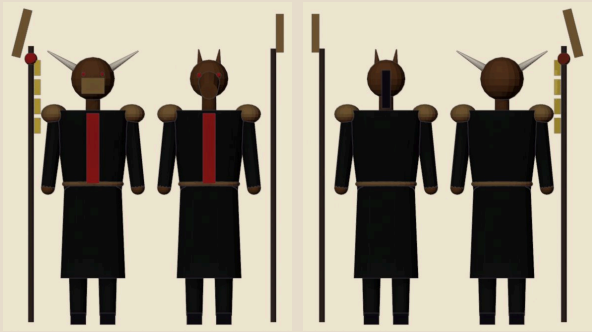
The Ten Courts (keepers)

Ink	Rice paper	Seal red	Bronze
#1B1B1B	#E9E2D0	#B22222	#8C6A3F

SEAT	Under the River Empire
WANTS	The true count of the dead
POWER	Brush Writing on the Book
STYLE	Ink-wash, rice paper, red seals; near silence
UNIFORM / LOOK	Black official robes; wardens in lamellar armour (Ox-Head, Horse-Face)
RANKS	Judges → wardens → clerks → executioner (Bai Si)
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	The Brush, the Book, halberds



Judge Cui



Ox-Head and Horse-Face

FACTION

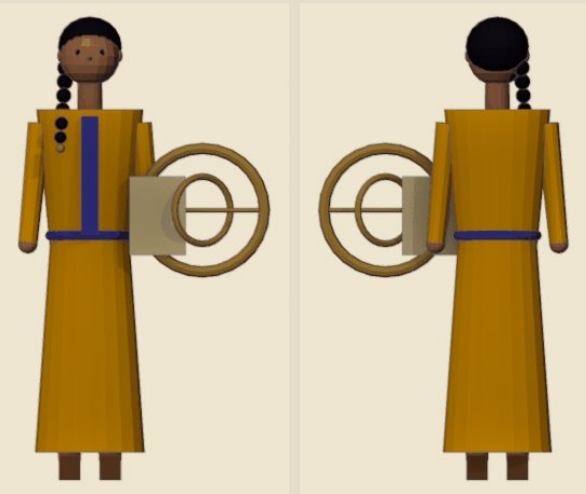
The Observatory

Indigo	Saffron	Brass	Sandstone
#3F3D99	#F4A300	#B5893B	#D8A86B

SEAT	Śūnyapura
WANTS	Truth by measurement
POWER	Karma Weaving; astronomy
STYLE	Sandstone, brass instruments, saffron and indigo, mirror-work
UNIFORM / LOOK	Layered indigo-and-saffron, brass astrolabe pins
RANKS	Acharya → astronomers → students
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	Astrolabes, dials, palm-leaf records



Acharya Vidya Rao



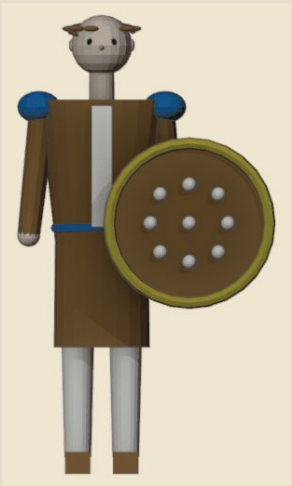
Shunya

FACTION

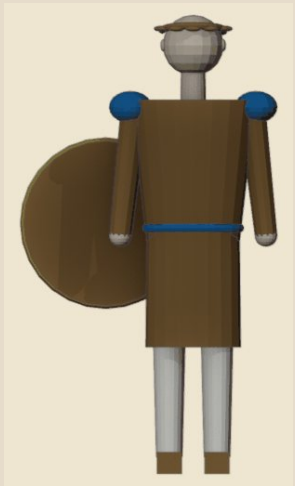
The Pythagorean Synod

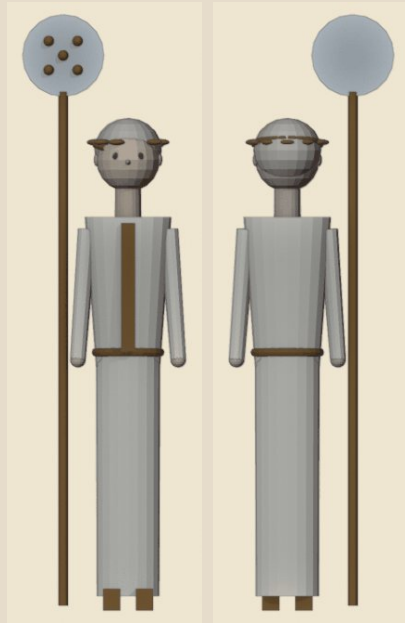
Bronze	Chalk	Aegean	Olive
#8C6A3F	#F4F1EA	#1F6FB2	#7A8B4A

SEAT	Kroton Nova
WANTS	Purity of number
POWER	Sieve Geometry
STYLE	White marble, bronze, Aegean blue, mosaic glyphs
UNIFORM / LOOK	Bronze cuirass, chalk tunic, sieve shields
RANKS	Archon → Synod elders → knights → novices
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	Sieve shields, prime glyphs



Composite Knight





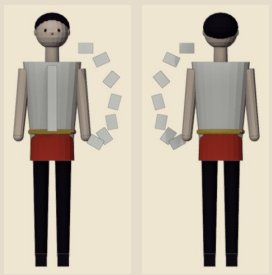
Archon Seventeen

FACTION

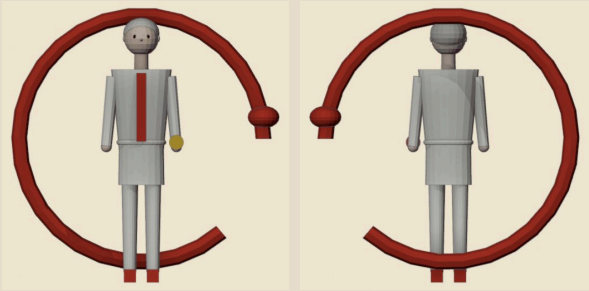
The House

Casino red	Ivory	Gold	Midnight
#C0392B	#F4F1EA	#D4AF37	#1D1A3A

SEAT	Lucky Strike
WANTS	The night never ending
POWER	Dealing; the loop
STYLE	Casino red, ivory, gold, desert neon
UNIFORM / LOOK	Red waistcoats, sleeve garters, green-felt trays
RANKS	The House → floor bosses → dealers
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	Marked decks, Wagers, the loop



House dealer



The House, Octavian Nine

FACTION

The Open Hand (outlawed)

Road dust	Open Hand gold	Homespun	Ink
#B9A58A	#D4AF37	#8C6A3F	#141018

SEAT	Everywhere, quietly
WANTS	To free Hap; second chances for all
POWER	Prayer; coincidence
STYLE	Road dust, plain cloth, one gold open-hand mark
UNIFORM / LOOK	Travelling cloaks, a carved open hand on a cord, a smooth die
RANKS	No ranks: "hands"
TOOLS AND WEAPONS	Dice, shrines, safe houses



Open Hand pilgrim







Brother Nought

STYLES

THE FOUR ERAS OF LUCK

Meridian's styles come from its history: the binding of the ledgers, the Rounding, the Deficit. Every street mixes them; every outfit tells you which side of the Zero-Sum Law its owner lives on.

TR 702
Basilica completed

TR 760→
Ledgerism

TR 850→
Charmpunk

TR 960→
Remainder

TR 990→
Gilded Fortune

TR 1002
Today



CHARMPUNK

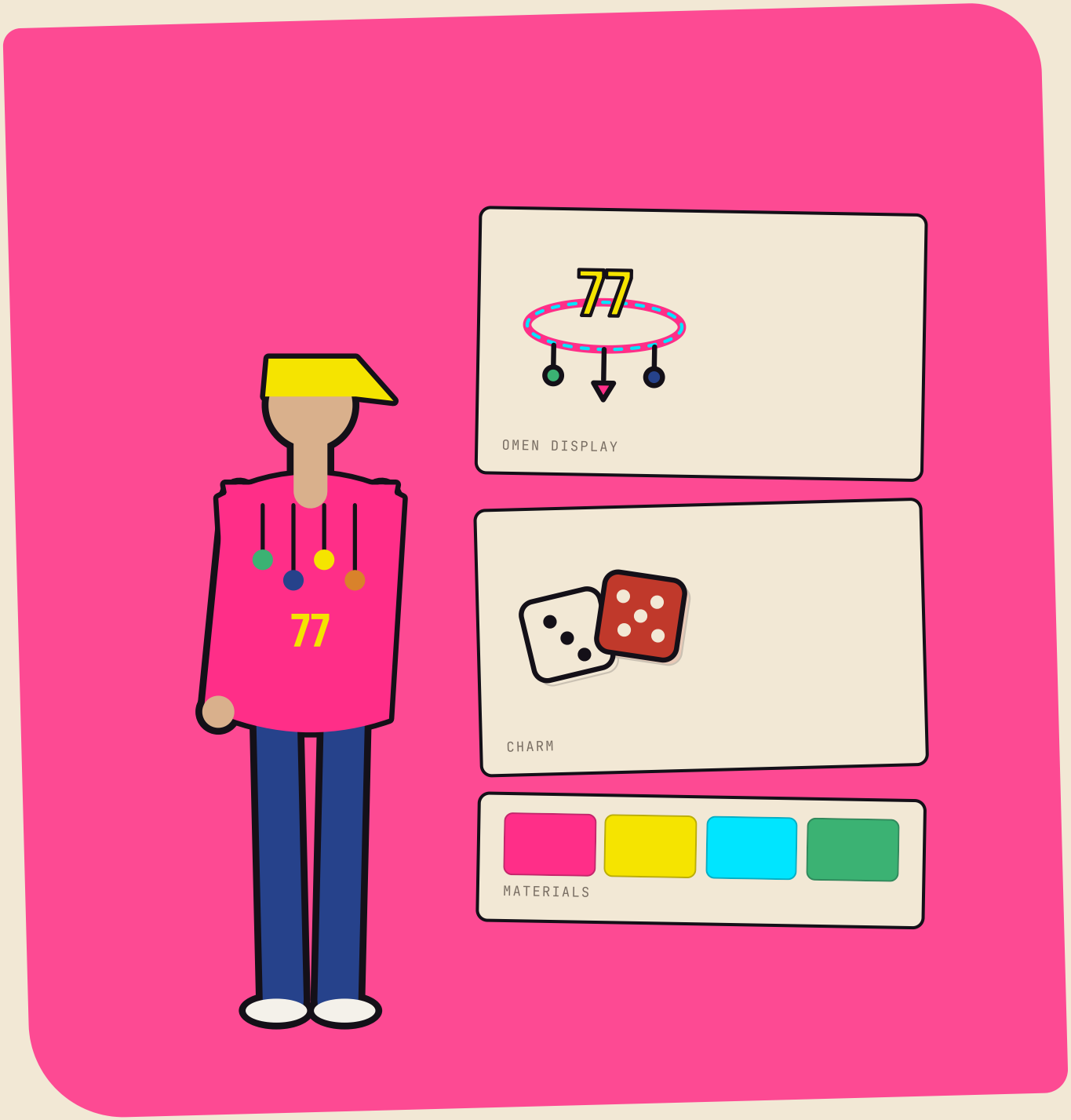
→ LUCK OVER SENSE ←

TR 850→

The street's lingua franca. Every culture's charms worn at once, hand-painted lucky numbers, plastic gold and neon. Charmpunk is loud because luck is a performance: if you can't raise your Omen, you can at least look like you're winning.

ART NEEDED · CHARMPUNK keyframe

- Line-up of 6 Bazaar locals in Charmpunk
- Keyframe: the Charm Bazaar at night, every stall a different culture
- Omen display: gaudy holo-halos, fake Omen projectors



REMAINDER

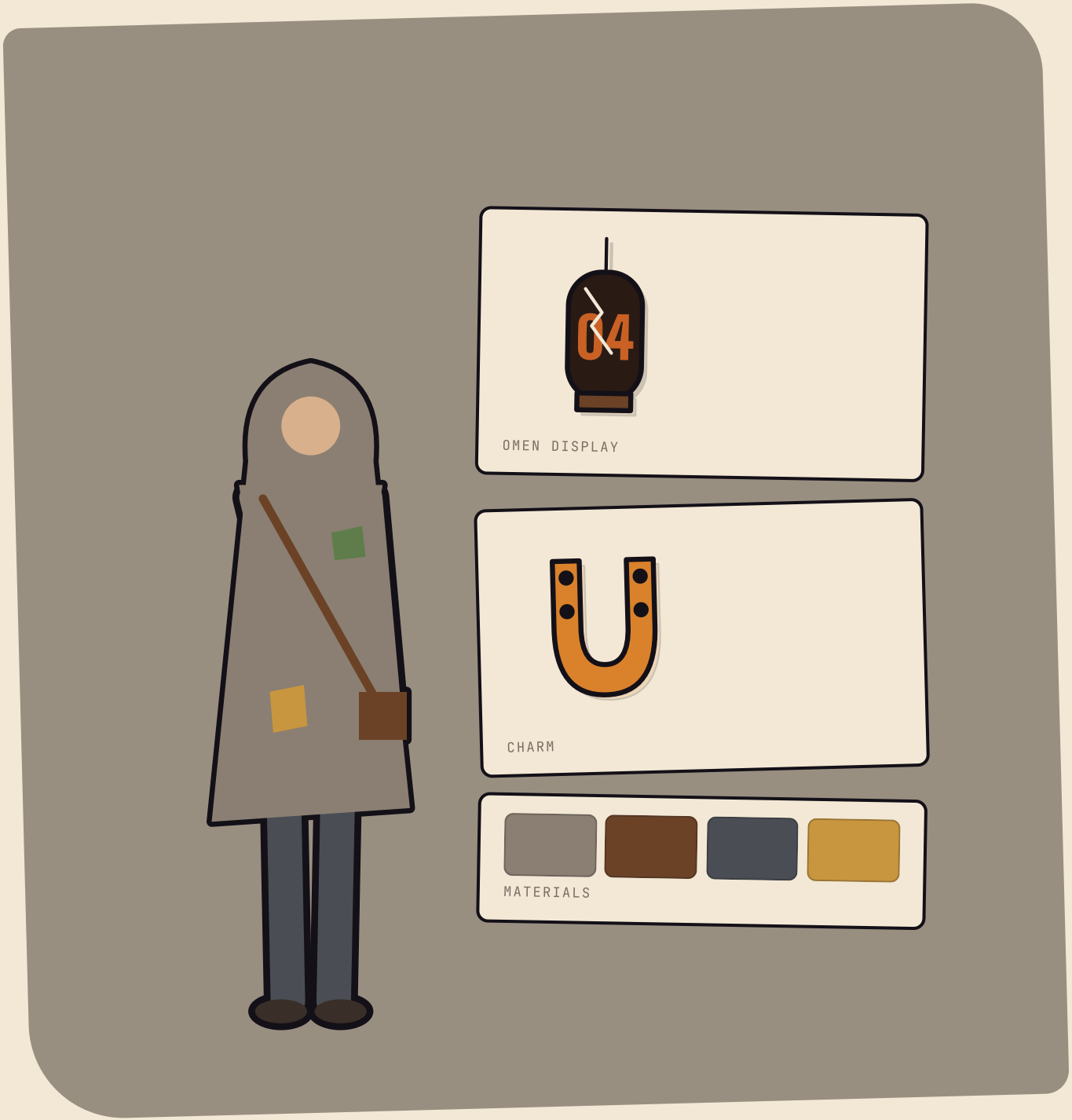
→ SURVIVAL OVER LUCK ←

TR 960→

The style of the Undercity, where Omens run low. Scrap brass from old Basilica parts, patched cloth, salvaged Nixie tubes and rope. Durable, ugly, honest. People hide their numbers here out of shame.

ART NEEDED · REMAINDER keyframe

- Line-up: Remainder Wards residents (mechanic, cook, debt-ridden mother, kids)
- Environment: Rain Alley 9 at dawn
- Omen display: a cracked tube on a cord



LEDGERISM

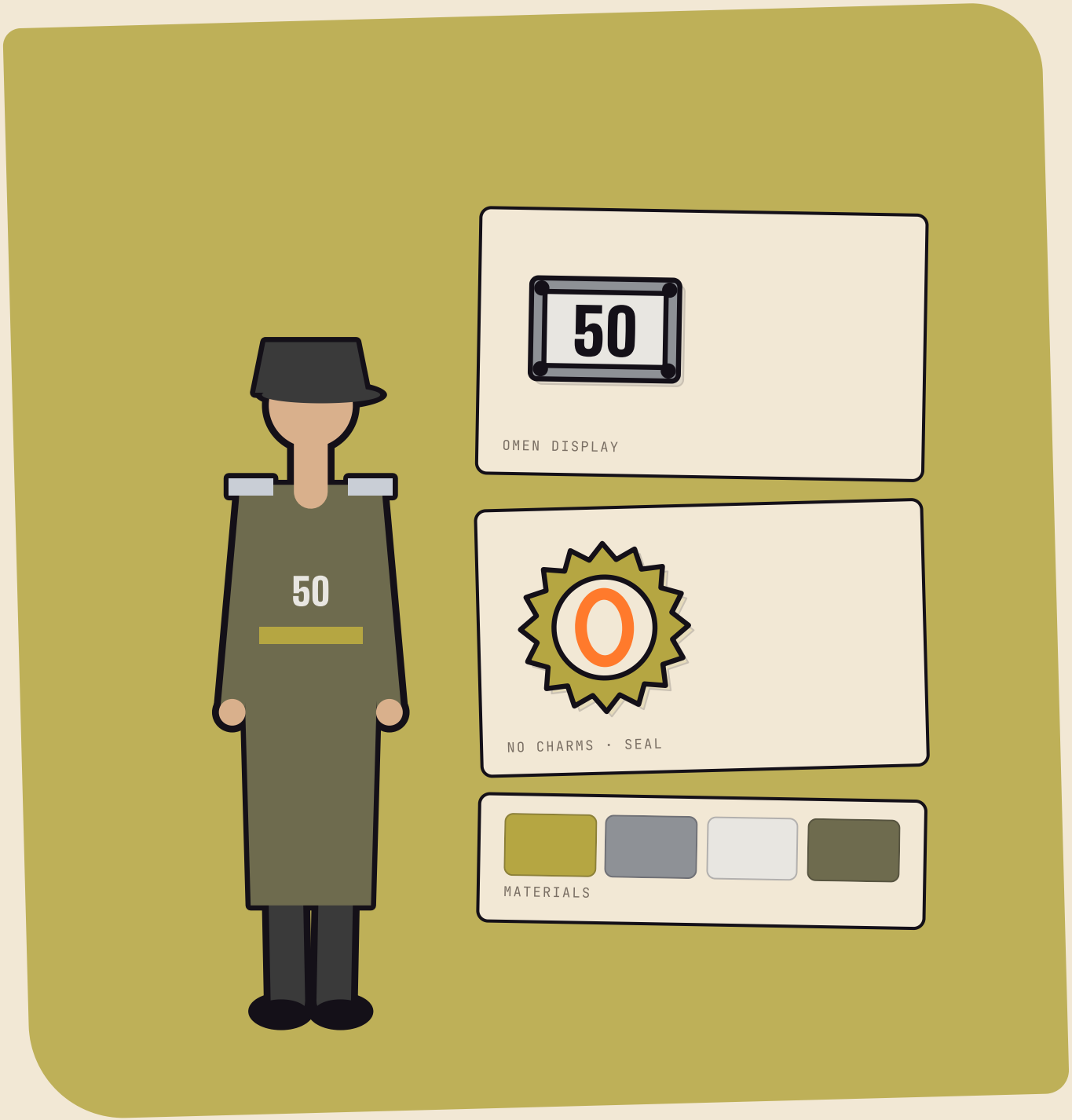
→ ORDER OVER CHANCE ←

TR 760→

The style of the Basilica and its servants. Brass, steel and white enamel; cathedral arches; clockwork; uniforms with stamped seals. Cold, formal and threatening, it says that chance has been abolished and you are being counted.

ART NEEDED · LEDGERISM keyframe

- Line-up: Collectors, Ledger-priests, Basilica clerks, Auditors
- Environment: the Basilica Ring checkpoint
- Omen display: steel numerals, never glowing



GILDED FORTUNE

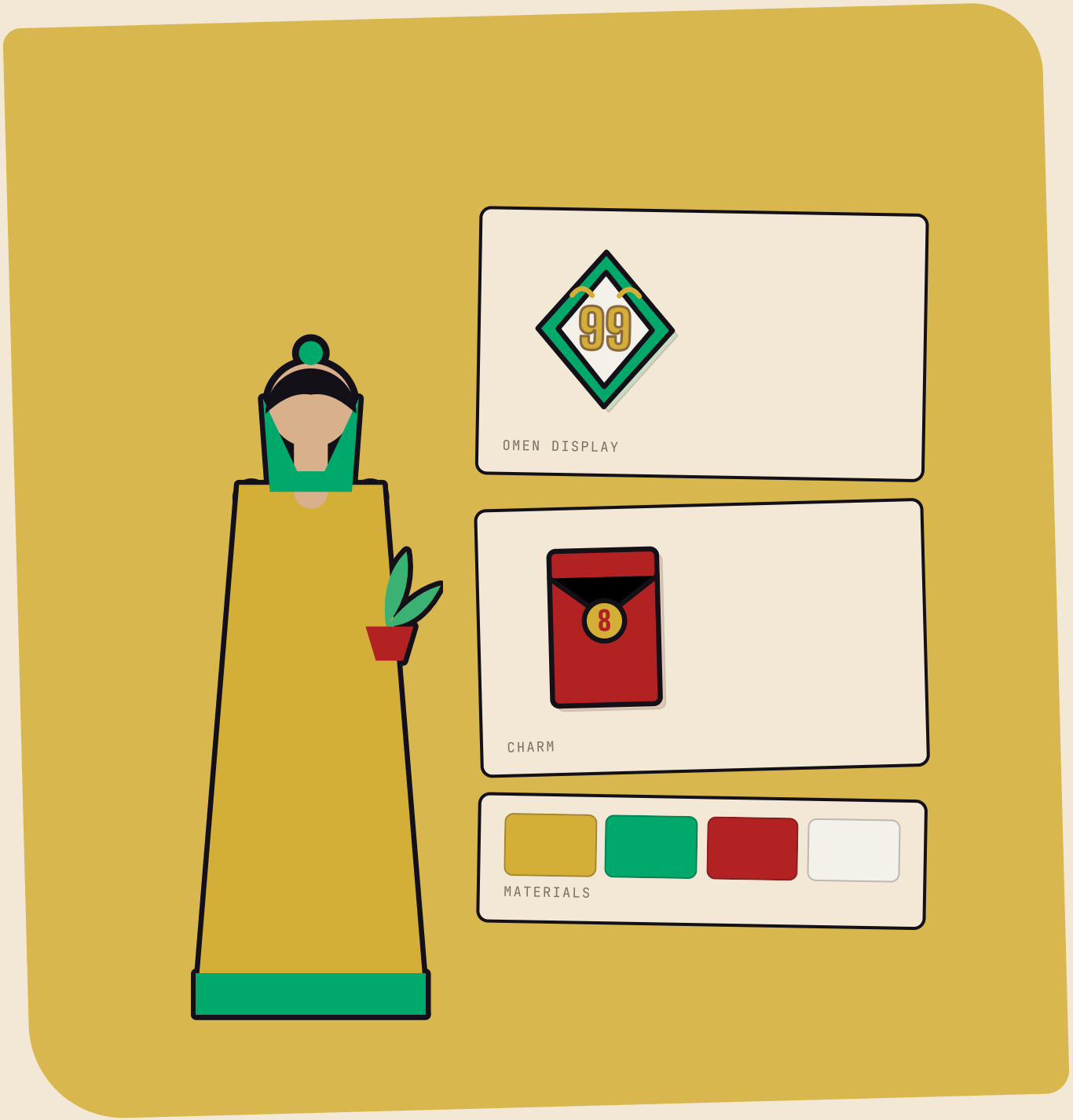
→ FORTUNE AND ORDER ←

TR 990→

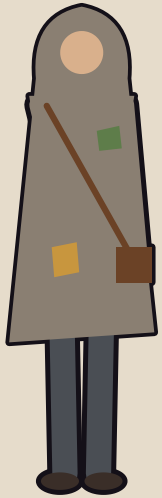
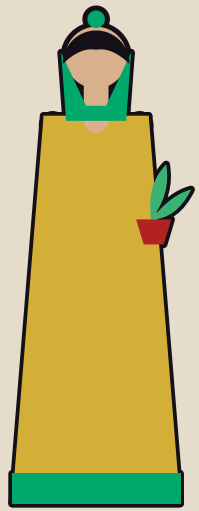
The style of the 99s: old money and Exchange magnates. Real gold leaf, jade, silk and living plants. In Meridian a garden is luck you can see; a bonsai on a balcony is a fortune worn in public.

ART NEEDED · GILDED FORTUNE keyframe

- Line-up: Exchange magnates, heirs, their guards
- Environment: the Exchange Terraces garden-villas
- Omen display: embroidered or gold-leaf numerals



COMPARISON

CHARMPUNK	REMAINDER	LEDGERISM	GILDED FORTUNE
			
Charm 	Charm 	Charm 	Charm 
Omen display 	Omen display 	Omen display 	Omen display 
LUCK OVER SENSE	SURVIVAL OVER LUCK	ORDER OVER CHANCE	FORTUNE AND ORDER

The same three slots per era (a person, a charm, an Omen display), side by side so the eras read as one system. Design figures stand in until the painted comparison sheet (Art Book Production Guide §7, image 3).

THE TALLY

A ring of lands around Meridian's plateau. The upper city is sealed, so to go up you must go around. Each land kept its own ledger of fate before the Basilica bound them all.

Red dotted line: the party's road, from Meridian's Undercity through five lands and back. The Upper Gate needs seven Seal Digits: 1 (Varro), 9, 8, 0, 2, 7, and the seventh is the player's own lucky number.

SEALED



PART III

THE LANDS

Seven places, seven palettes. Every land: its colour-script opener, then its 3D blockout from above, in 2.5D and from the battle camera.

1. Meridian Undercity
2. Hyakki
3. The River Empire
4. Śūnyapura
5. Kroton Nova
6. The Crossroads Territory
7. The Basilica

MERIDIAN UNDERCITY

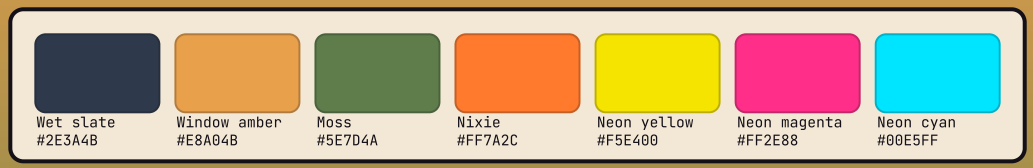
Prologue · cosmopolitan capital · cyber-noir painted city

ACT	Prologue
INSPIRED BY	a cosmopolitan modern capital; the immigrant quarters of every great port city.
LAW OF THE LAND	Debt: everyone owes luck
AUDITOR	Varro Kade, the Ledgerhound
ENEMIES	Debt Hounds · Collectors · Noiselings
LITTLE THINGS	charms of every culture over every door; laundry between tenements; balcony gardens (a garden is luck you can see); cats; hand-painted lucky numbers.
SOUND	rain, Nixie hum, distant Dawn Tally bells, street musicians, Collector sirens.





00–99

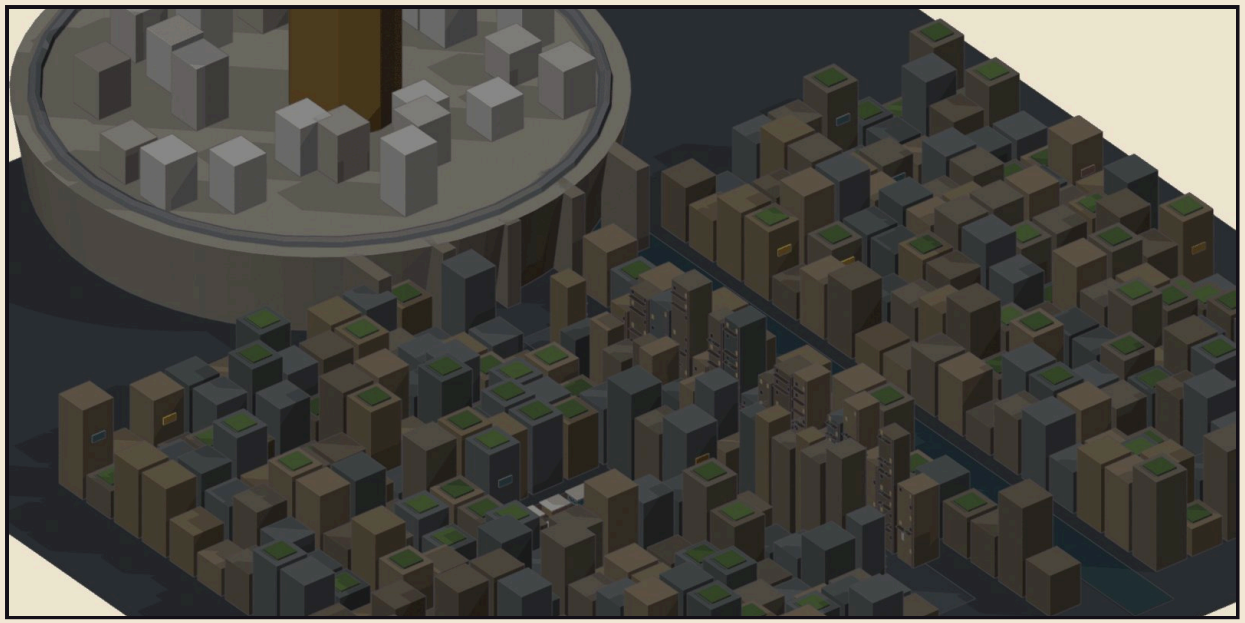


ART NEEDED · Meridian Undercity paintings

- Establishing: the Wards at dawn after rain, the Basilica's eye at the end of the street
- Battle stage: Rain Alley 9
- District keyframes: Charm Bazaar, Exchange Terraces, Basilica Ring

COLOUR SCRIPT

MERIDIAN UNDERCITY · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

PROLOGUE · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

TIME	Rainy dawn / dusk
KEY LIGHT	Window amber + Nixie signage
FILL	Wet slate blue
ATMOSPHERE	Rain, haze, wet ground

First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

MERIDIAN · REMAINDER WARDS

Stacked in the drains and cliffs beneath the plateau. The Wards began as workers' housing for the Basilica's builders and became the place where low Omens end up. Remainder scrap meets Charmpunk colour: every door wears a different culture's charm.

What happened here: the Rounding. Every fraction of luck dropped since TR 702 flowed downhill, and so did everyone who lost theirs.



KEY · REMAINDER WARDS

Colour key over the 3D base: overcast dawn after rain. Slate, ochre and moss walls, warm windows, every culture's laundry, the brass Basilica at the end of the canyon. Nixie orange, magenta and cyan live only on the signs.

Pipeline stage 1b · colour key. Perspective, scale and light are solved in 3D first (see the pipeline page). Stage 2 paints over this; stage 3 is the artist's overpaint.

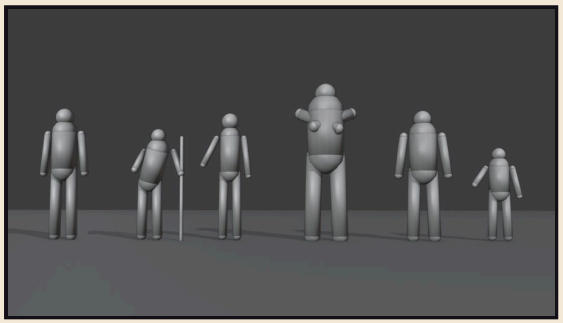


LINE-UP · REMAINDER WARDS

Six locals, shoulder to shoulder, slightly low camera, over the district painting. Ages, builds and origins vary; every outfit is evidence of the Wards' economy.

ART NEEDED · Remainder Wards line-up

- Brass-scrap mechanic (Remainder)
- Grandmother with jade and evil-eye charms (Charmpunk)
- Teen dice-gambler (Charmpunk)
- Collector in rust armour (Ledgerism)
- Noodle cook with a lemon-and-chilli charm
- Kid with a cracked Nixie-tube necklace (Remainder)



3D BASE FOR THIS LINE-UP · STAGE 1

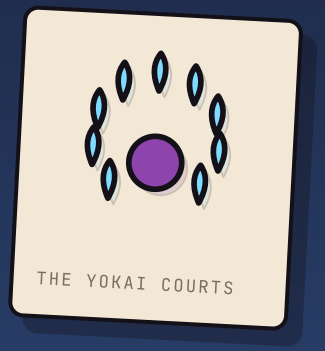


HYAKKI

Act I · Japanese folklore · ukiyo-e + painted night

ACT	Act I
INSPIRED BY	Japanese folklore (yokai, tsukumogami, the Seven Lucky Gods, Enma); ukiyo-e and Edo-period towns.
LAW OF THE LAND	The Rule of Shi and Ku: 4 and 9 are cursed; 7 is blessed
AUDITOR	Tamamo, the Nine-Tailed Auditor
KEEPER	Enma
ENEMIES	Kasa-obake · Chōchin-obake · Kappa · Oni enforcers
LITTLE THINGS	daruma dolls with one eye painted; beckoning cats; fireflies; wind chimes; one tired kappa selling cucumbers.
SOUND	shamisen, shakuhachi, taiko for battle, cicadas and wind chimes.
MERIDIAN INTRUSION	a Ledgerist toll gate on the shrine road; Collectors in the harbour.





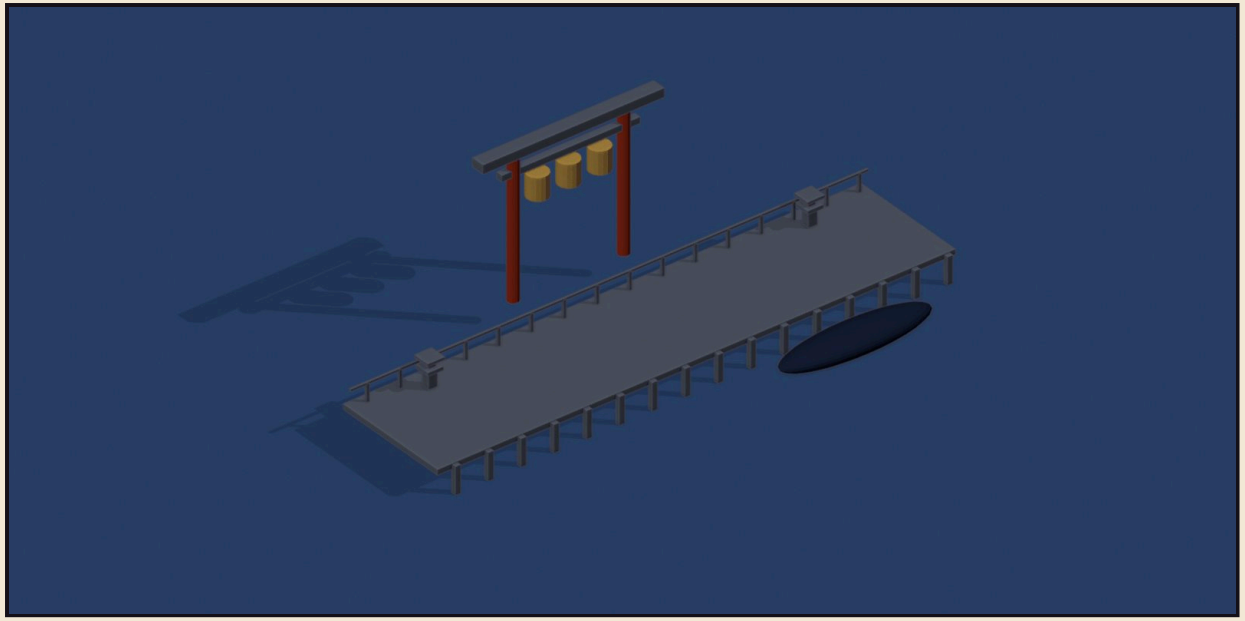
Indigo	Ink blue	Paper	Vermilion	Lantern gold	Firefly
#1B2440	#2E4A7A	#F2E6C9	#E34234	#F2B33D	#9BD15A

ART NEEDED · Hyakki paintings

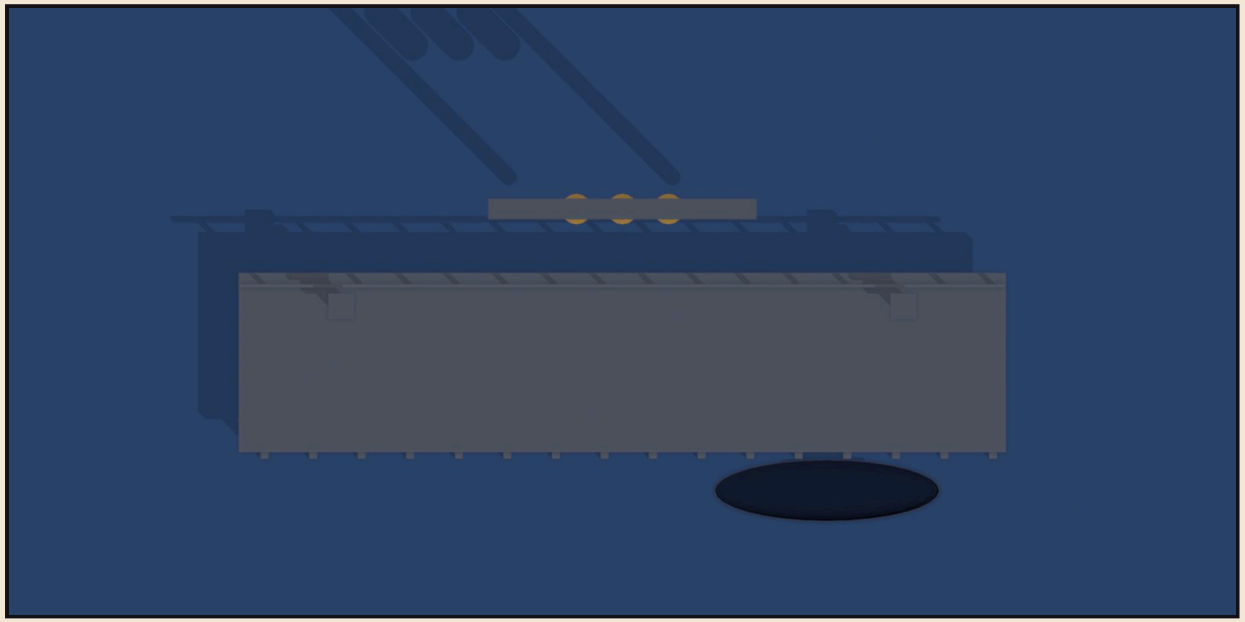
- Establishing: the Moon Pier at night
- The Night Parade crossing the red bridge
- Shrine of the Seven Lucky Gods; Tamamo's foxfire palace

COLOUR SCRIPT

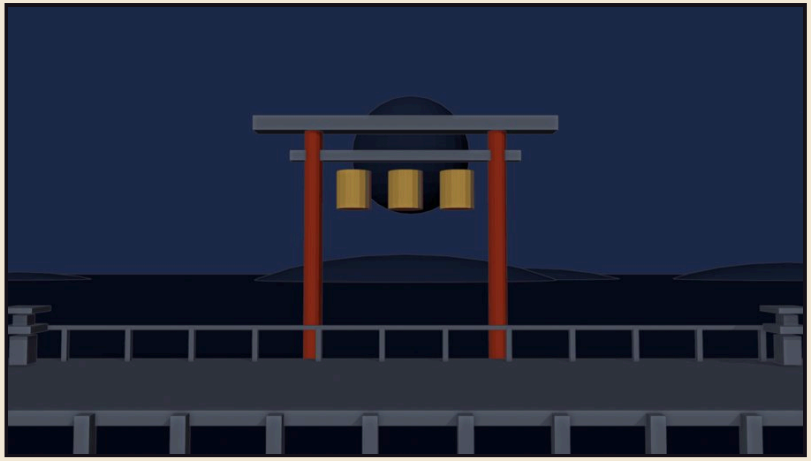
HYAKKI · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

ACT I · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

TIME	Summer night, full moon
KEY LIGHT	Lantern gold
FILL	Indigo moonlight
ATMOSPHERE	Mist over water, fireflies

First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

HYAKKI · MOON PIER

Volcanic islands where humans and yokai share festivals. The pier is where the party lands: lanterns, fireflies, and the Night Parade crossing the far ridge. Its deck is the Act I battle floor; the torii's three lanterns are the reel.

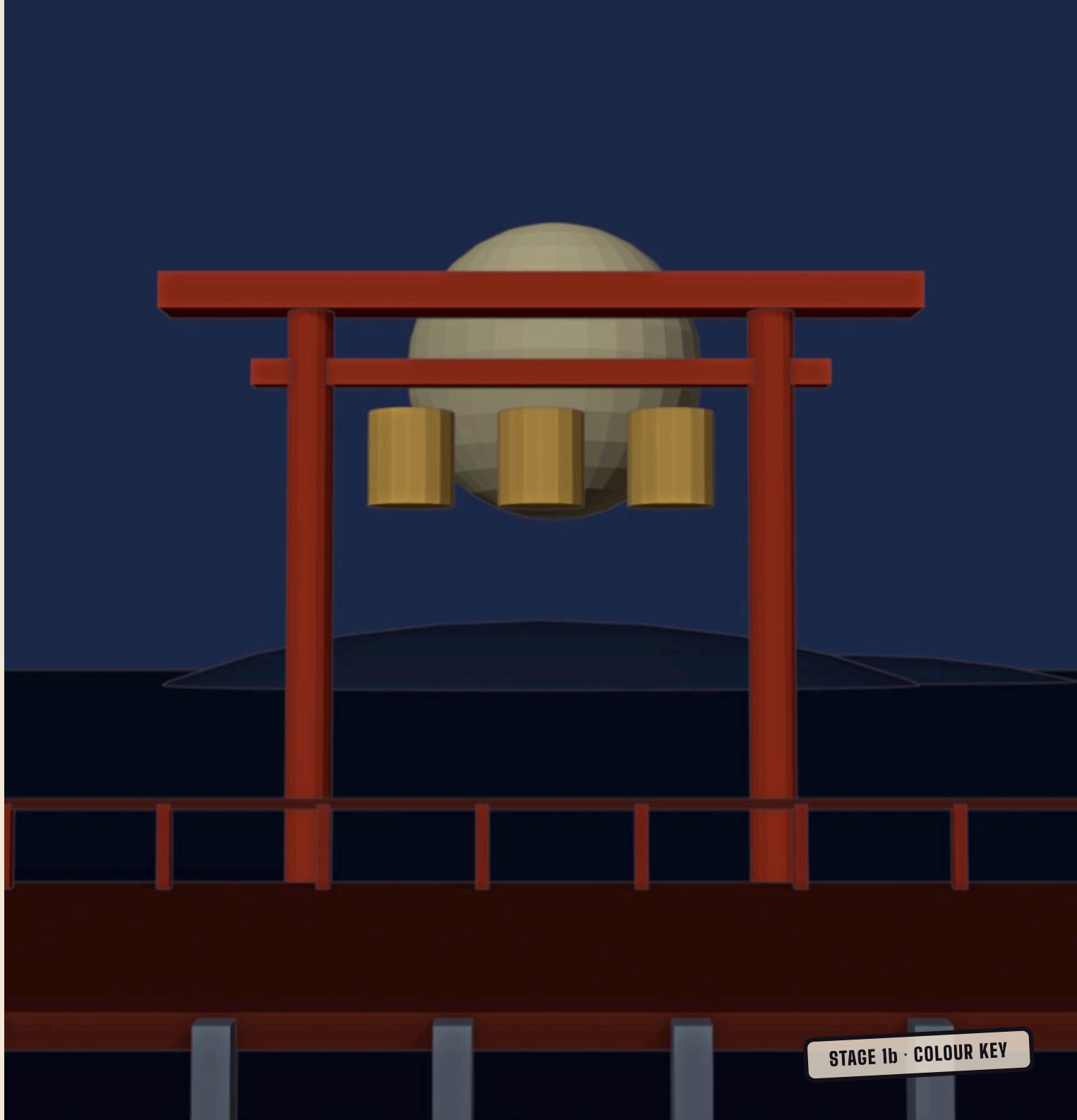
Meridian intrusion: a Ledgerist toll gate on the shrine road.



KEY · MOON PIER

Colour key: indigo night, vermilion torii, lantern gold, moon cream. The paint pass adds mist, fireflies, sea glints and the Night Parade on the ridge, and keeps the deck clear for the fight.

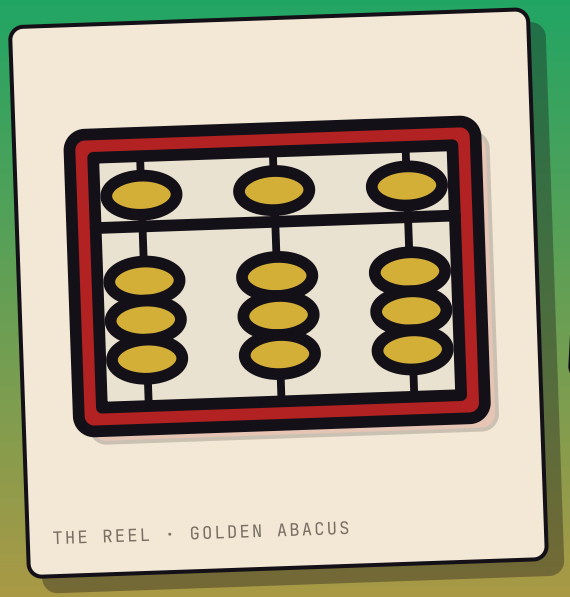
Pipeline stage 1b · colour key over the 3D base on the pipeline page.



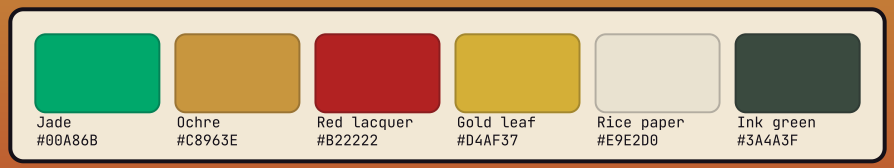
THE RIVER EMPIRE

Act II · Chinese folk religion · gongbi gold + ink-wash underworld

ACT	Act II
INSPIRED BY	Chinese folk religion, festival culture and river trade.
LAW OF THE LAND	The Rule of Interest: luck compounds
AUDITOR	Chancellor Jin Chan, the Golden Toad
KEEPER	Judge Cui
ENEMIES	Abacus Golems · Debt Junks · Golden Koi · Ox-Head & Horse-Face · Hungry Ghosts · Jiangshi
LITTLE THINGS	red envelopes, mahjong tables, dragon boats, joss paper drifting into the river, lucky 8s on every price tag.
SOUND	erhu, guzheng, firecrackers, abacus clicks; the underworld is silent except for brush strokes.
MERIDIAN INTRUSION	the Exchange is half Basilica office, half temple.





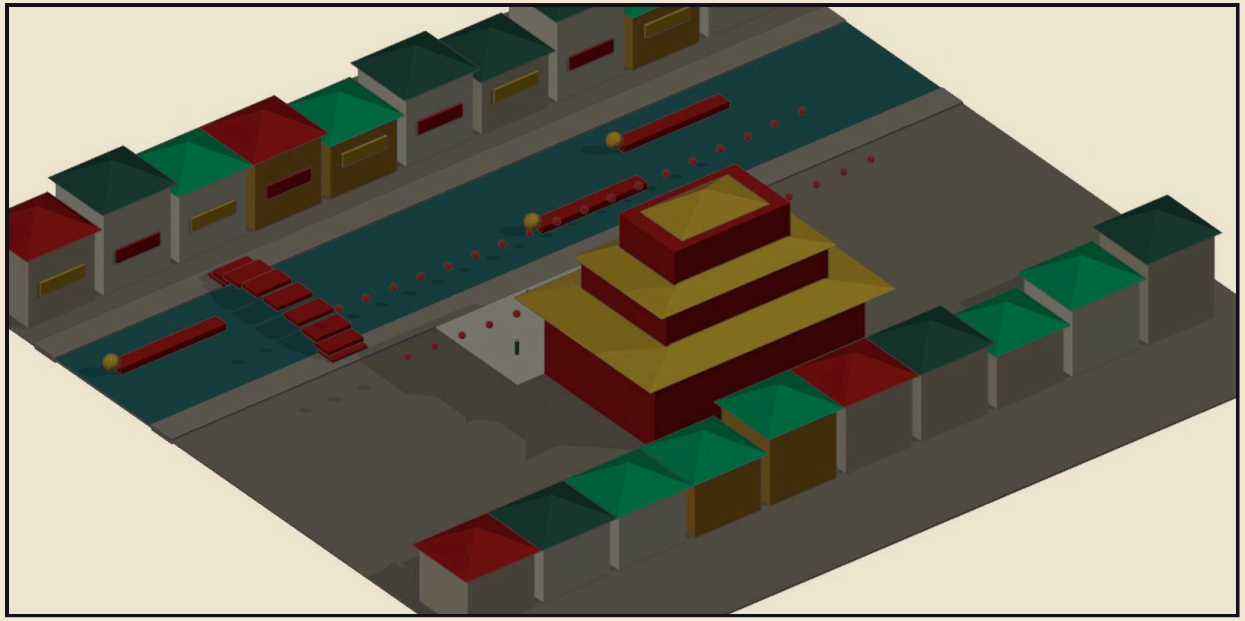


ART NEEDED · The River Empire paintings

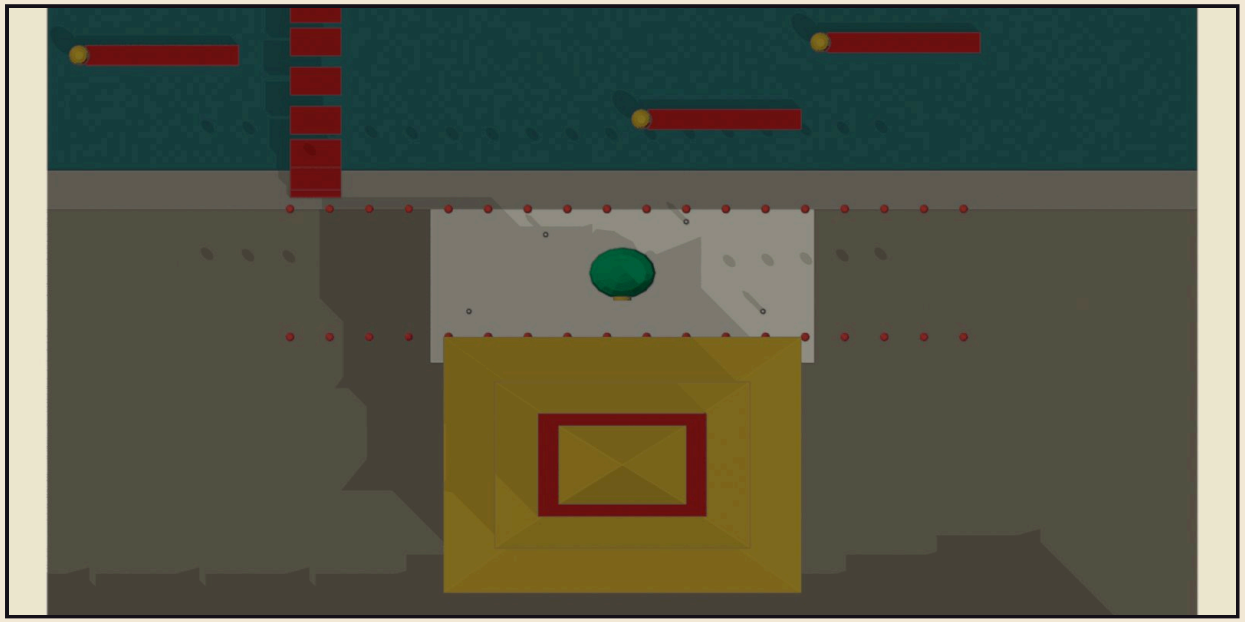
- Establishing: Bāfā Harbor at the Lantern Festival
- The Luck Exchange's live Omen boards
- The Ten Courts in ink-wash; Naihe Bridge

COLOUR SCRIPT

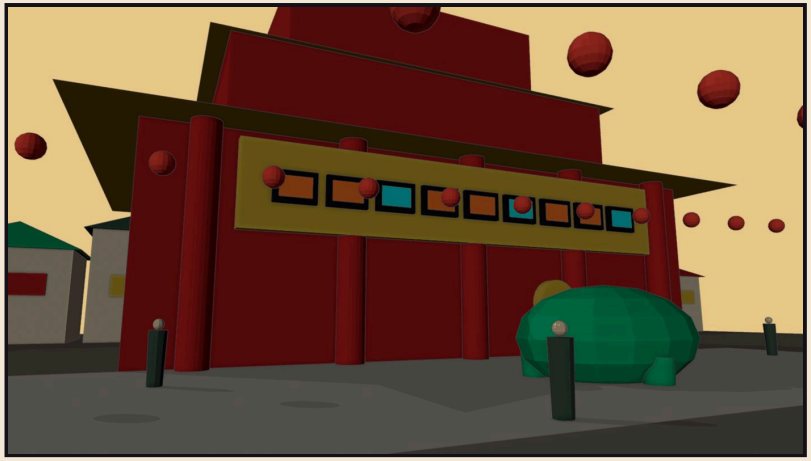
THE RIVER EMPIRE · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

ACT II · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

TIME	Golden afternoon (harbor) / misty dark (Courts)
KEY LIGHT	Low sun
FILL	Jade bounce
ATMOSPHERE	Incense, lantern smoke

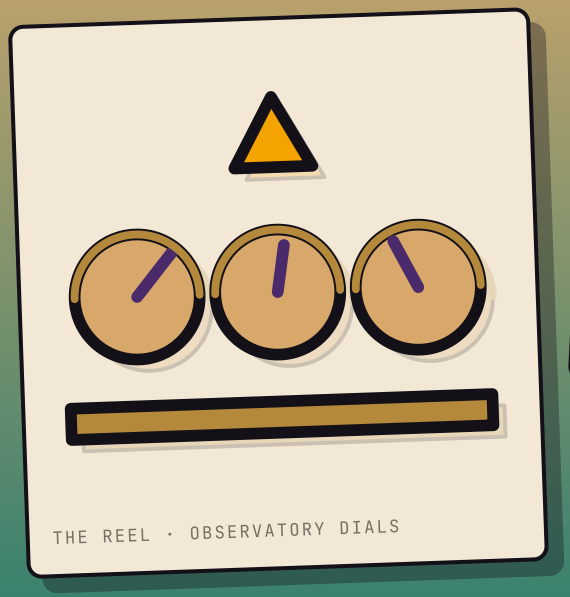
First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

ŚŪNYAPURA

Act III · Indian myth & mathematics · miniature painting + monsoon light

ACT	Act III
INSPIRED BY	Indian mythology, astronomy and mathematics; stepwells; open-air stone observatories.
LAW OF THE LAND	The Rule of Karma: every action is recorded and returns
AUDITOR	Rahu & Ketu, the Eclipse
KEEPER	Chitragupta
ENEMIES	Vetālas · Brass Yantra Guardians · Monsoon Nāgas
LITTLE THINGS	a lemon and seven chillies over every door; rangoli patterns; chai stalls; pigeons; monsoon puddles mirroring the instruments.
SOUND	sitar, tabla, temple bells, rain on stone.
MERIDIAN INTRUSION	Basilica surveyors re-measuring the observatory's numbers.





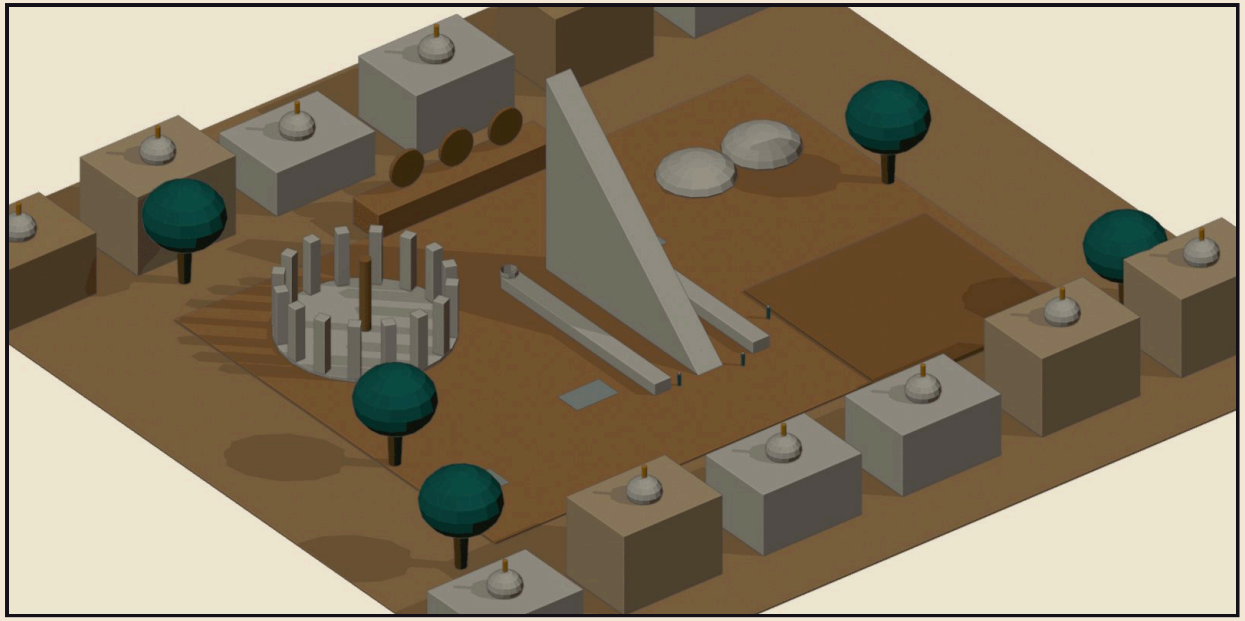
Sandstone #D8A86B
Peacock #1E7B6F
Saffron #F4A300
Indigo #3F3D99
Brass #B5893B
Eclipse #4B2A6B

ART NEEDED · Śūnyapura paintings

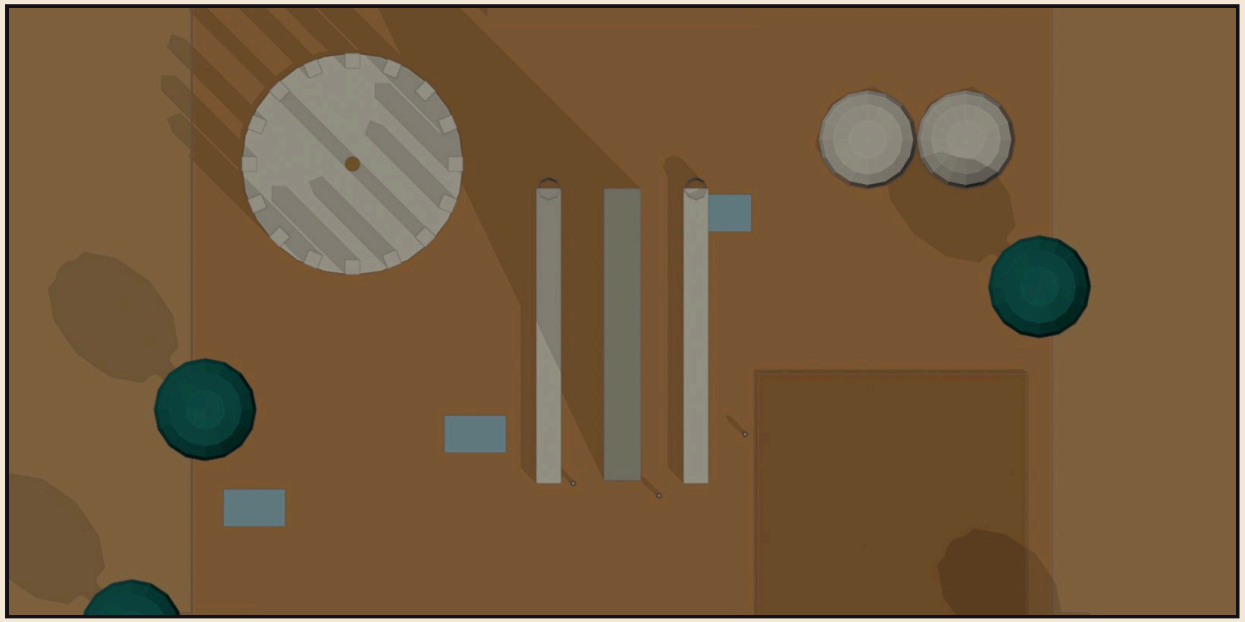
- Establishing: the Great Observatory in monsoon light
- The Stepwell of a Thousand Steps
- Chitragupta's Hall of palm-leaf records

COLOUR SCRIPT

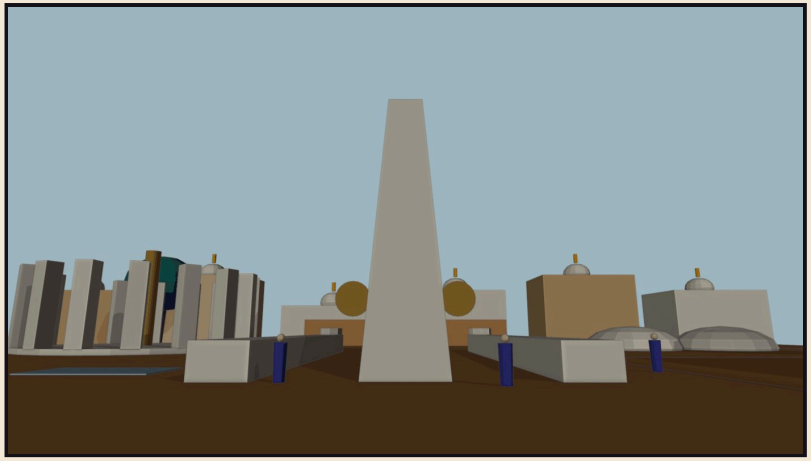
ŚŪNYAPURA · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

ACT III · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

TIME	Monsoon break
KEY LIGHT	Sun through cloud
FILL	Wet sandstone bounce
ATMOSPHERE	Rain sheets, puddle mirrors

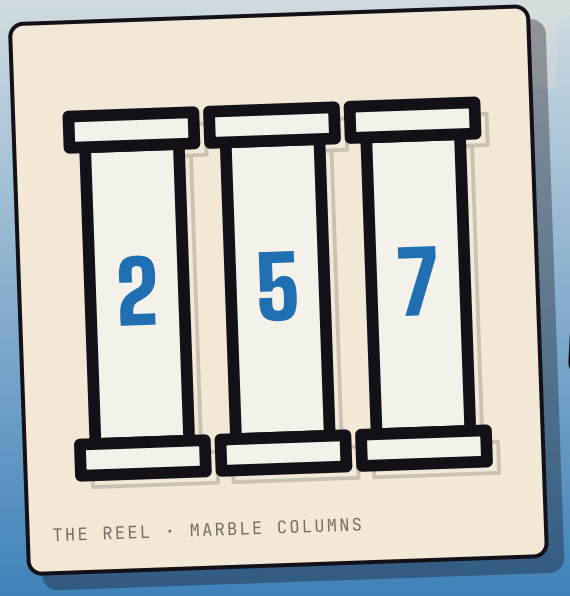
First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

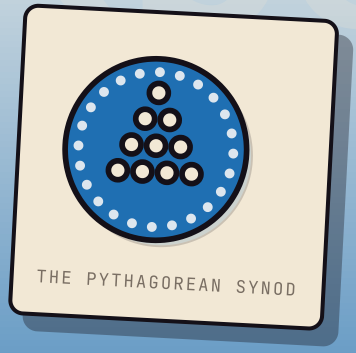
STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

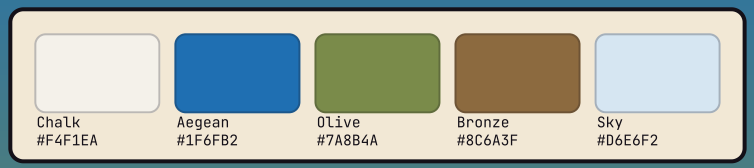
KROTON NOVA

Act IV · Greek myth · marble, mosaic, Aegean noon

ACT	Act IV
INSPIRED BY	Greek mythology and Pythagorean number mysticism.
LAW OF THE LAND	The Rule of Indivisibility: only primes pass
AUDITOR	Archon Seventeen
KEEPER	the Moirai
ENEMIES	Bronze Automata · Harpies · Composite Knights · Sirens
LITTLE THINGS	blue evil-eye beads; olive trees; goats on the terraces; mosaics of numbers.
SOUND	lyre, bouzouki, waves, chanting of primes.
MERIDIAN INTRUSION	the undercity of the "composite" people built from Basilica scrap.





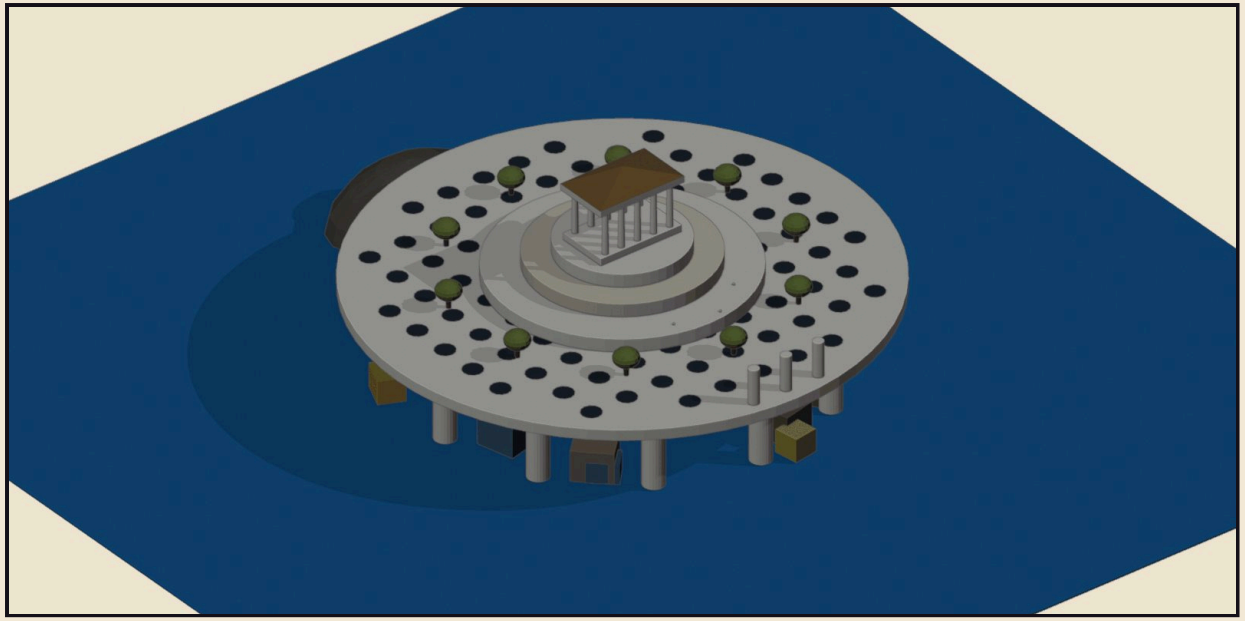


ART NEEDED · Kroton Nova paintings

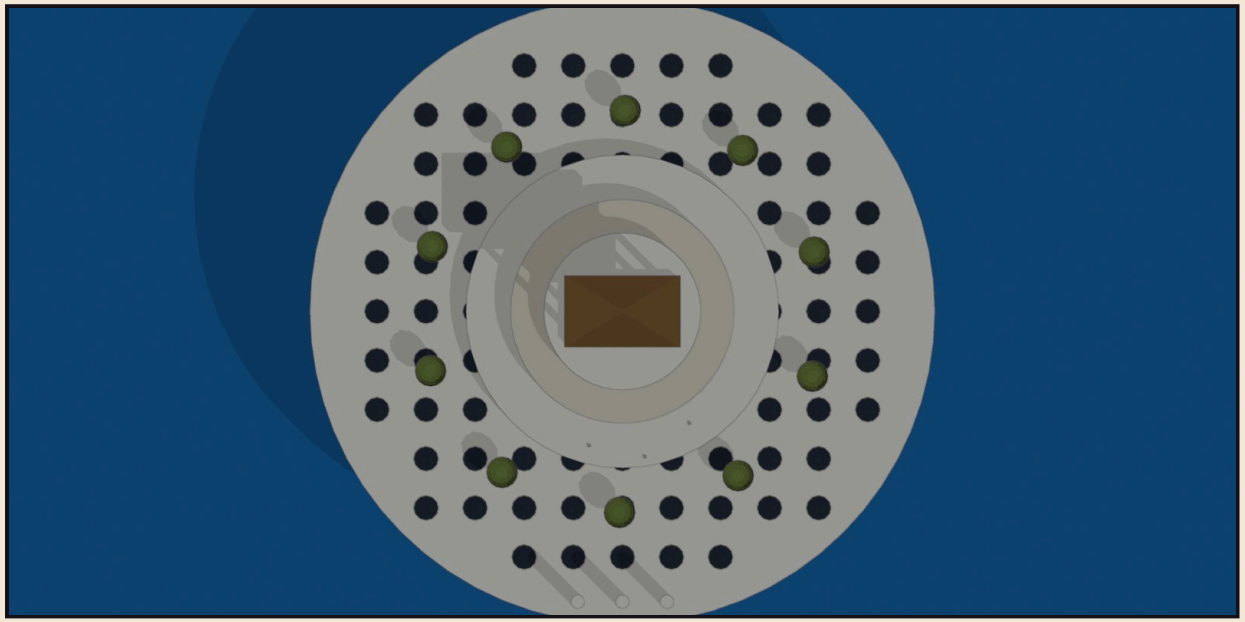
- Establishing: the white Sieve city at noon
- The undercity of the fallen under the Sieve
- The Moirai's cave

COLOUR SCRIPT

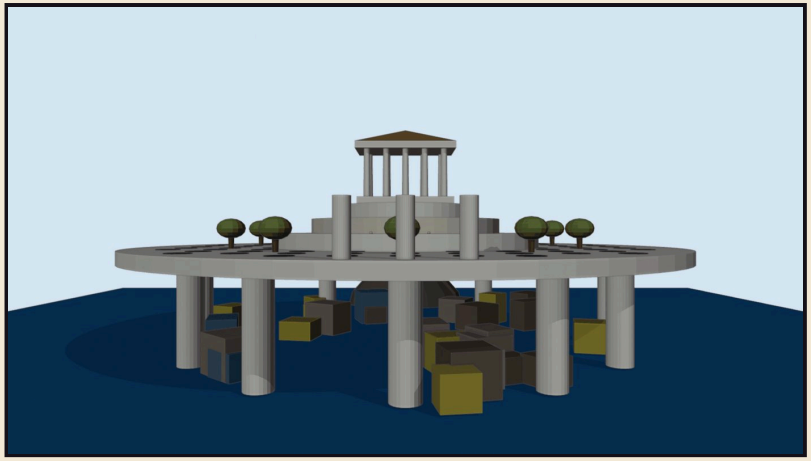
KROTON NOVA · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

ACT IV · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

TIME	Hard noon
KEY LIGHT	White sun
FILL	Aegean sky blue
ATMOSPHERE	Heat haze, sharp shadows

First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

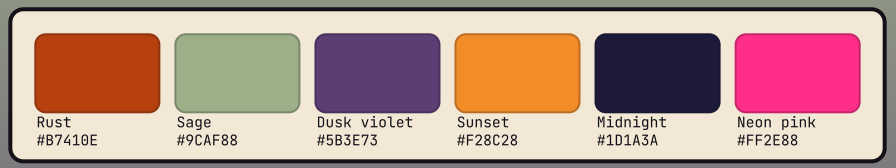
THE CROSSROADS TERRITORY

Act V · American folklore · desert sunset + casino neon

ACT	Act V
INSPIRED BY	American folklore: frontier tall tales, the blues crossroads legend, immigrant charms, desert highways and casinos.
LAW OF THE LAND	The Rule of the House: the night loops; every deal has a price
AUDITOR	The House (Octavian Nine)
KEEPER	the Stranger
ENEMIES	the Headless Horseman · Card-Sharp Automata · Tumbleweed Golems · the Ghost Train
LITTLE THINGS	horseshoes over doors (open end up); rabbit's-foot keychains; lucky pennies on the railway; diners; neon cacti.
SOUND	slide guitar, harmonica, a slot-machine choir, coyotes.
MERIDIAN INTRUSION	the casino is financed by the Basilica; Collectors deal blackjack.







ART NEEDED · The Crossroads Territory paintings

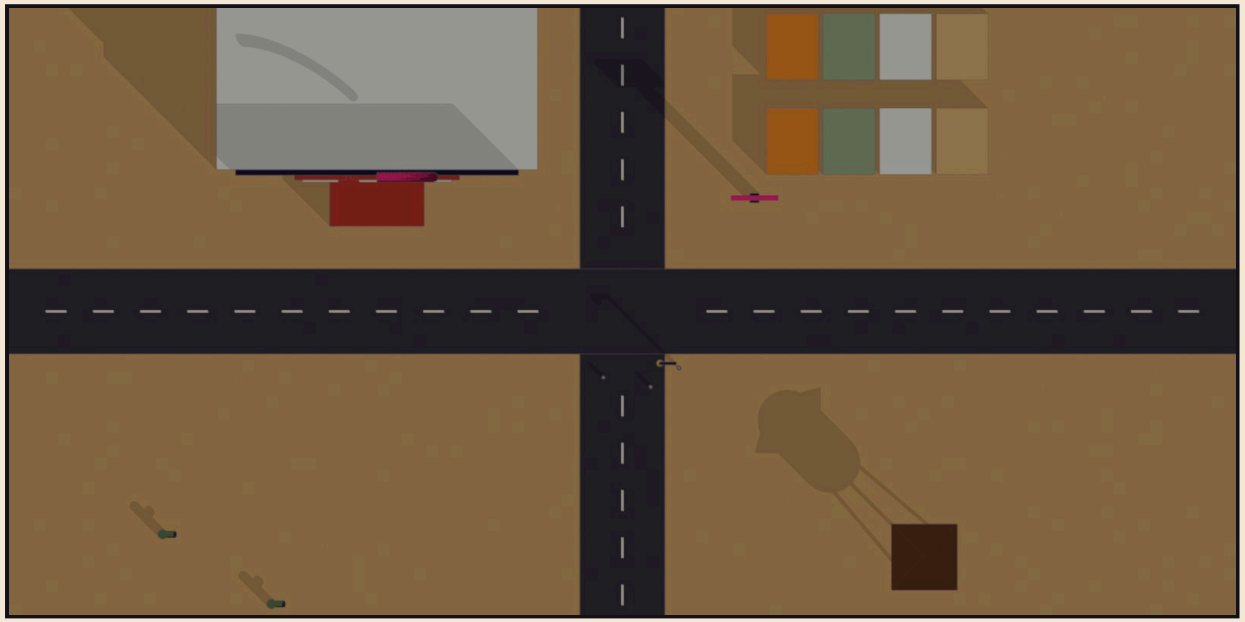
- Establishing: the midnight crossroads under one streetlamp
- Lucky Strike's casino strip, the same night repeating
- The Ghost Train

COLOUR SCRIPT

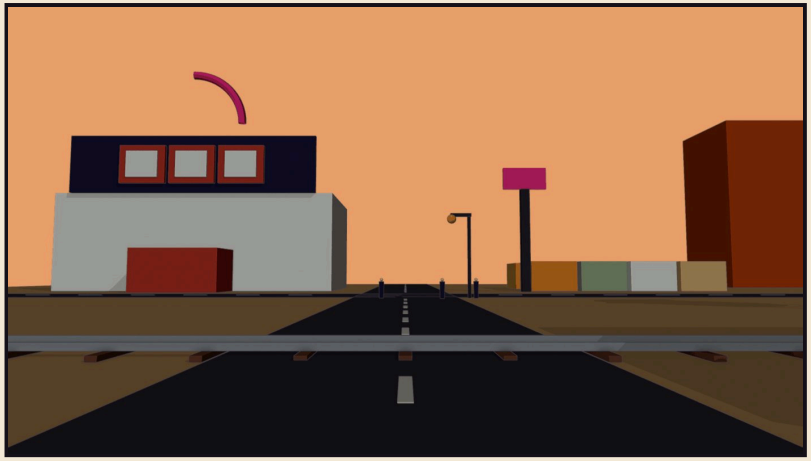
THE CROSSROADS TERRITORY · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

ACT V · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

TIME	Sunset → neon night
KEY LIGHT	Sunset orange / neon
FILL	Dusk violet
ATMOSPHERE	Dust, card storms

First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

THE BASILICA

Finale · the machine · brass and steel

ACT	Finale
INSPIRED BY	a cosmopolitan modern capital; the immigrant quarters of every great port city.
LAW OF THE LAND	Fixed Fate
AUDITOR	Comptroller Lucan Thale
ENEMIES	every Auditor's echo
LITTLE THINGS	charms of every culture over every door; laundry between tenements; balcony gardens (a garden is luck you can see); cats; hand-painted lucky numbers.
SOUND	rain, Nixie hum, distant Dawn Tally bells, street musicians, Collector sirens.





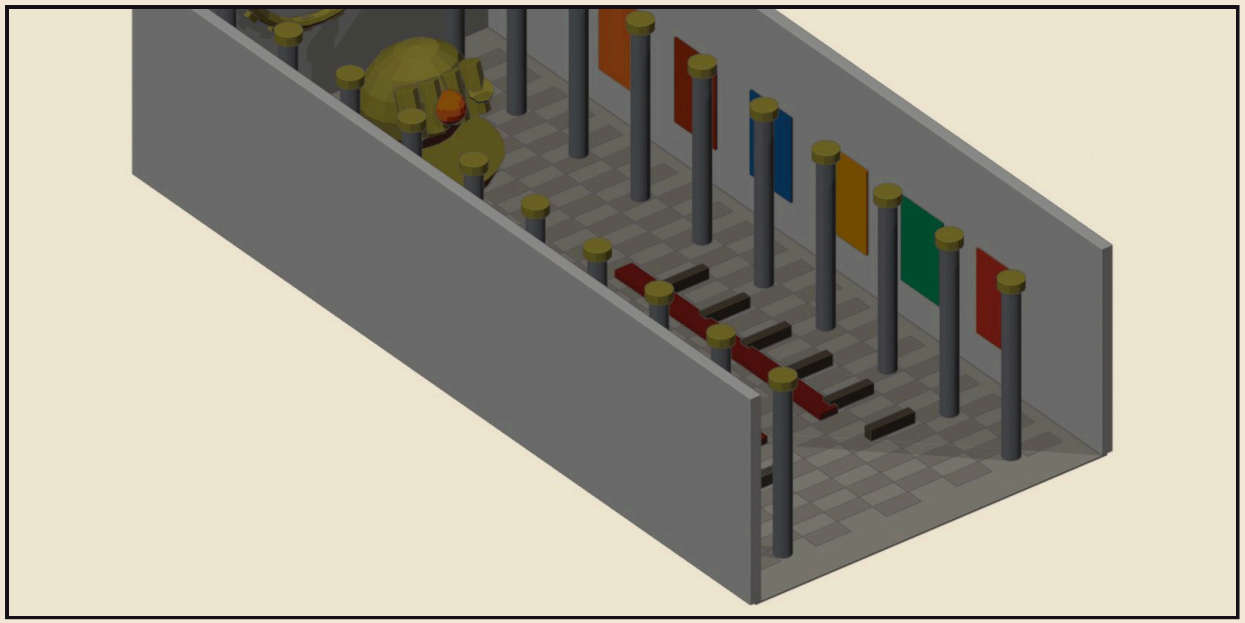


ART NEEDED · The Basilica paintings

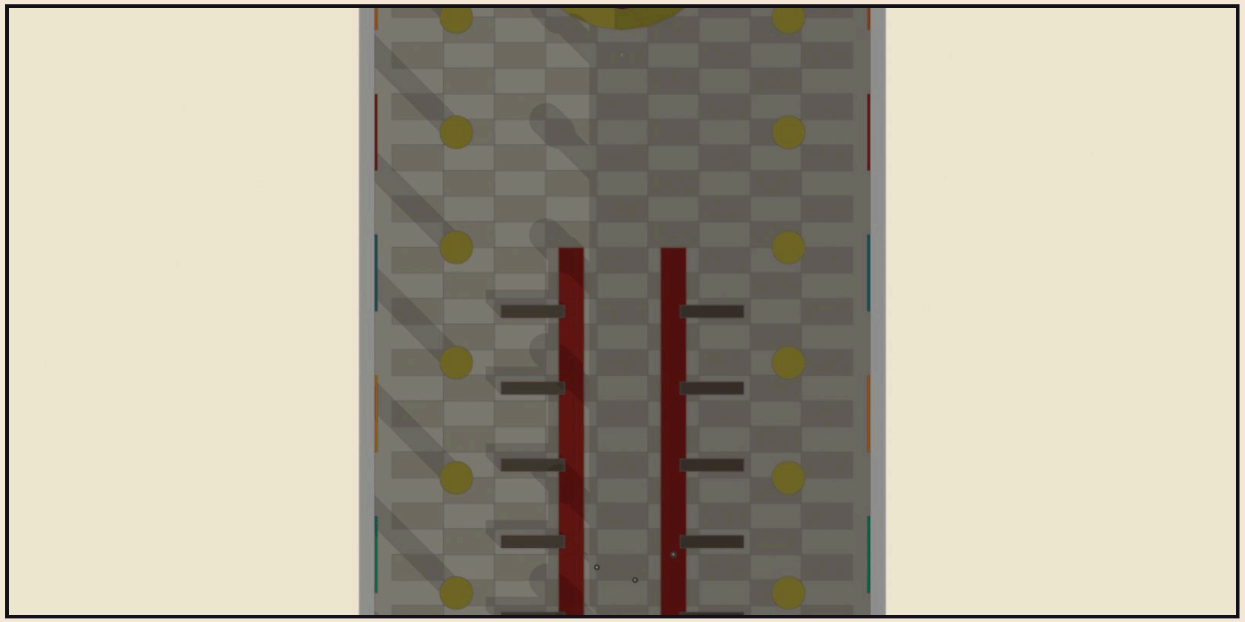
- Keyframe: the Basilica nave, every land's ledger on its walls
- The Upper Gate with seven Seal Digits
- Thale's three phases as one sequence

COLOUR SCRIPT

THE BASILICA · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

FINALE · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

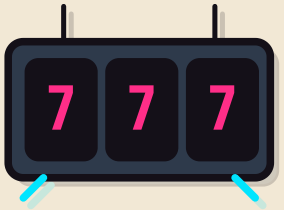
TIME	Interior, no sun
KEY LIGHT	Nixie amber
FILL	Brass bounce
ATMOSPHERE	Still air, motes

First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

THE REEL, LAND BY LAND

The three slots where stopped digits land are always an object from the world, never a UI panel (GDD §8). Same three digits, seven cultures.



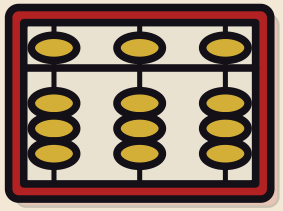
Neon sign

Meridian Undercity



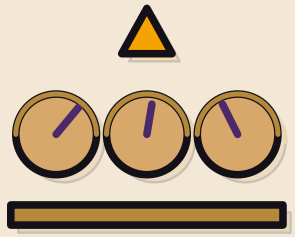
Torii with three lanterns

Hyakki



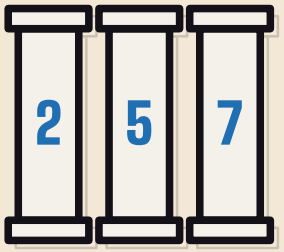
Golden abacus

The River Empire



Observatory dials

Śūnyapura



Marble columns

Kroton Nova



Slot machine

The Crossroads Territory



The Basilica clock

The Basilica

PART IV

THE CAST

Every character, outfit, boss, keeper, story character and faction archetype as a first-draft 3D model, front, left, right and back at one scale.

1. Main character
2. Companions
3. Secret recruits
4. Bosses
5. Keepers
6. The god of luck
7. Story characters
8. Factions and jobs

CAST · READABILITY

Every character must read as a solid black silhouette at 64 px and by colour alone (Character Bible §0). Shared scale, true relative heights: heroes on top, Auditors below.





NIL
Player's choice



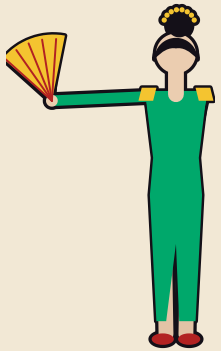
Vesper Sette
7



Maeve Triskel
3



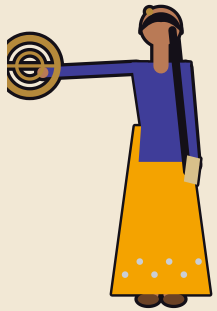
Hina
9



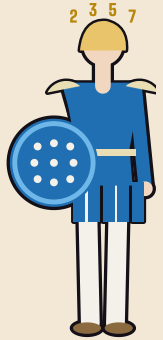
Ba Jinling
8



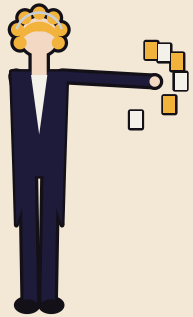
Bai Si
4



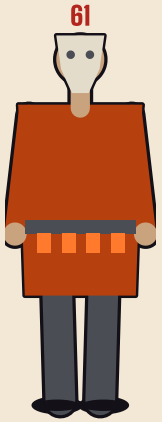
Shunya
0



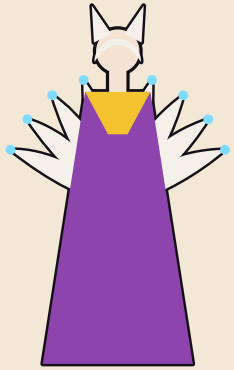
Prima
2



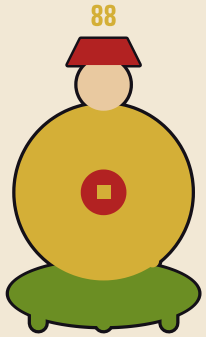
Fibi Leone
Fibonacci



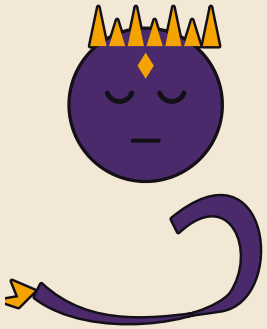
Varro Kade
61



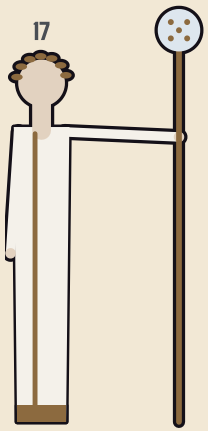
Tamamo
Nine tails



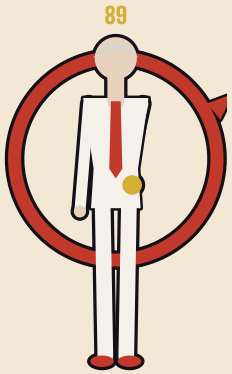
Jin Chan
88



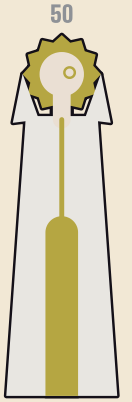
Rahu & Ketu
Eclipse



Archon Seventeen
17



The House
89



Lucan Thale
50 (steel)


KEYFRAME · NIL
NAN?
PLACEHOLDER · PASS 1 ART

NIL · OUTFITS

The main character's four story outfits, front and back at one scale. Each gets a full turnaround on its own page.



Wanderer's coat (default, Prologue onward)

Long asymmetric black actuary's coat (left tail longer), high collar, three brass ledger clasps on the right, fingerless gloves, slim trousers, tall boots. Cracked brass decoder fused into the RIGHT wrist. Broken holographic NaN halo.



Remainder rags (intro, Rain Alley 9)

Hooded ash-grey poncho patched with Remainder scrap over black clothes; a satchel; the decoder wrapped in rag. The coat is earned later (Vesper buys it in Act I).



Night Parade disguise (Act I, Hyakki)

An indigo festival robe borrowed from the parade, worn over the black coat; a paper fox mask pushed to the side of the head; a hand lantern.



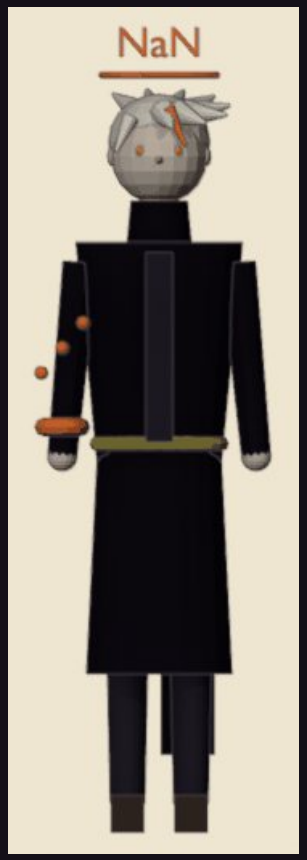
The Open Hand (finale,

The coat turned inside out: i
every land's ledger in gold th
The halo resolves into the pl

THE CAST

MAIN CHARACTER

4 models · front views at one shared scale.



Wanderer's coat



Remainder rags

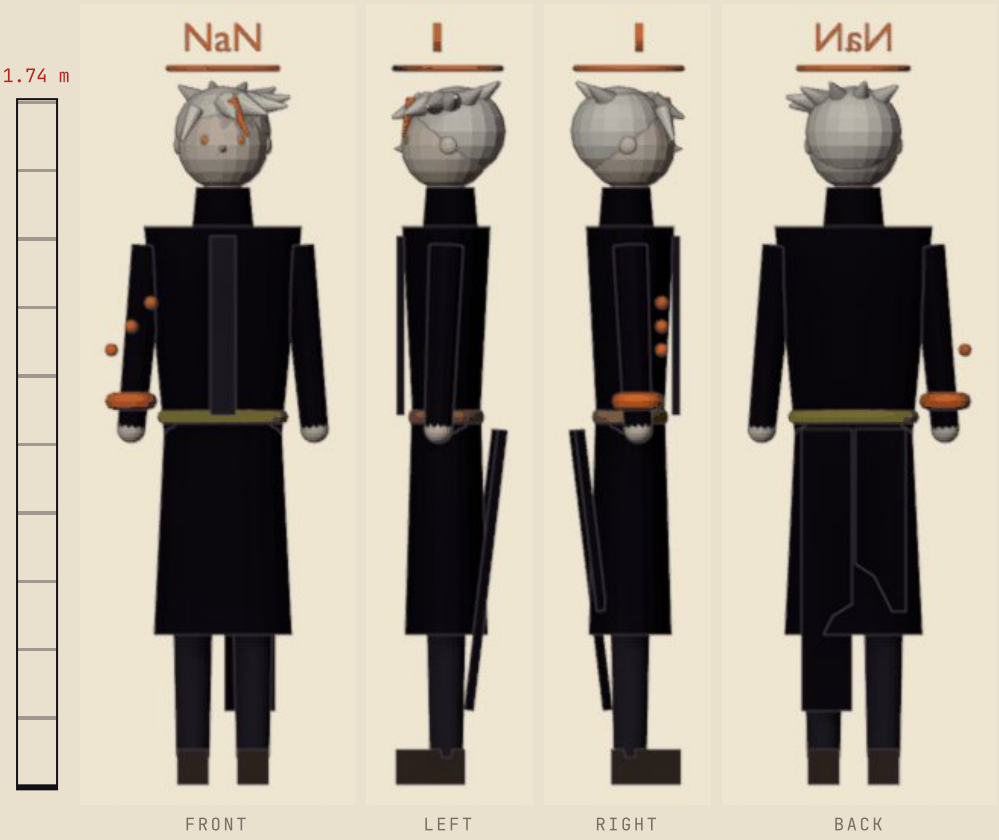


Night Parade disguise



The Open Hand

MAIN CHARACTER NIL



Ink

Nixie
#FF7A2C

Bone
#EDE6DA

Brass
#B5A642

GROUP	Main character
OUTFIT	Wanderer's coat (default, Prologue onward)
ROLE	Protagonist · the Remainder
LAND	Meridian Undercity
LUCKY DIGIT	player's choice
OMEN	NaN
HEIGHT	1.74 m

DESIGN

Long asymmetric black actuary's coat (left tail longer), high collar, three brass ledger clasps on the right, fingerless gloves, slim trousers, tall boots. Cracked brass decoder fused into the RIGHT wrist. Broken holographic NaN halo.

PROPS

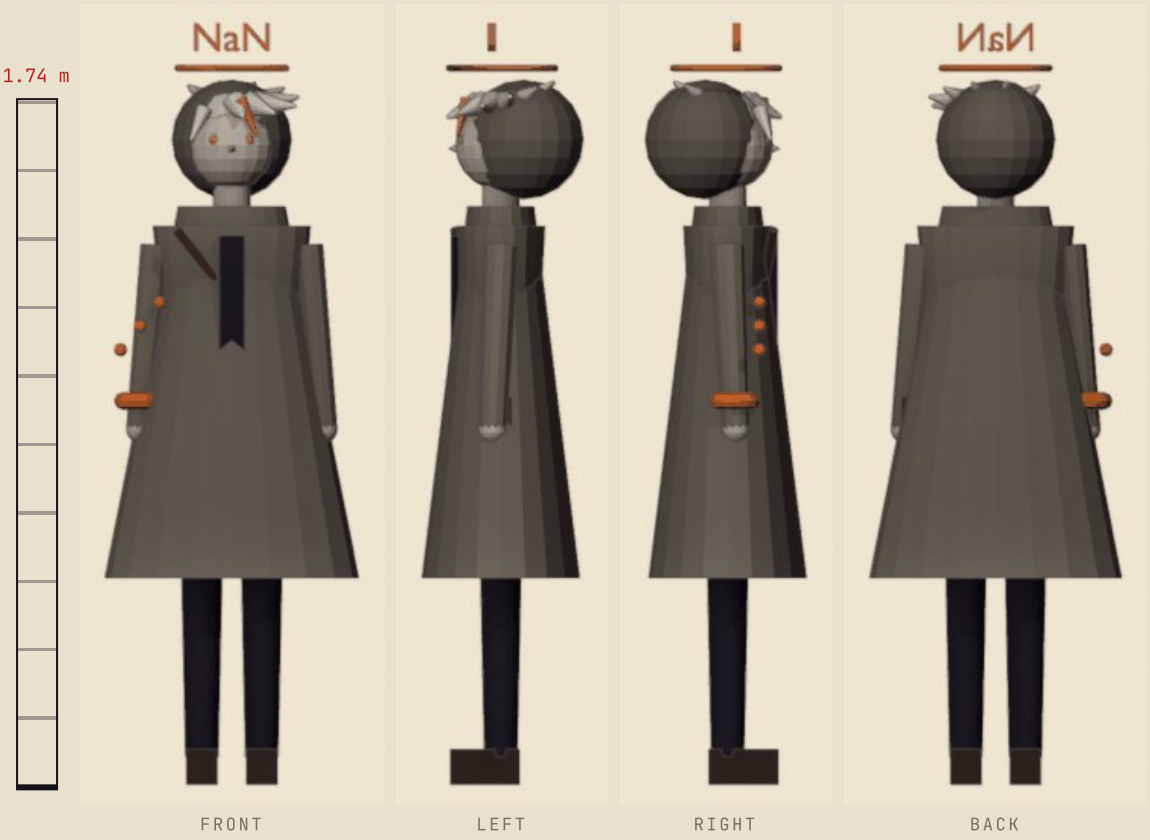
Cracked brass decoder fused into the right wrist; leaks orange light and tiny floating digits when emotional

CANON LOCKS

- Decoder on the RIGHT wrist
- One orange streak in white hair
- Halo reads exactly "NaN"
- Coat's left tail is longer
- Amber eyes

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

MAIN CHARACTER NIL



Ash
#8A7F72

Ink
#141018

Nixie
#FF7A2C

GROUP	Main character
OUTFIT	Remainder rags (intro, Rain Alley 9)
ROLE	Protagonist · first appearance
LAND	Meridian Undercity
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	NaN
HEIGHT	1.74 m

DESIGN

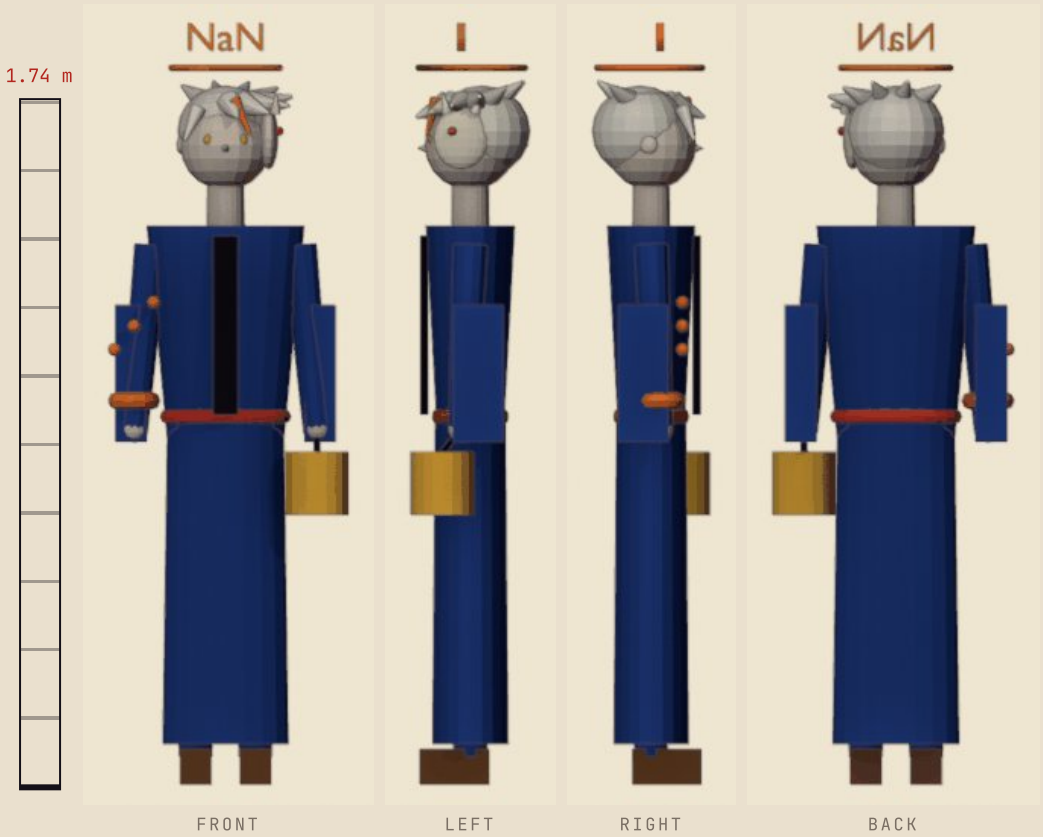
Hooded ash-grey poncho patched with Remainder scrap over black clothes; a satchel; the decoder wrapped in rag. The coat is earned later (Vesper buys it in Act I).

CANON LOCKS

- Hood up until the Naming Rite
- Decoder visible under the rag

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

MAIN CHARACTER NIL



Indigo #26428B

Vermilion #E34234

Paper #F2E6C9

GROUP	Main character
OUTFIT	Night Parade disguise (Act I, Hyakki)
ROLE	Protagonist · festival disguise
LAND	Hyakki
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	NaN
HEIGHT	1.74 m

DESIGN

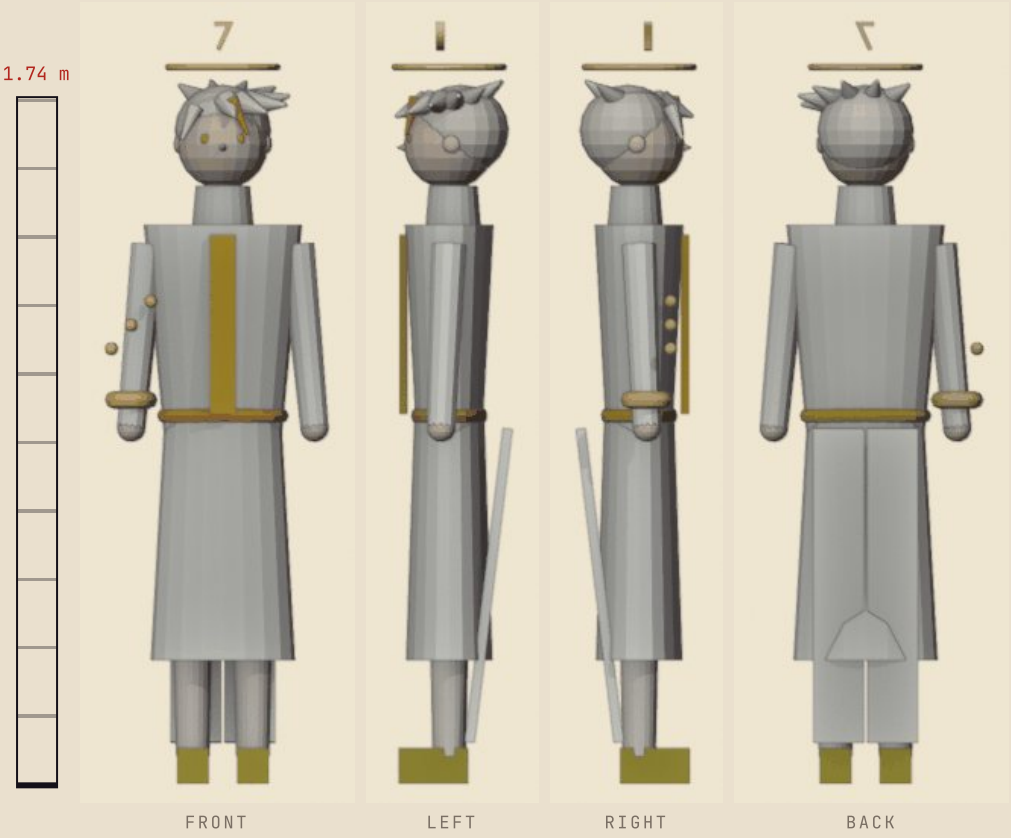
An indigo festival robe borrowed from the parade, worn over the black coat; a paper fox mask pushed to the side of the head; a hand lantern.

CANON LOCKS

- The NaN still shows: the disguise hides the face, never the halo

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

MAIN CHARACTER NIL



Bone	#F4F1EA
Gold	#D4AF37
Nixie	#FF7A2C

GROUP	Main character
OUTFIT	The Open Hand (finale, true ending)
ROLE	Protagonist · finale
LAND	The Basilica
LUCKY DIGIT	yours
OMEN	your number
HEIGHT	1.74 m

DESIGN

The coat turned inside out: its bone-white lining embroidered with every land's ledger in gold thread. Both tails even for the first time. The halo resolves into the player's digit.

CANON LOCKS

- Only in the true ending
- The halo shows the player's chosen digit

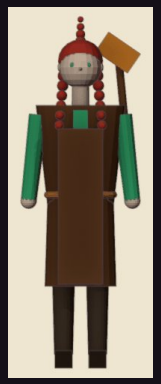
3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

THE CAST

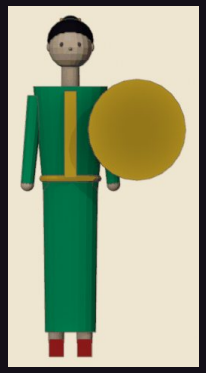
COMPANIONS

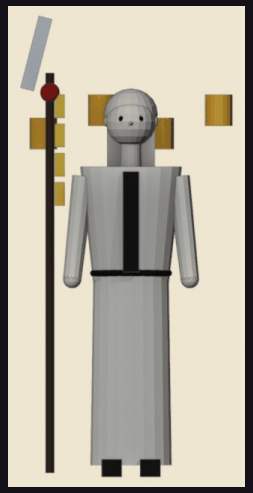
8 models · front views at one shared scale.


Vesper Sette

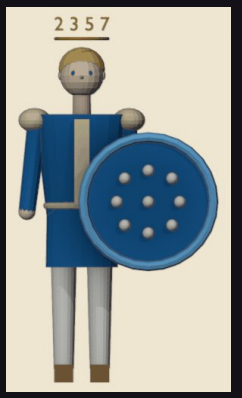

Maeve Triskel


Hina of the Ninety-Nine


Ba Jinling


Bai Si

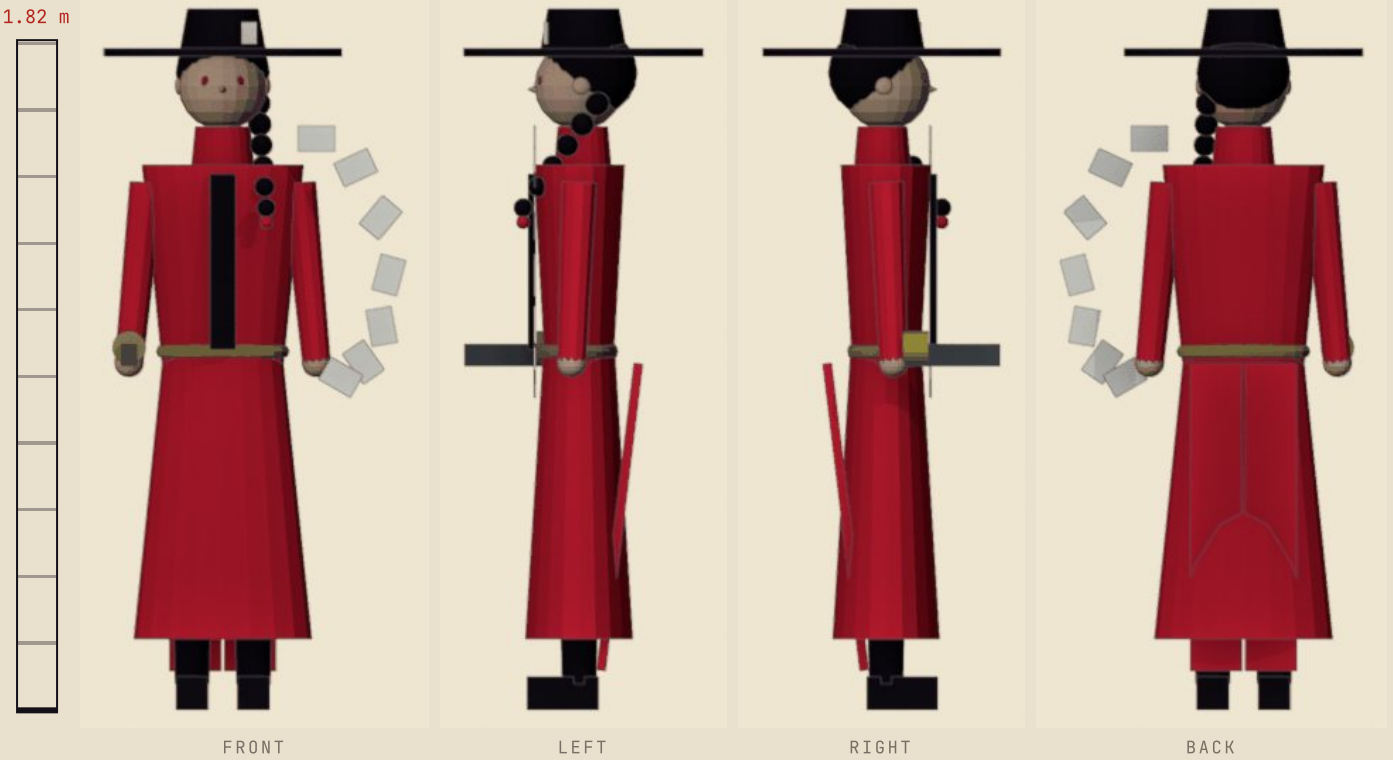

Shunya



Prima of Kroton


Fibi Leone

COMPANIONS Vesper Sette



Crimson

Black
#141018

Brass
#B5A642

Shirt
#F4F1EA

GROUP	Companions
ROLE	Gunslinger · companion
LAND	Meridian / Crossroads
LUCKY DIGIT	7
OMEN	77
HEIGHT	1.82 m

DESIGN

Wide-brim black hat with two playing cards in the band; crimson duster with triangular tails; black croupier waistcoat; white shirt, sleeves rolled; cards in her garters

PROPS

Revolver with a seven-chamber cylinder engraved 1–7; a worn silver coin she flips before every decision and ignores

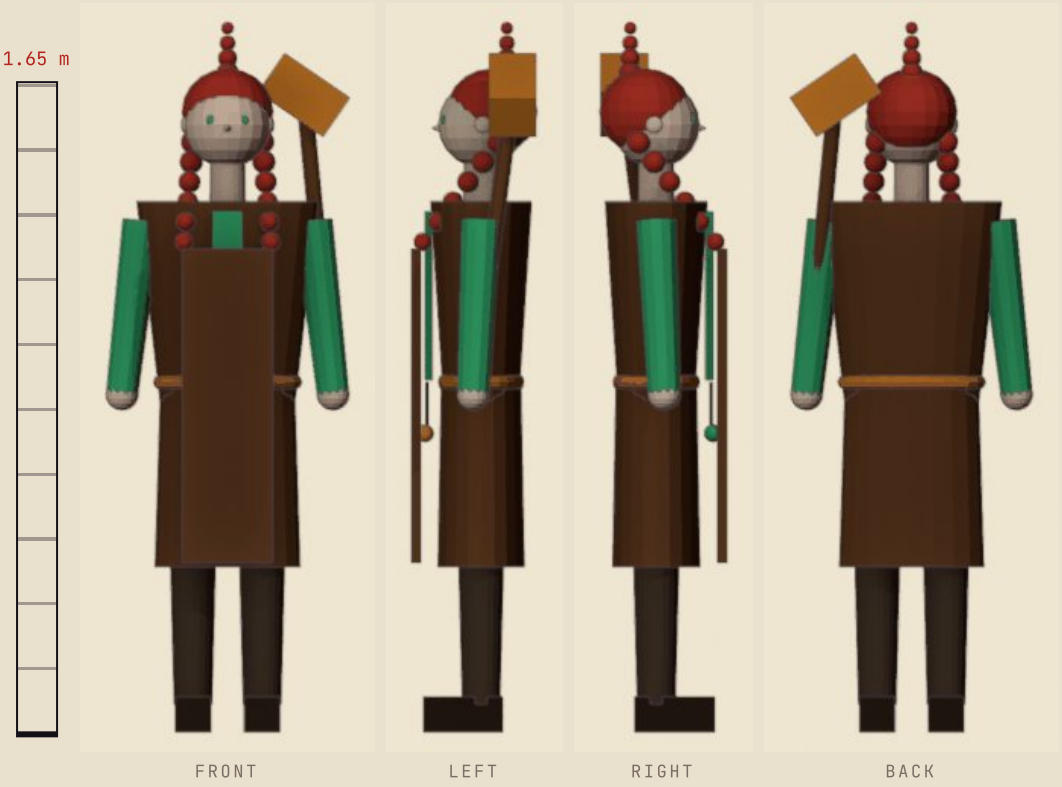
CANON LOCKS

- Exactly 7 chambers
- scar on the lip
- crimson + black + brass only
- braid over the LEFT shoulder

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS

Maeve Triskel



Copper

Clover
#3BB273

Leather
#6B4226

Red hair
#C0392B

GROUP	Companions
ROLE	Charm-smith · companion
LAND	Meridian, Celtic quarter
LUCKY DIGIT	3
OMEN	33
HEIGHT	1.65 m

DESIGN

Leather forge apron, rolled work shirt, heavy boots; red hair in three braids

PROPS

Horseshoe-knuckle gauntlets (glow copper-hot when charged); forge hammer with a triskele burned into the head; four-leaf-clover pin

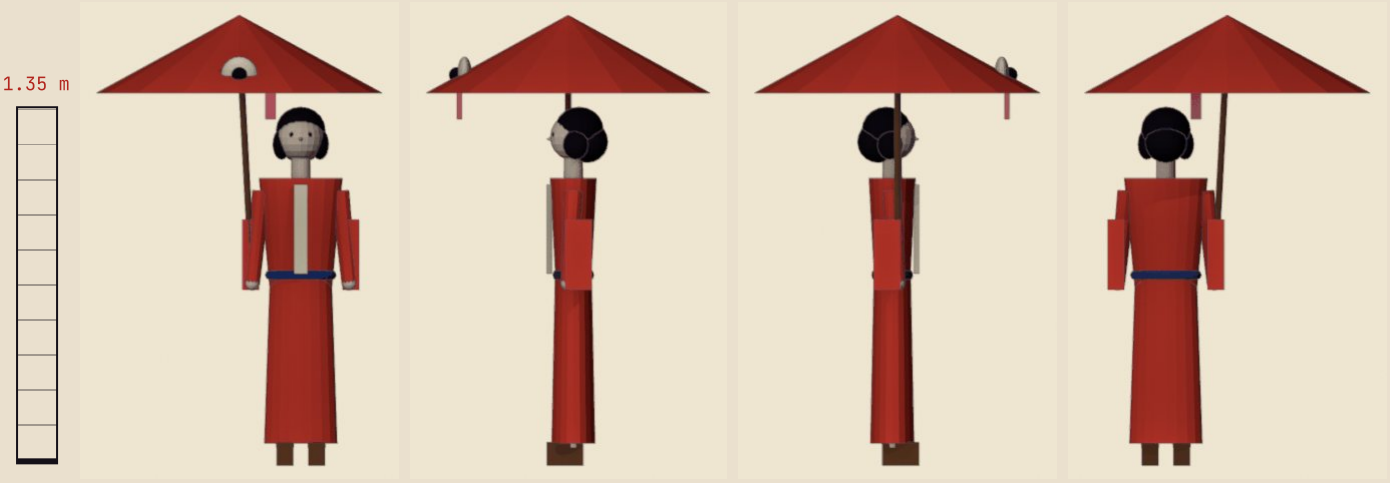
CANON LOCKS

- Exactly 3 braids
- triskele on the hammer
- clover pin on the collar

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS

Hina of the Ninety-Nine



Vermilion

Indigo
#26428B

Paper
#F2E6C9

Gold
#F2B33D

GROUP	Companions
ROLE	Tsukumogami · companion
LAND	Hyakki
LUCKY DIGIT	9
OMEN	99
HEIGHT	1.35 m

DESIGN

Furisode kimono in indigo and vermilion patterned with numbers 1–99; big obi bow; geta sandals; black bob

PROPS

Red-and-white oiled-paper umbrella with one eye and a long tongue (it's her true body; it has its own expressions)

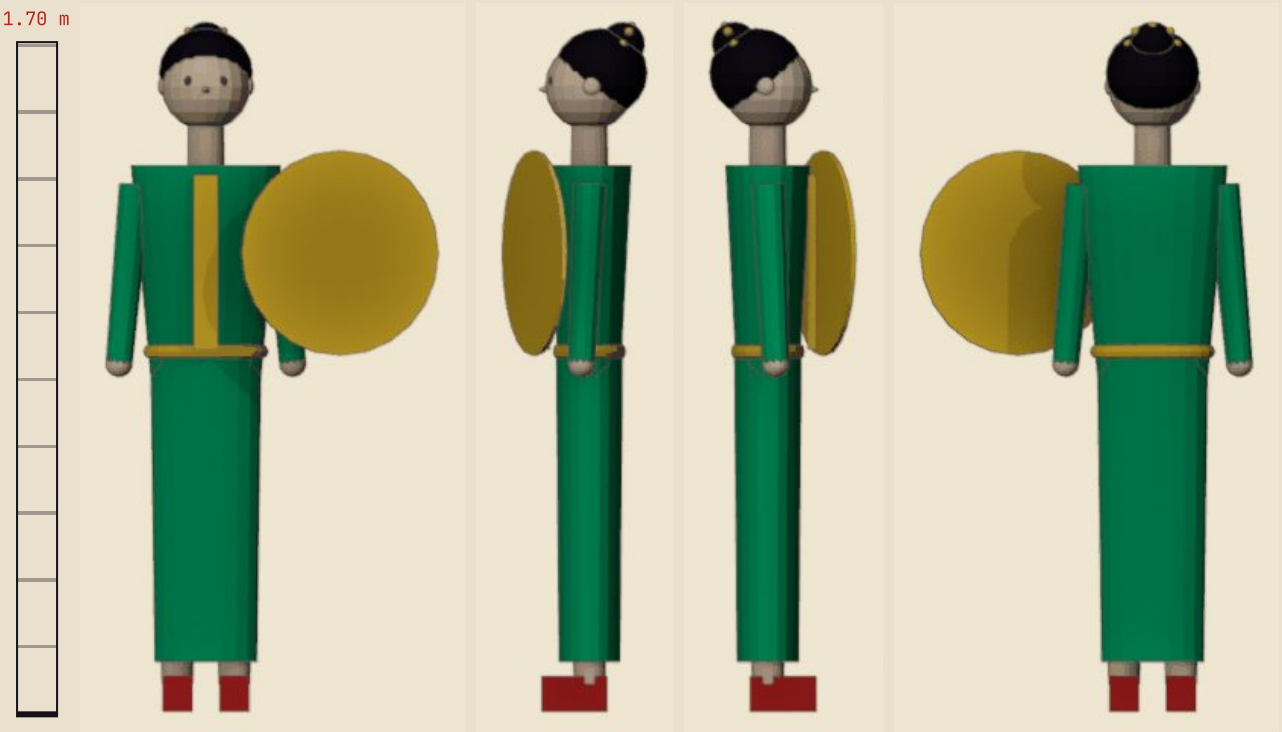
CANON LOCKS

- The umbrella has ONE eye
- kimono numbers stop at 99
- she never reaches 100 before the finale

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS

Ba Jinling



Jade

Gold
#F4C430

Lacquer
#B22222

Violet
#5D3A7A

GROUP	Companions
ROLE	Financier · companion
LAND	River Empire
LUCKY DIGIT	8
OMEN	88
HEIGHT	1.70 m

DESIGN

Modern jade-and-gold qipao with a high slit and structured shoulders; eight tiny golden bells in hair ornaments and anklets

PROPS

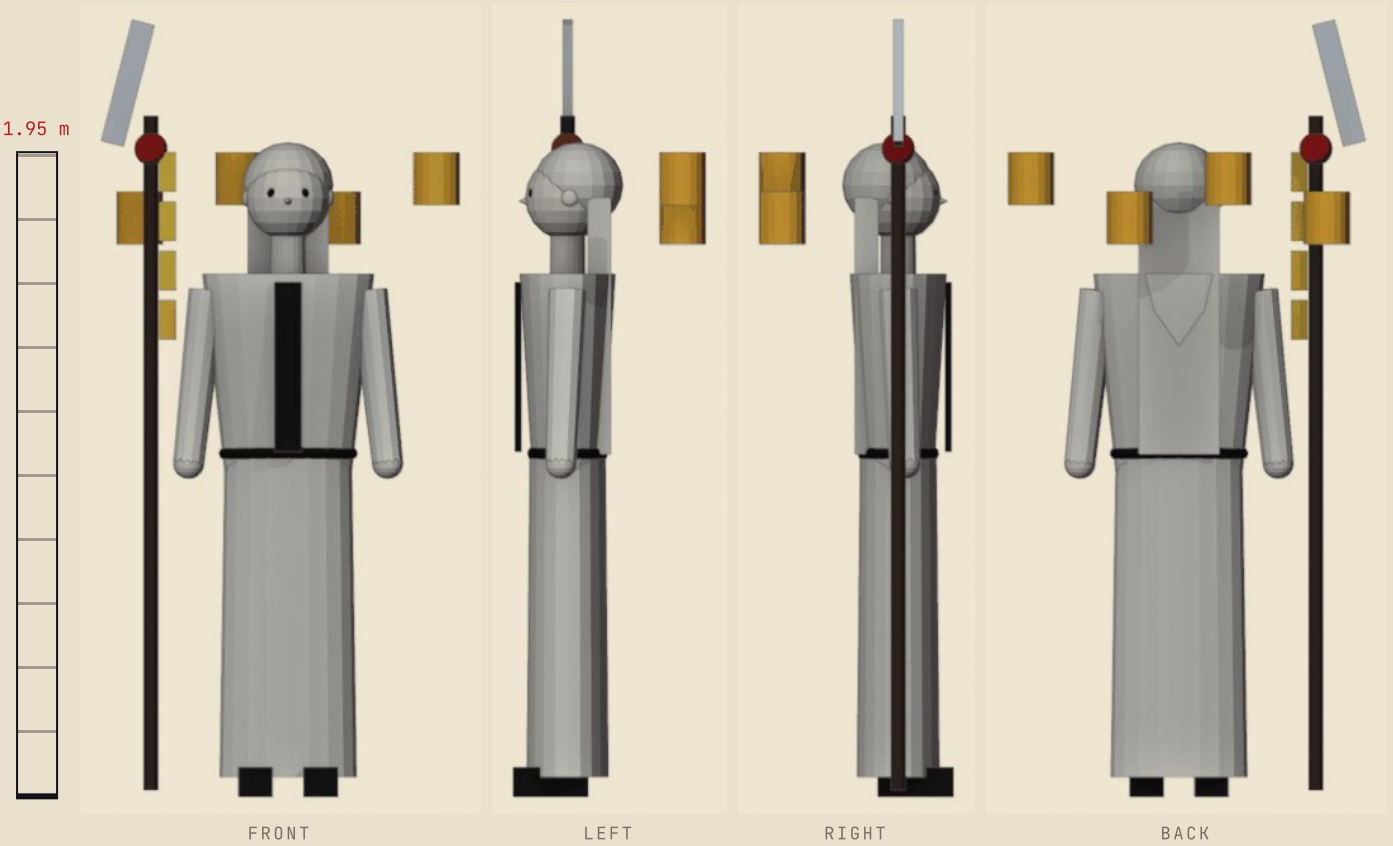
Folding fan whose ribs are abacus rods (beads fly as projectiles)

CANON LOCKS

- Exactly 8 bells
- the abacus fan
- jade + gold palette

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS Bai Si



Mourning white

Ink
#1B1B1B

Talisman
#E8C547

Lantern
#F2B33D

GROUP	Companions
ROLE	Executioner · companion
LAND	River Empire (Ten Courts)
LUCKY DIGIT	4
OMEN	44
HEIGHT	1.95 m

DESIGN

White mourning robes (white is the mourning colour in Chinese tradition) inked with 四; black funeral ribbon in long white hair

PROPS

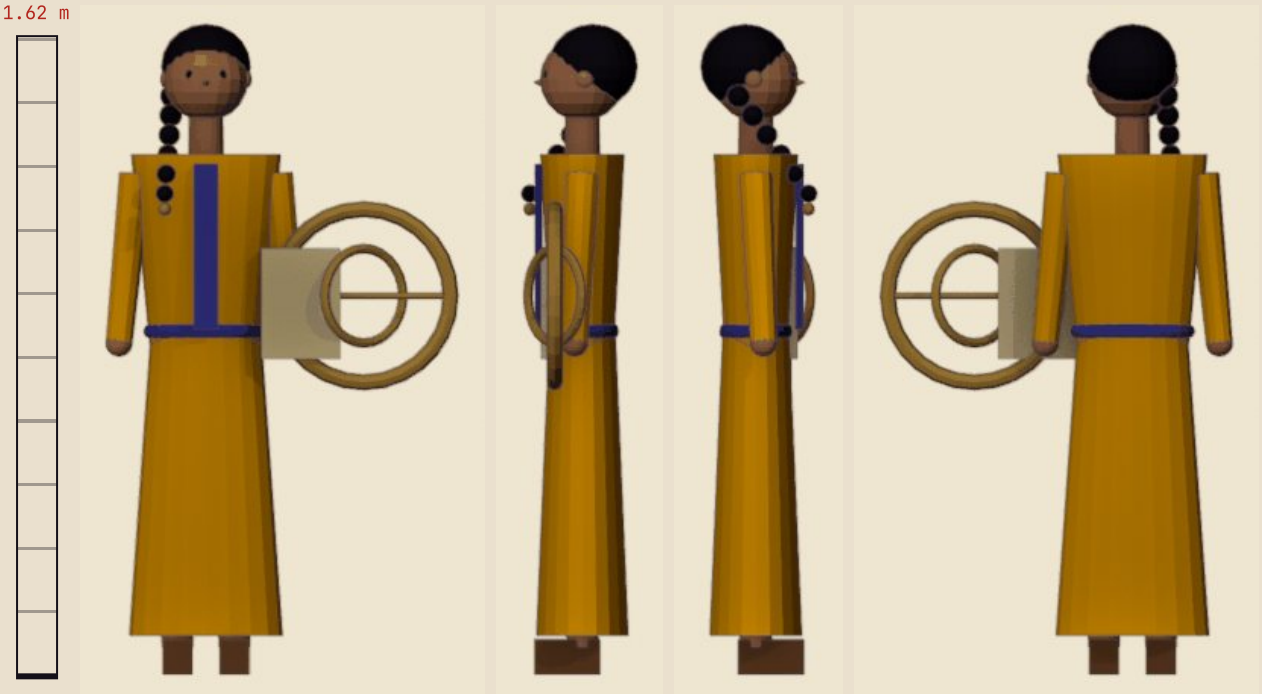
Huge guandao-style blade hung with four paper talismans; joss paper drifts around him; four floating lanterns

CANON LOCKS

- Always 4 lanterns and 4 talismans
- white robes, never coloured
- never smiles before Act IV

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS Shunya



Indigo
Saffron
#F4A300
Brass
#B5893B
Mirror
#C9CED6

GROUP	Companions
ROLE	Astronomer · companion
LAND	Śūnyapura
LUCKY DIGIT	0
OMEN	00→
HEIGHT	1.62 m

DESIGN

Indigo-and-saffron layered clothing with mirror-work embroidery; long dark braid with brass astrolabe hairpins; ink-stained fingers

PROPS

Brass astrolabe (spun as a weapon), palm-leaf manuscripts tied at her hip

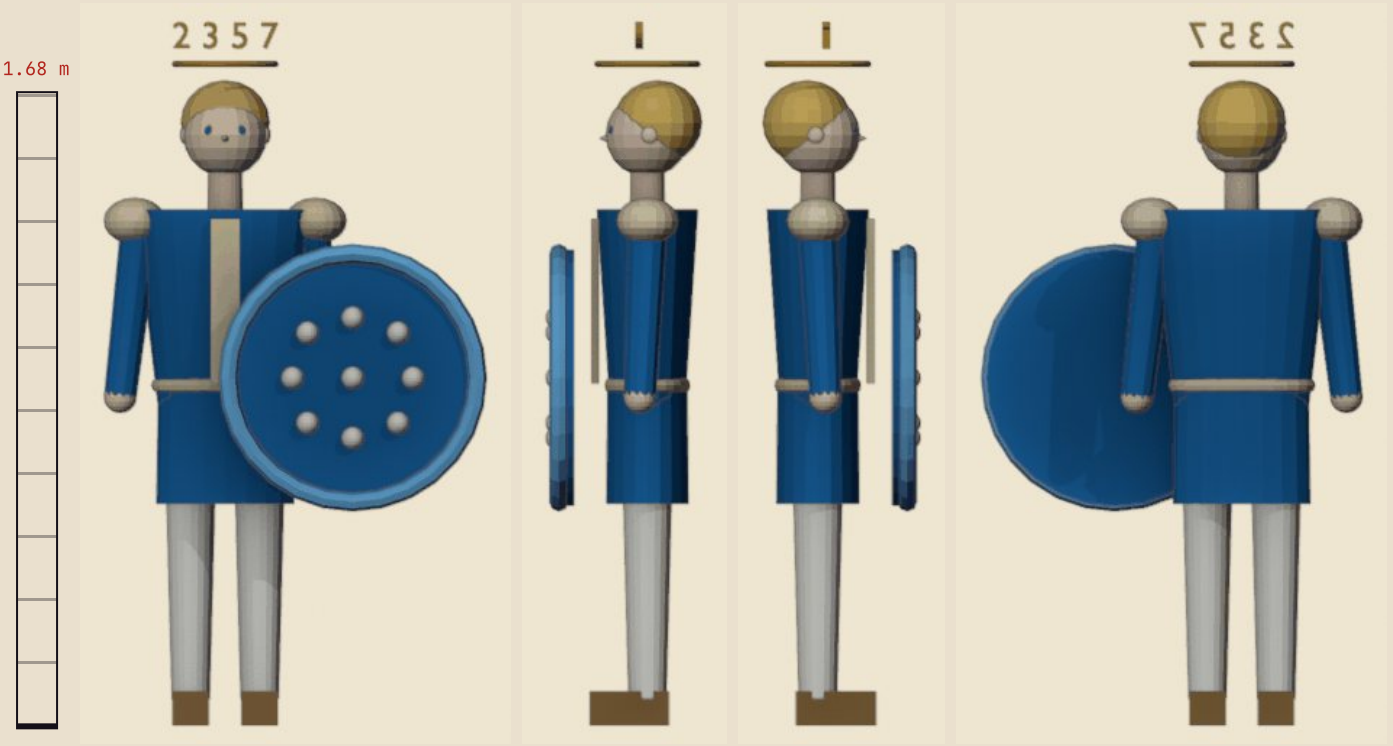
CANON LOCKS

- The astrolabe
- mirror-work embroidery
- the line "Zero isn't nothing."

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS

Prima of Kroton



Aegean

White gold
#E9DDB3

Chalk
#F4F1EA

Glass
#6FB7E9

GROUP	Companions
ROLE	Paladin · companion
LAND	Kroton Nova
LUCKY DIGIT	2
OMEN	02
HEIGHT	1.68 m

DESIGN

White-and-gold armour with Greek-key borders; short blonde hair; blue eyes

PROPS

Giant round shield shaped like a sieve set with blue glass; a halo of floating glyphs 2-3-5-7

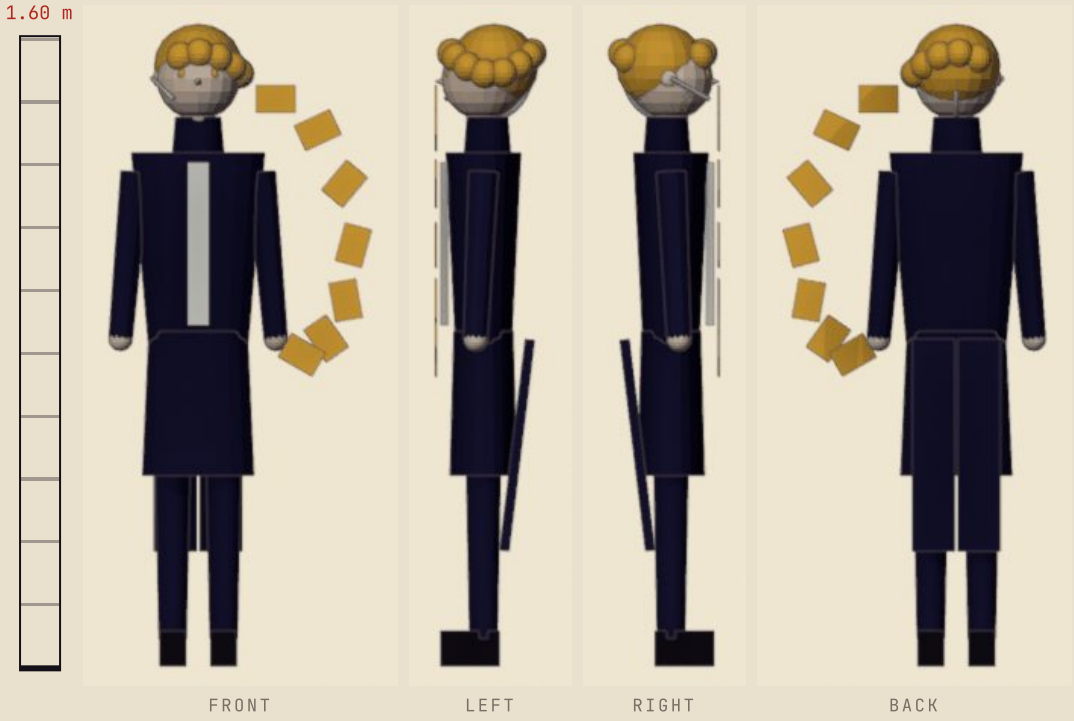
CANON LOCKS

- The sieve shield
- the 2-3-5-7 halo
- short hair

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS

Fibi Leone



Gold

Midnight
#1D1A3A

Card white
#F4F1EA

Neon pink
#FF2E88

GROUP	Companions
ROLE	Dealer · companion
LAND	The Crossroads
LUCKY DIGIT	Fibonacci
OMEN	89
HEIGHT	1.60 m

DESIGN

Tailored croupier tailcoat and headset; golden spiral curls; spiral-patterned irises

PROPS

A deck of glowing cards that flows around her in a golden spiral

CANON LOCKS

- 1,597 nights
- spiral irises
- her digit changes every round

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

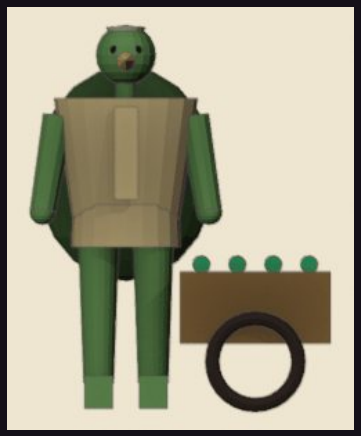
THE CAST

SECRET RECRUITS

3 models · front views at one shared scale.



Varro Kade



Kyūsuke the Kappa



Granny Liu Shun

SECRET RECRUITS Varro Kade



Rust #B7410E
Gunmetal #4A4E54
Bone #E3DCCB

GROUP	Secret recruits
OUTFIT	Ally (Act V on)
ROLE	Secret recruit · digit 1
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	1
OMEN	61
HEIGHT	2.05 m

DESIGN

The same rust trench armour with its debt jars smashed; the hound-skull mask pushed up on his head, never worn over the face again.

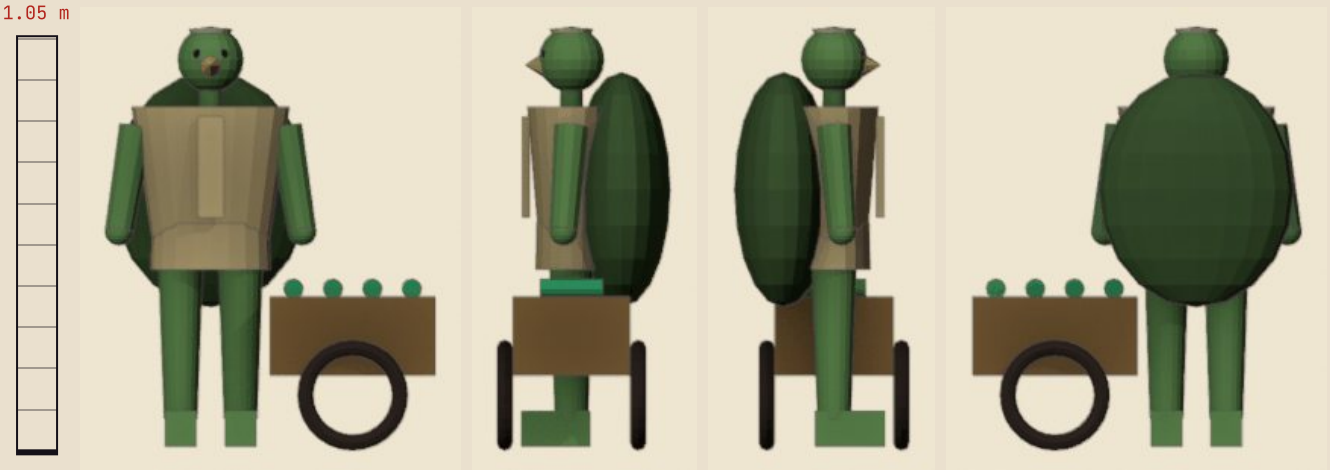
CANON LOCKS

- Mask up, face visible
- Jars empty and cracked

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

SECRET RECRUITS

Kyūsuke the Kappa



Kappa green
#6E9B5A

Straw
#D8C08A

Cucumber
#3BB273

GROUP	Secret recruits
ROLE	Secret recruit · digit 5
LAND	Hyakki
LUCKY DIGIT	5
OMEN	55
HEIGHT	1.05 m

DESIGN

A small river imp: green skin, beak, turtle shell, a water dish on his head, a straw vest, and a cucumber cart.

CANON LOCKS

- The water dish is always full
- Never seen without the cart

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

SECRET RECRUITS

Granny Liu Shun



Jade	#00A86B
Cardigan	#B4A7C8
Lacquer	#B22222

GROUP	Secret recruits
ROLE	Secret recruit · digit 6
LAND	River Empire
LUCKY DIGIT	6
OMEN	66
HEIGHT	1.48 m

DESIGN

Tiny, eighty-ish, a lavender cardigan over a red qipao, jade bangles, a mahjong-tile purse and a cane she points with.

CANON LOCKS

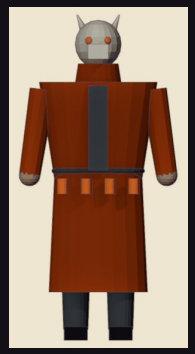
- Never loses at mahjong on screen

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

THE CAST

BOSSES

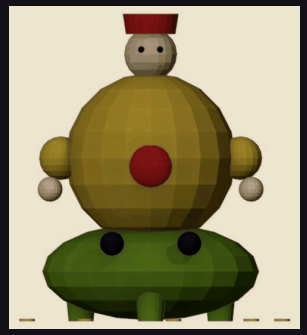
7 models · front views at one shared scale.



Varro Kade, the Ledgerhound



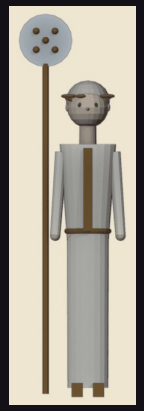
Tamamo, the Nine-Tailed Auditor



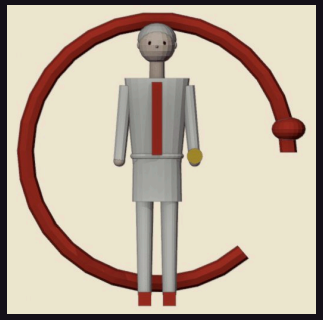
Chancellor Jin Chan



Rahu & Ketu, the Eclipse



Archon Seventeen



The House, Octavian Nine



Comptroller Lucan Thale

BOSSES

Varro Kade, the Ledgerhound



Rust

Gunmetal
#4A4E54

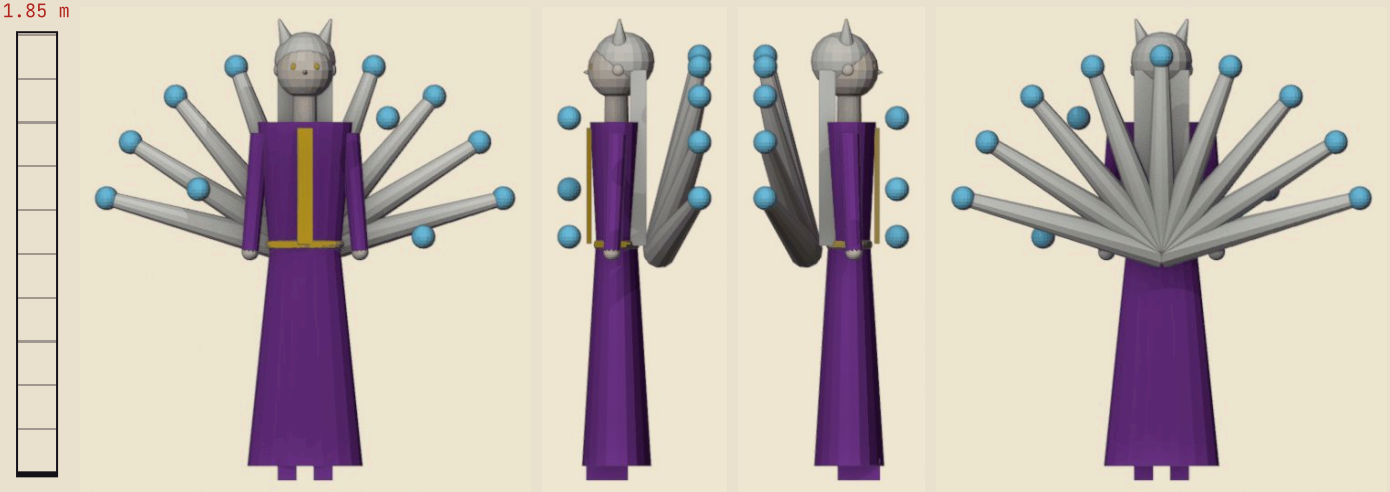
Debt glow
#FF7A2C

Bone
#E3DCCB

GROUP	Bosses
ROLE	Prologue boss
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	61
HEIGHT	2.05 m

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

BOSSES Tamamo, the Nine-Tailed Auditor



Violet

Gold
#F4C430

Foxfire
#7FDBFF

White
#F4F1EA

GROUP	Bosses
ROLE	Act I boss
LAND	Hyakki
LUCKY DIGIT	9
OMEN	99 ×9
HEIGHT	1.85 m

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

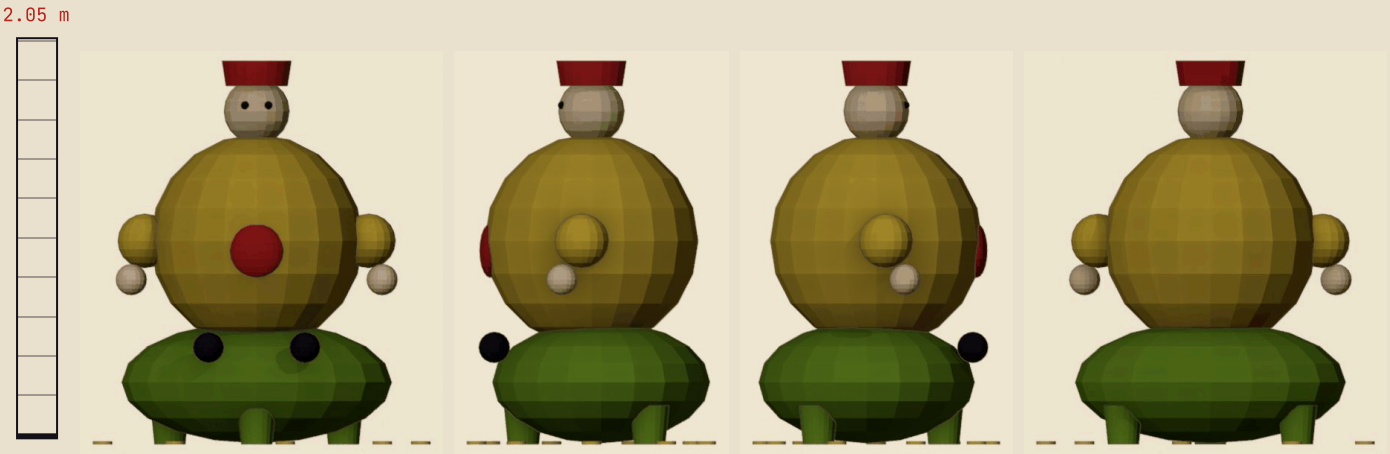
BOSSES Chancellor Jin Chan

Gold
#D4AF37

Toad green
#6B8E23

Red
#B22222

GROUP	Bosses
ROLE	Act II boss
LAND	River Empire
LUCKY DIGIT	8
OMEN	88
HEIGHT	2.05 m



3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

BOSSES

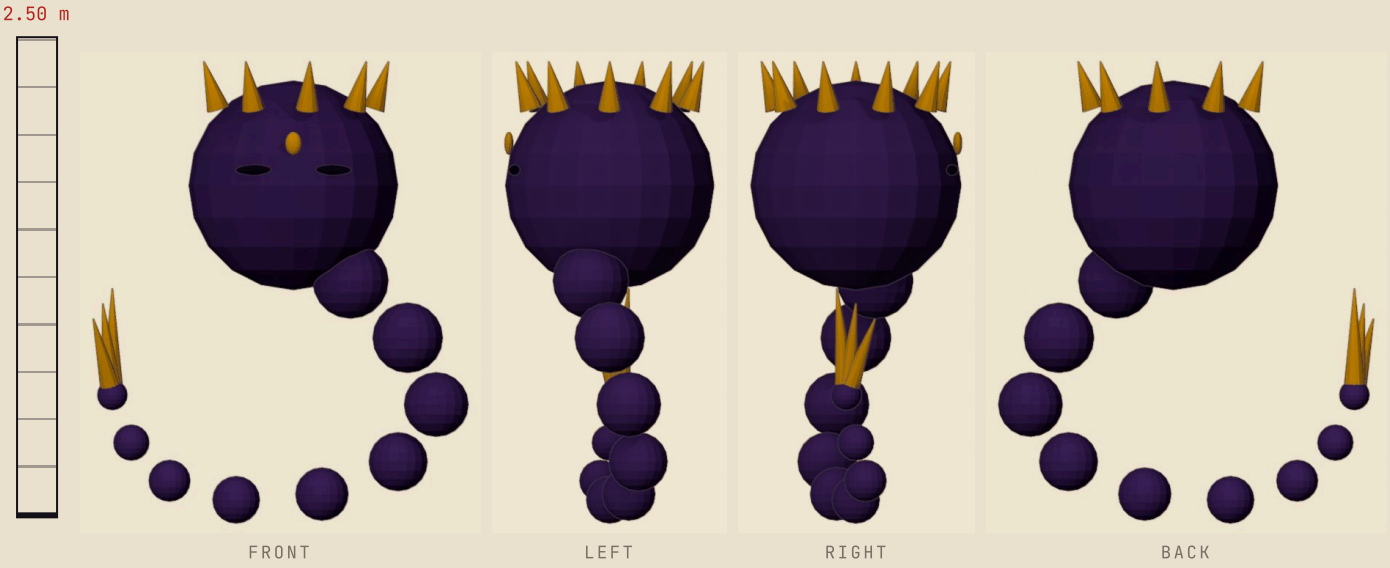
Rahu & Ketu, the Eclipse

Eclipse
#4B2A6B

Corona
#F4A300

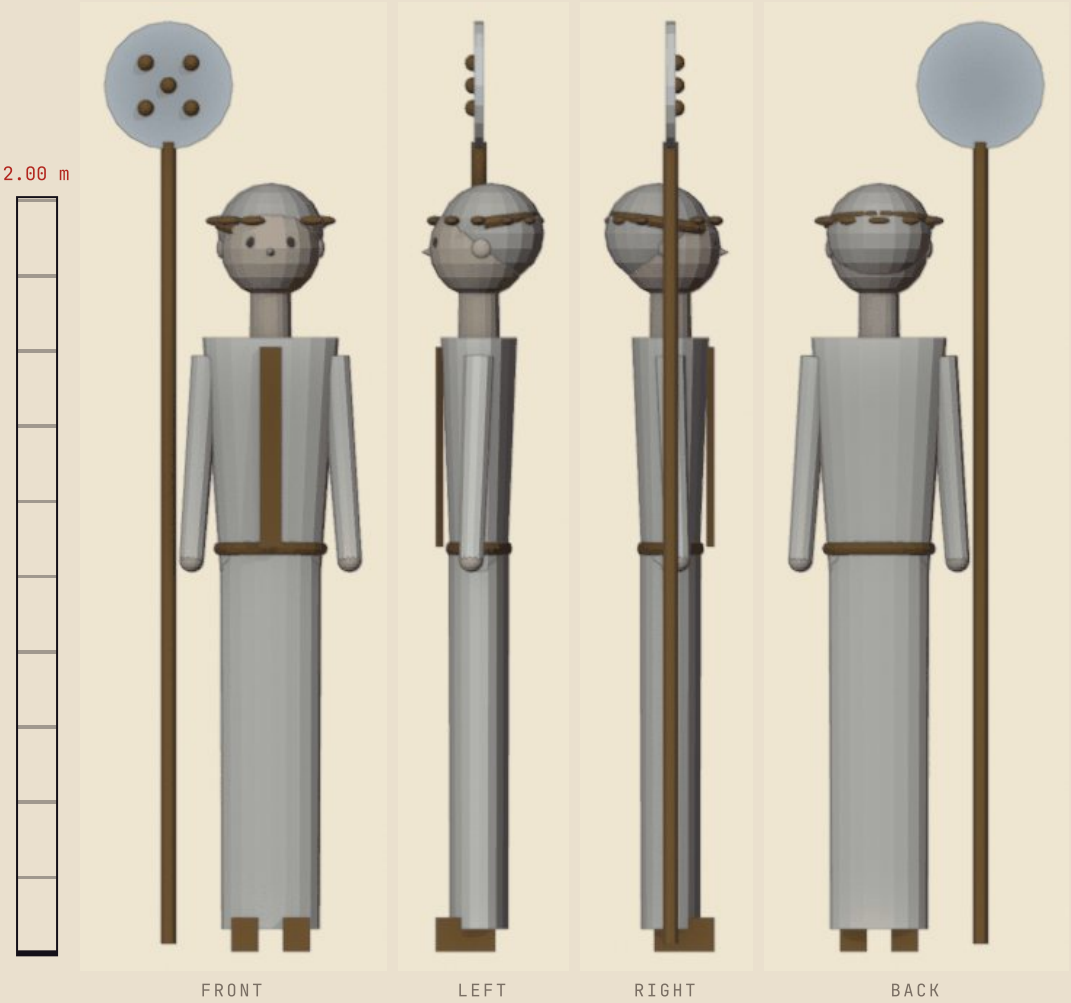
Night
#141018

GROUP	Bosses
ROLE	Act III boss (cultural review required)
LAND	Śūnyapura
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	eclipsed
HEIGHT	2.50 m



CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

BOSSES Archon Seventeen



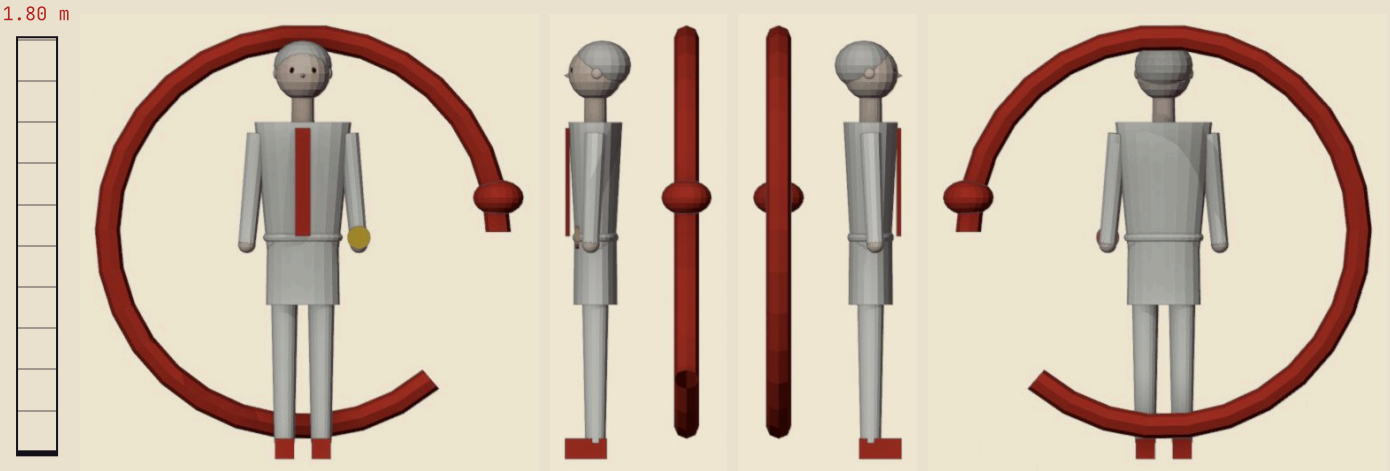
Bronze #8C6A3F	
Chalk #F4F1EA	
Sieve white #DDE6EE	
GROUP	Bosses
ROLE	Act IV boss
LAND	Kroton Nova
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	17
HEIGHT	2.00 m

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

BOSSES The House, Octavian Nine

Ivory	Casino red	Gold
#F4F1EA	#C0392B	#D4AF37

GROUP	Bosses
ROLE	Act V boss
LAND	The Crossroads
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	89
HEIGHT	1.80 m



3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

BOSSES Comptroller Lucan Thale



Steel white

Brass
#B5A642

Nixie
#FF7A2C

Steel
#8E9196

GROUP	Bosses
ROLE	Final antagonist
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	50 (steel)
HEIGHT	1.90 m

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

THE CAST

KEEPERS

6 models · front views at one shared scale.



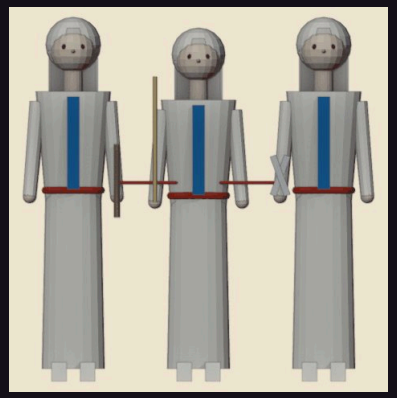
Enma



Judge Cui



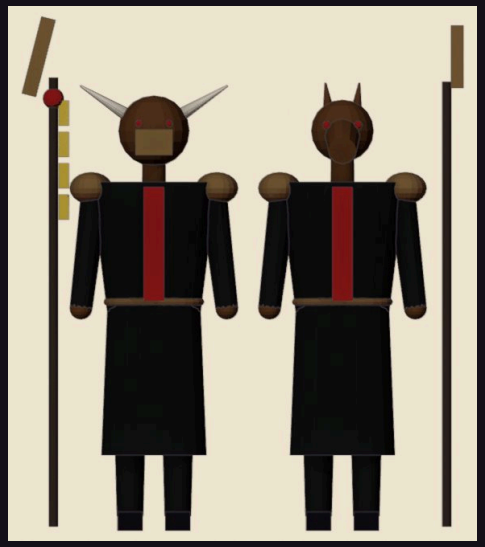
Chitragupta



The Moirai



The Stranger



Ox-Head and Horse-Face

KEEPERS Enma



Court red
#9E2B25

Black
#141018

Gold
#D4AF37

GROUP	Keepers
ROLE	Keeper of Hyakki's gate of the dead
LAND	Hyakki
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	—
HEIGHT	2.15 m

DESIGN

A solemn judge in layered court robes and a judge's crown, holding the ledger of the dead. Shown with reverence: never monstrous.

CANON LOCKS

- Never an enemy; his trial ends with a bow
- Design reviewed by a Japanese consultant before final art

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

KEEPERS

Judge Cui



Ink
#1B1B1B

Rice paper
#E9E2D0

Lacquer
#B22222

GROUP	Keepers
ROLE	Keeper of the Brush, the Ten Courts
LAND	River Empire
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	—
HEIGHT	1.80 m

DESIGN

An official of the underworld courts in black robes with a giant brush and the Book of Life and Death.

CANON LOCKS

- Writes every number twice
- Chinese consultant review

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

KEEPERS

Chitragupta



Saffron
#F4A300

Palm leaf
#D8C08A

Indigo
#3F3D99

GROUP	Keepers
ROLE	Keeper of the records of deeds
LAND	Śūnyapura
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	—
HEIGHT	1.85 m

DESIGN

The divine scribe with a stylus and palm-leaf records. Placeholder blockout only: final design must come from Indian cultural consultants.

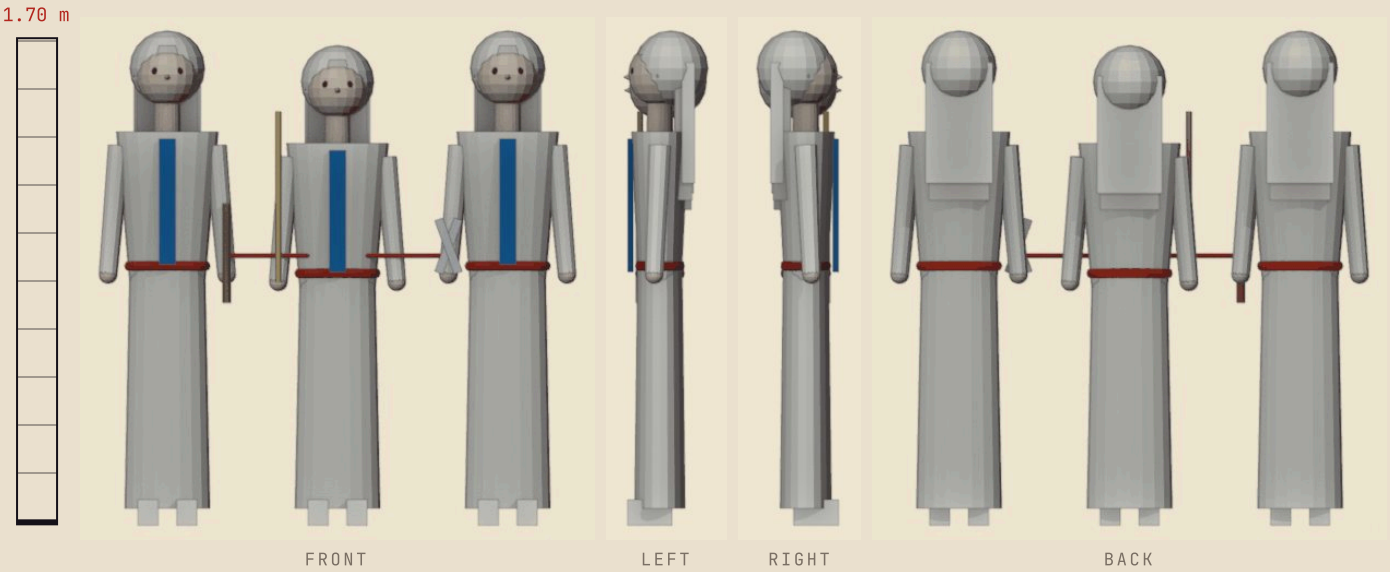
CANON LOCKS

- Revered figure: no stylisation without consultant sign-off

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

KEEPERS

The Moirai



Chalk	#F4F1EA
Thread red	#C0392B
Aegean	#1F6FB2

GROUP	Keepers
ROLE	Keepers of the thread (Clotho, Lachesis, Atropos)
LAND	Kroton Nova
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	—
HEIGHT	1.70 m

DESIGN

Three sisters in white peplos and veils: Clotho with a spindle, Lachesis with a measuring rod, Atropos with shears; one red thread runs through all three.

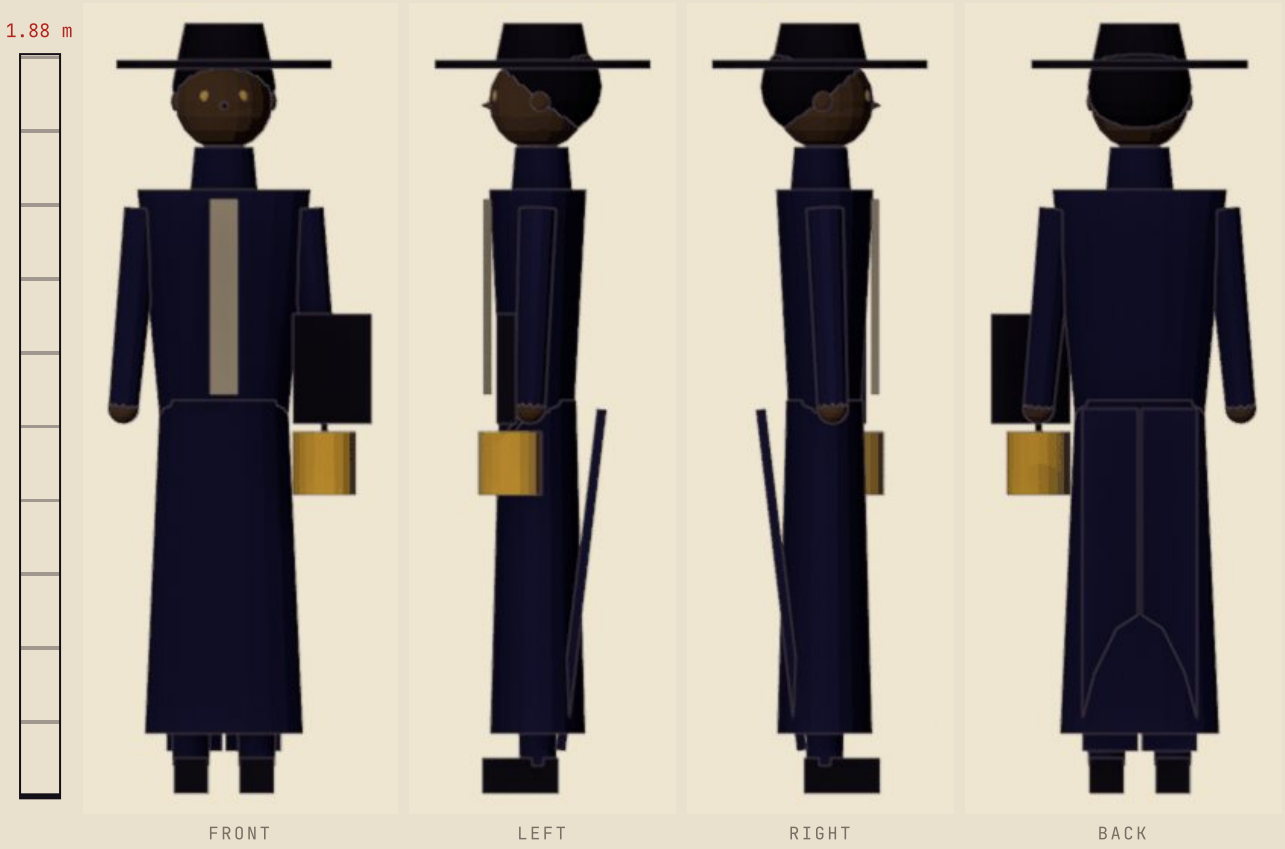
CANON LOCKS

- Always three
- The red thread connects them

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

KEEPERS

The Stranger



Midnight #1D1A3A

Lamp gold #F2B33D

Dust #B9A58A

GROUP	Keepers
ROLE	Keeper of the crossroads
LAND	The Crossroads
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	—
HEIGHT	1.88 m

DESIGN

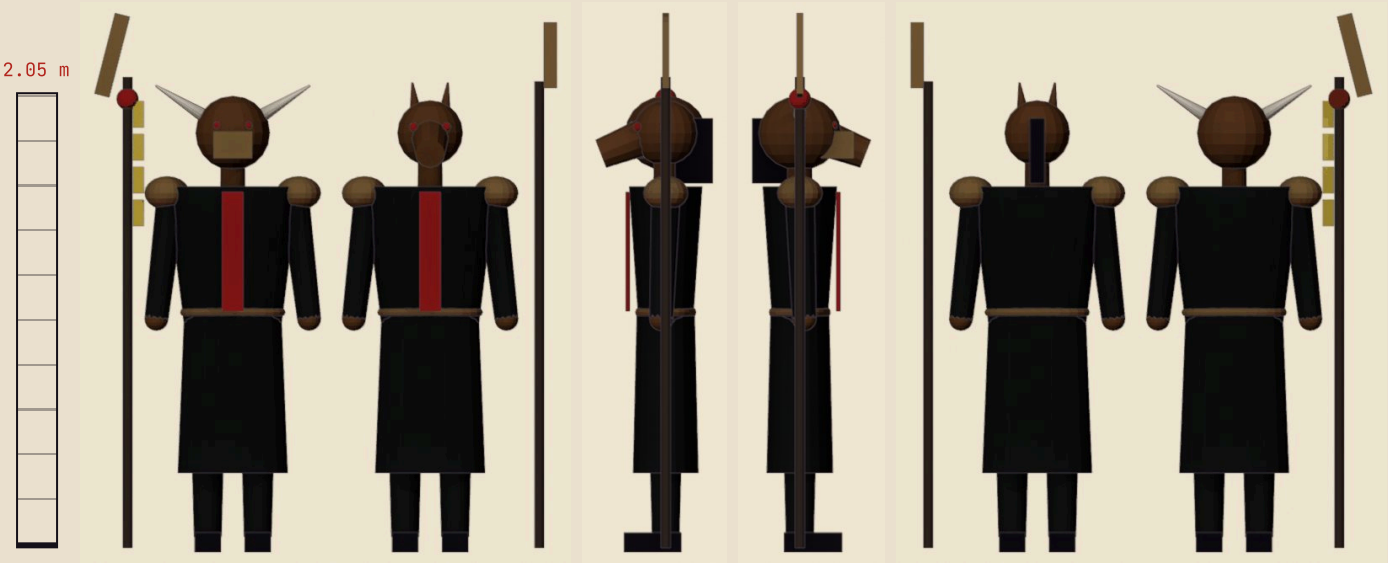
A tall figure at the midnight crossroads with a long dusty coat, a wide hat and the black book. Fair, patient, never a devil.

CANON LOCKS

- Never a villain
- American consultant review of the blues crossroads legend

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

KEEPERS Ox-Head and Horse-Face



Bronze	#8C6A3F
Ink	#1B1B1B
Lacquer	#B22222

GROUP	Keepers
ROLE	Wardens of the Ten Courts (trial)
LAND	River Empire
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	—
HEIGHT	2.05 m

DESIGN

Two towering wardens with an ox's head and a horse's head, in black lamellar armour, carrying halberds. A trial, not villains.

CANON LOCKS

- Always a pair
- Shown as guardians, never demons

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

THE CAST

THE GOD OF LUCK

1 model · front views at one shared scale.



Hap

THE GOD OF LUCK

Hap



Star black #141026	
Dice ivory #F4F1EA	
Every land's accent #FF7A2C	

GROUP	The god of luck
ROLE	The god of luck (never an enemy)
LAND	Everywhere
LUCKY DIGIT	0–9
OMEN	—
HEIGHT	2.20 m

DESIGN

A vast, gentle figure of night sky: a robe full of stars, two dice for eyes, every digit 0–9 orbiting its head, and the open hand with a die. Its face changes per land; the dice eyes and orbiting digits never do.

CANON LOCKS

- Never the same face twice
- Never a monster or a stand-in for a real deity

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

THE CAST

STORY CHARACTERS

18 models · front views at one shared scale.



STORY CHARACTERS

Ama Okoro



Wax print
#D9822B

Indigo
#26428B

Ash
#8A7F72

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Wards mother; the intro's Omen 01
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	01→07
HEIGHT	1.66 m

DESIGN

A wax-print dress under a worn Remainder shawl, a head wrap, a laundry bag. Tired, proud.

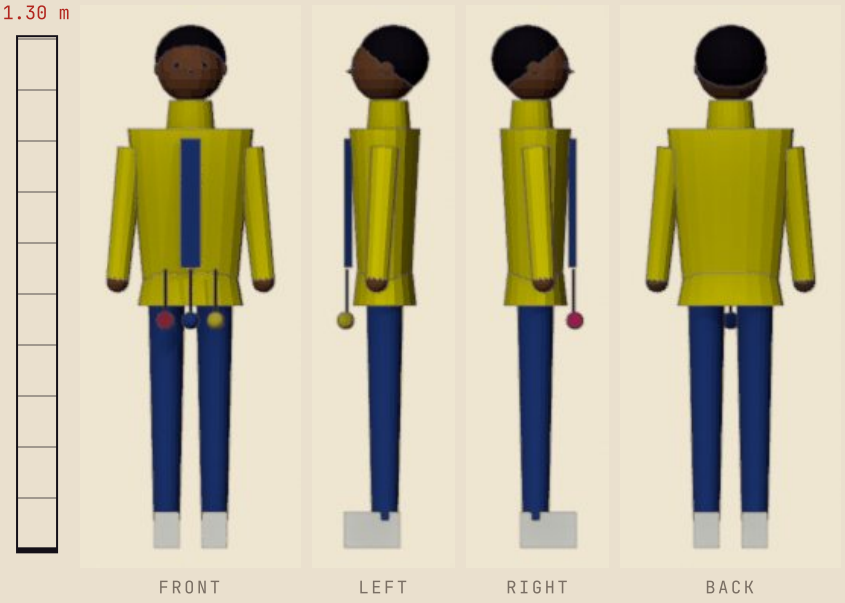
CANON LOCKS

- Her Omen goes 01 → 07 in the intro

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Tobi Okoro



Hoodie yellow
#F5E400

Denim
#26428B

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Ama's son, age 9; NIL's first follower
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	31
HEIGHT	1.30 m

DESIGN

Oversized yellow hoodie with a hand-painted 7, patched jeans, a string of bottle-cap charms.

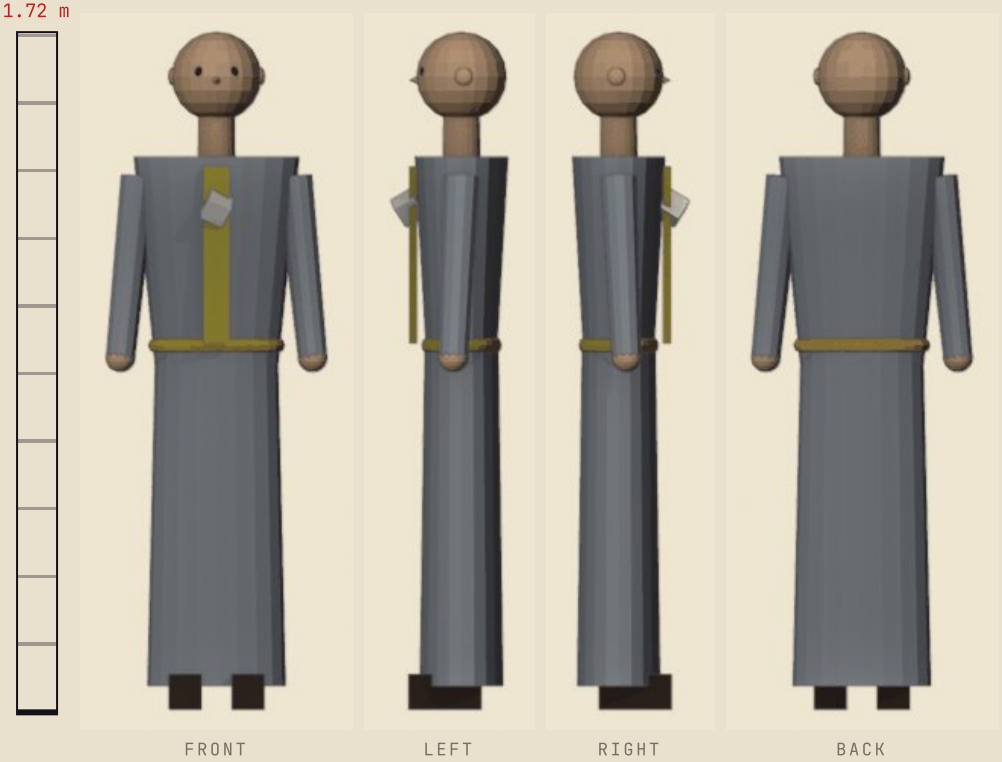
CANON LOCKS

- Counts NIL's wins on his fingers

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Brother Nought



Faded steel
#9CA0A6

Brass
#B5A642

Open Hand gold
#D4AF37

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Defrocked Ledger-priest; secret Open Hand
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	09
HEIGHT	1.72 m

DESIGN

A Ledger-priest's steel-grey robe with the seals torn off; a die on a string where the Basilica pendant should be.

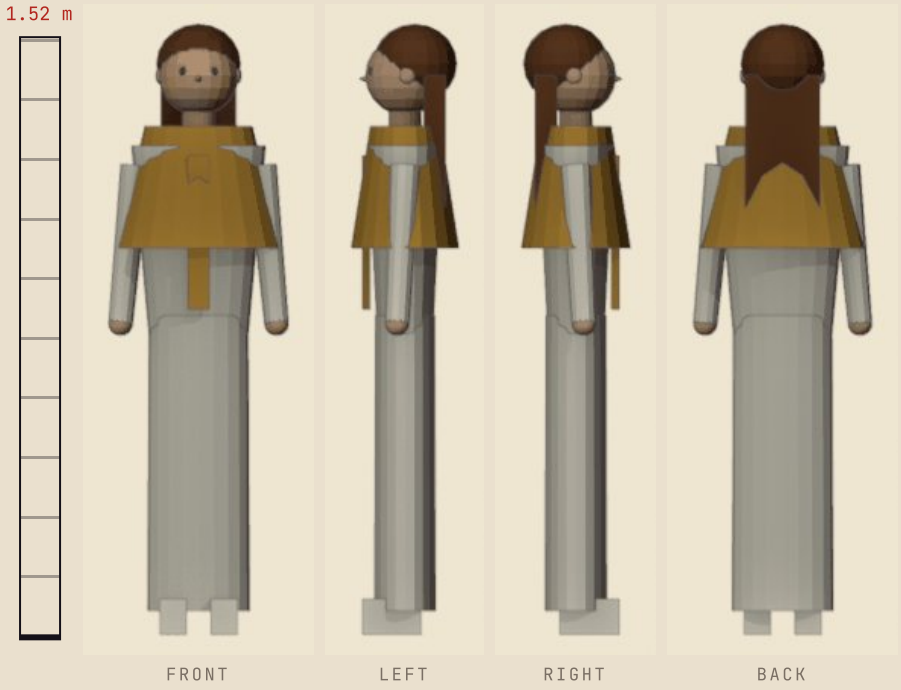
CANON LOCKS

- Rounds everything up out of spite

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Livia Kade



Blanket
#C8963E

Nightgown
#E9E2D0

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Varro's sister, Omen 06
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	06
HEIGHT	1.52 m

DESIGN

Thin, wrapped in a mustard blanket over a nightgown; a dog-shaped charm her brother carved.

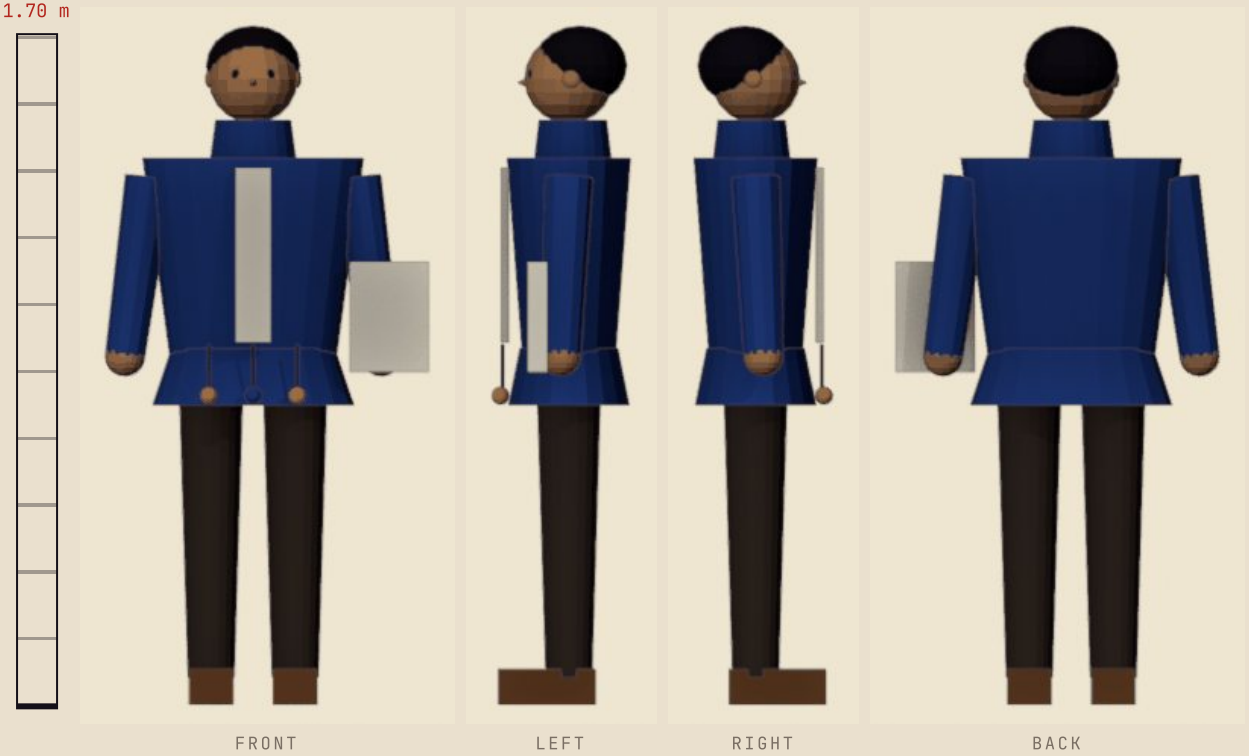
CANON LOCKS

- Never seen outside until Act V

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Gus Mendoza



Bowling shirt	#26428B
Gold chains	#D4AF37
Cream	#F2E8D5

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Charm Bazaar fixer
LAND	Meridian / Crossroads
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	47
HEIGHT	1.70 m

DESIGN

A bowling shirt covered in every culture's charms, gold chains, a receipt book.

CANON LOCKS

- Haggles in sevens

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Clerk Ivo Marr



Ledger olive
#6E6B4E

Steel
#C9CED6

Brass
#B5A642

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Thale's assistant (defects in the finale)
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	50
HEIGHT	1.76 m

DESIGN

Basilica clerk's olive uniform, sleeve guards, a ledger held like a shield.

CANON LOCKS

- Files everything in triplicate

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Ofuku



Shrine white
#F4F1EA

Vermilion
#E34234

Daruma red
#C0392B

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Keeper of the Seven Lucky Gods' shrine
LAND	Hyakki
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	77
HEIGHT	1.45 m

DESIGN

An elderly shrine keeper in white and red, a calligraphy brush for daruma eyes.

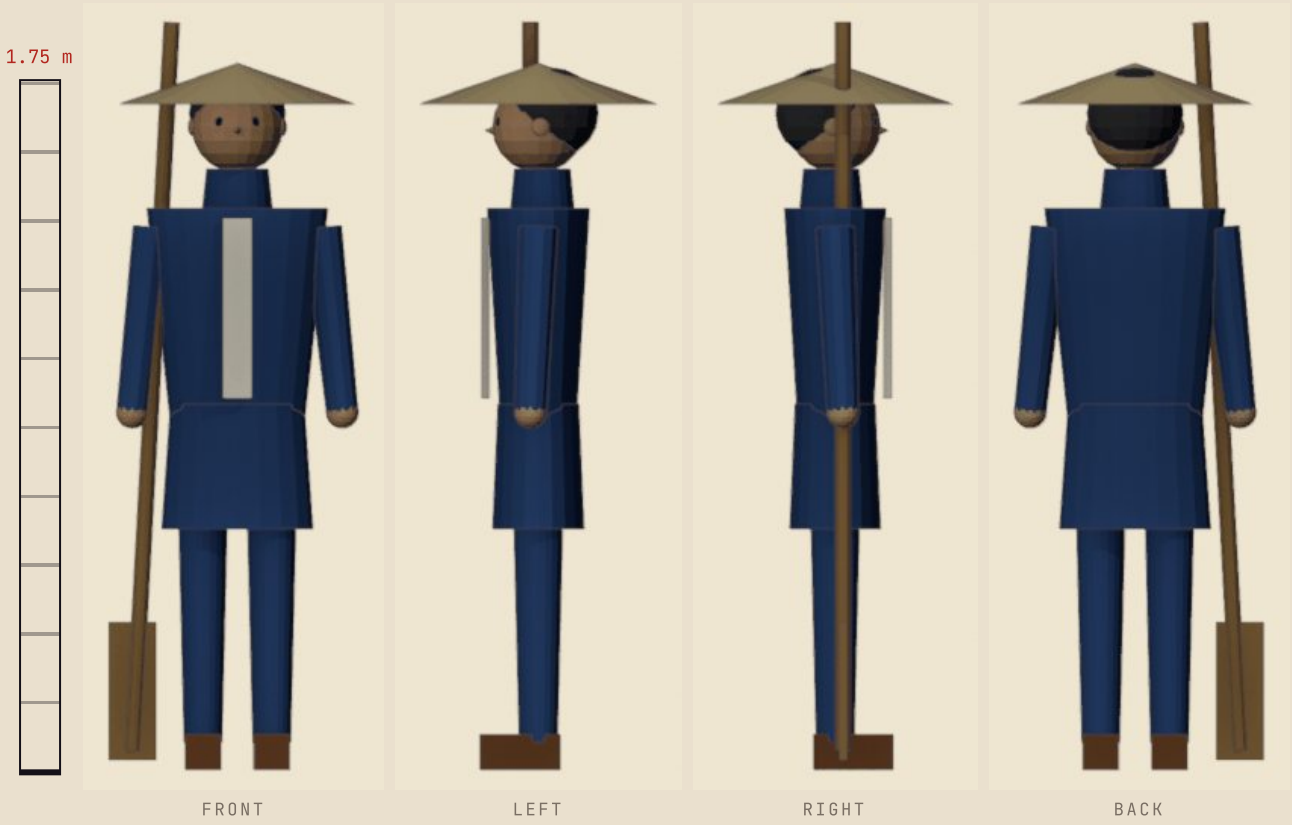
CANON LOCKS

- Paints one daruma eye a day

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Tetsu



Indigo work
#2E4A7A

Straw
#D8C08A

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Ferryman; former Collector
LAND	Hyakki
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	38
HEIGHT	1.75 m

DESIGN

Indigo work jacket over a Collector's old undershirt, a wide straw hat, a long oar.

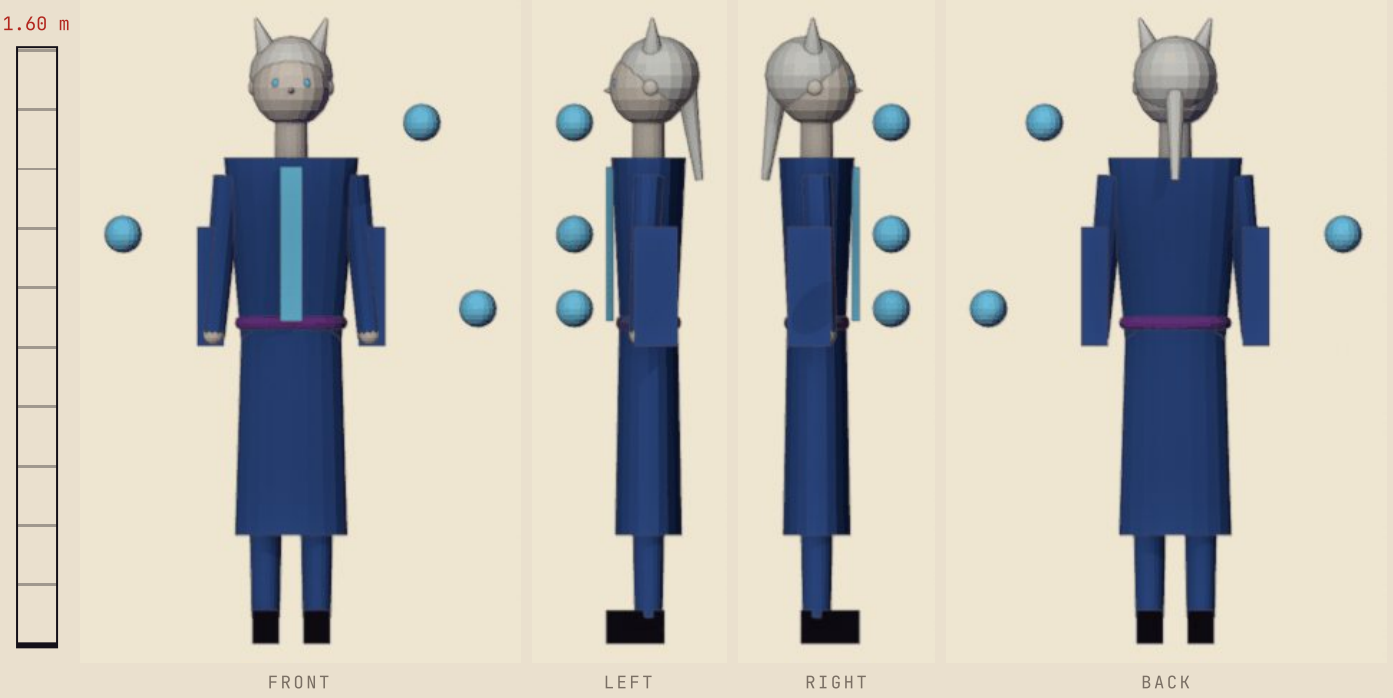
CANON LOCKS

- Counts strokes of the oar

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Ao (Kitsune twin)



Foxfire blue
#7FDBFF

Violet
#8E44AD

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Tamamo's foxfire retainer
LAND	Hyakki
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	44
HEIGHT	1.60 m

DESIGN

Blue twin of the pair; fox ears, a single tail, cold blue foxfire.

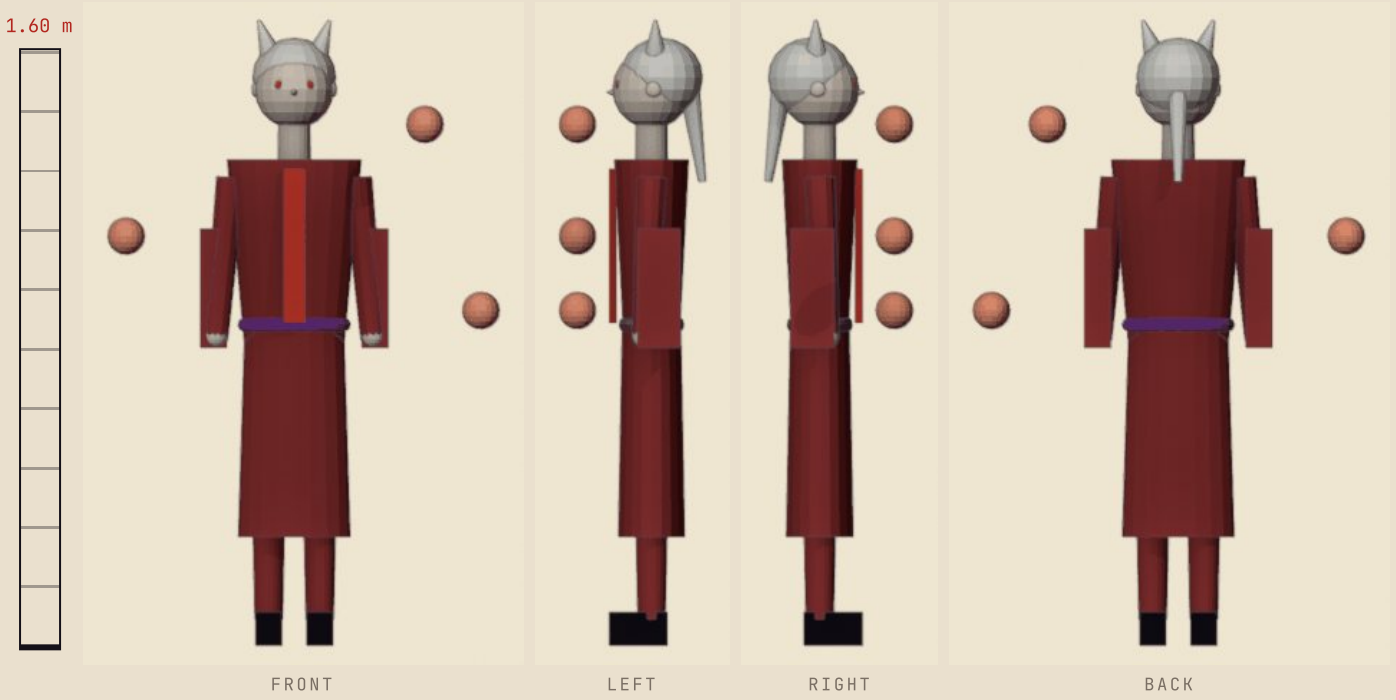
CANON LOCKS

- Speaks only in pairs with Aka

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Aka (Kitsune twin)



Foxfire red
#E34234

Violet
#8E44AD

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Tamamo's foxfire retainer
LAND	Hyakki
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	44
HEIGHT	1.60 m

DESIGN

Red twin; mirror of Ao (his ponytail on the other side).

CANON LOCKS

- Mirror of Ao

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Little Lantern (Xiao Deng)



Festival red
#B22222

Lantern gold
#F2B33D

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Festival orphan messenger
LAND	River Empire
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	18
HEIGHT	1.25 m

DESIGN

A too-big red festival jacket, a paper lantern on a stick, quick feet.

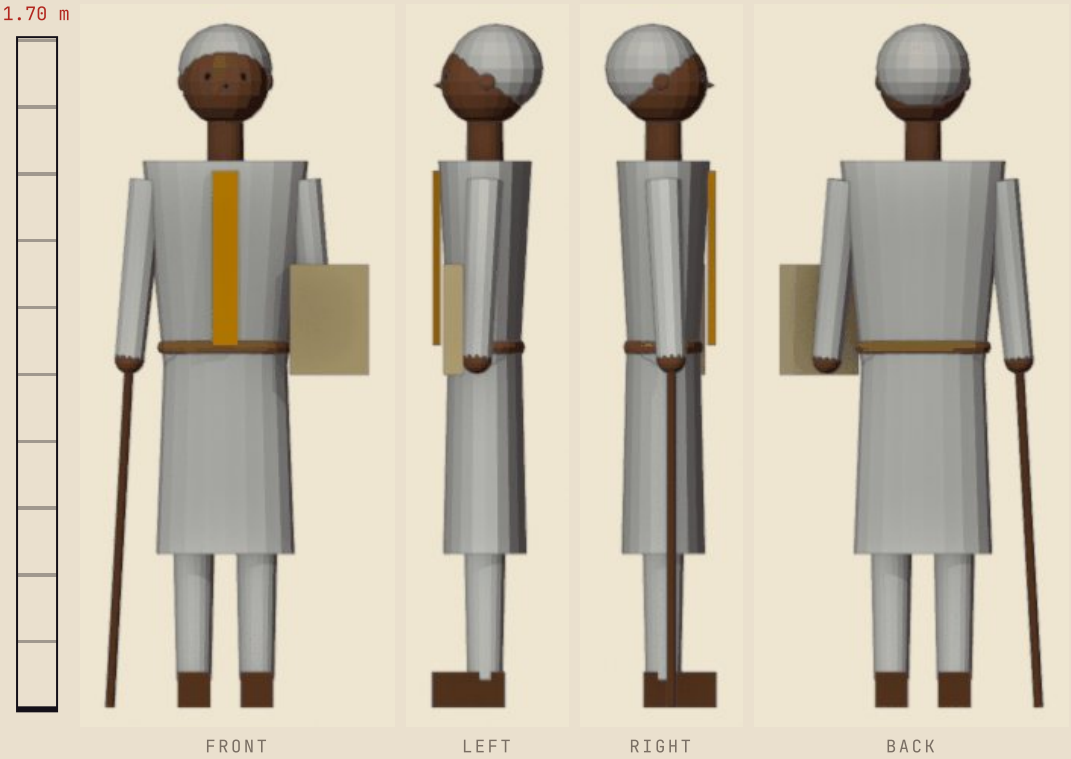
CANON LOCKS

- Counts lanterns

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Acharya Vidya Rao



Khadi white	#F4F1EA
Saffron	#F4A300
Brass	#B5893B

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Shunya's teacher, the observatory
LAND	Śūnyapura
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	70
HEIGHT	1.70 m

DESIGN

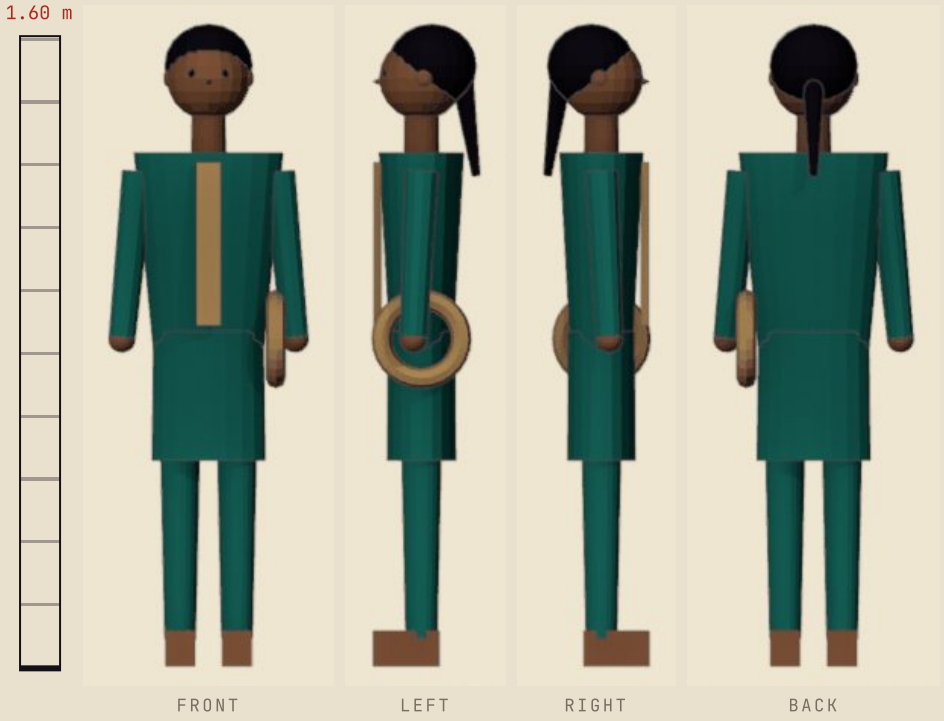
White kurta and shawl, round spectacles, a walking stick, star charts under the arm.

CANON LOCKS

- Counts in Sanskrit numerals

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS Meera



Peacock
#1E7B6F

Sandstone
#D8A86B

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Stepwell guide and diver
LAND	Śūnyapura
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	21
HEIGHT	1.60 m

DESIGN

A peacock-green diving tunic, a coil of rope, a lamp on her belt.

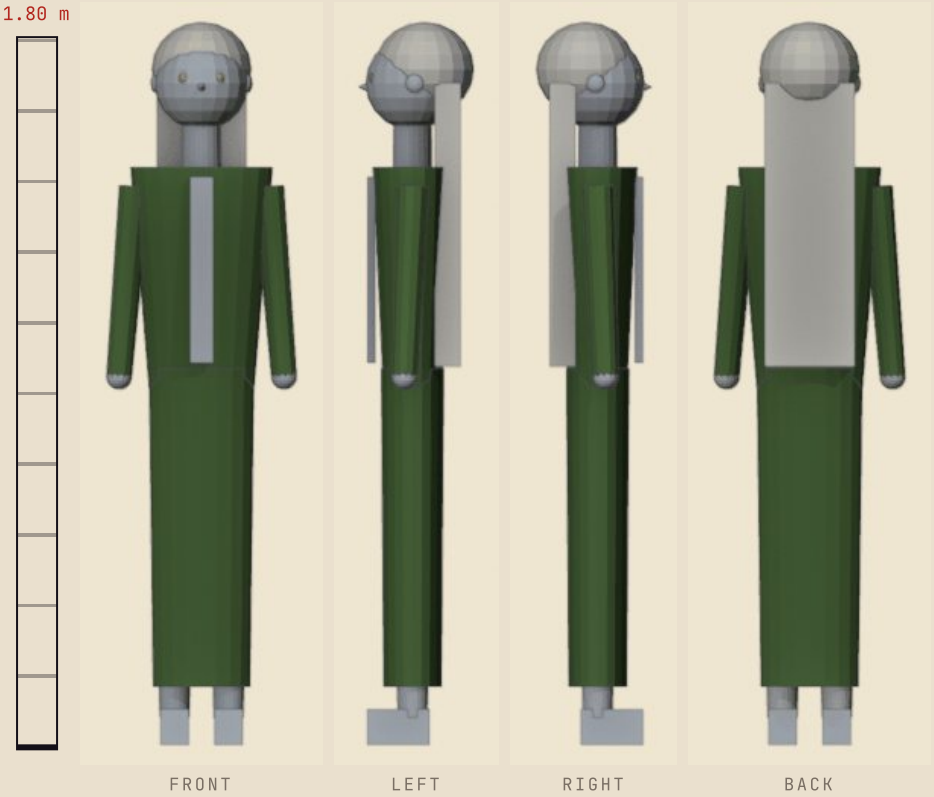
CANON LOCKS

- Counts the 1,001 steps

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Baital



Ghost pale
#C9CED6

Banyan
#5E7D4A

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Vetāla who riddles travellers
LAND	Śūnyapura
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	??
HEIGHT	1.80 m

DESIGN

A gaunt, pale spirit draped in banyan-green cloth who hangs upside down from a branch to ask riddles. Eerie, witty, never gory.

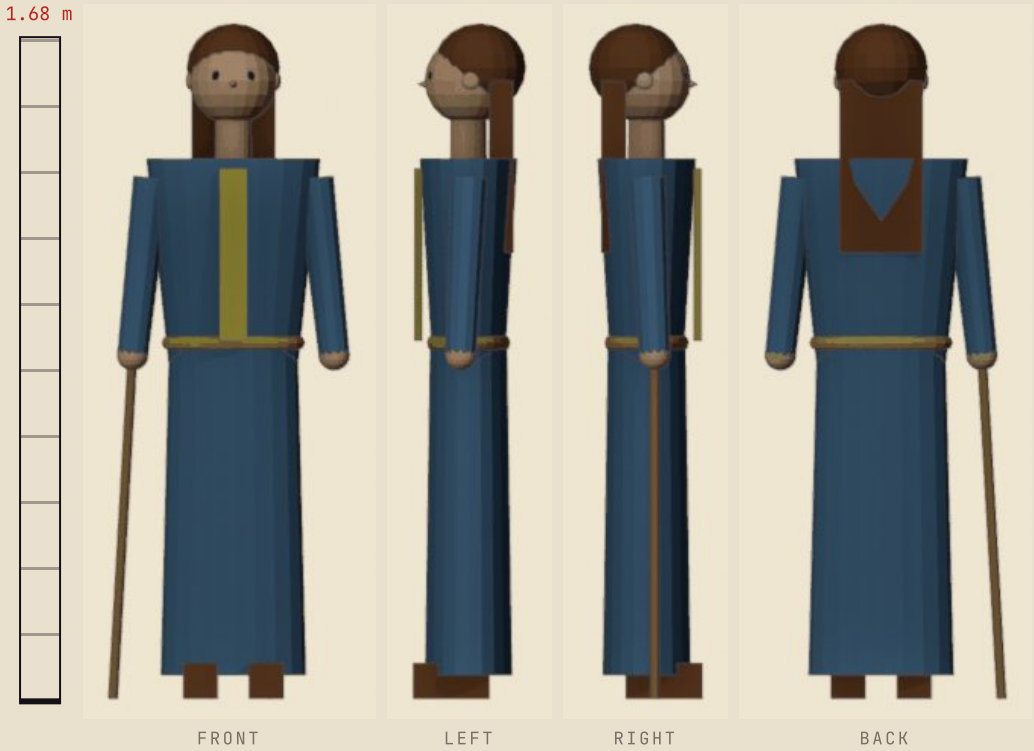
CANON LOCKS

- Answers only in questions

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Mother Kallisto



Patched blue
#4A6E8C

Scrap brass
#B5A642

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Leader of the undercity of the fallen
LAND	Kroton Nova
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	24
HEIGHT	1.68 m

DESIGN

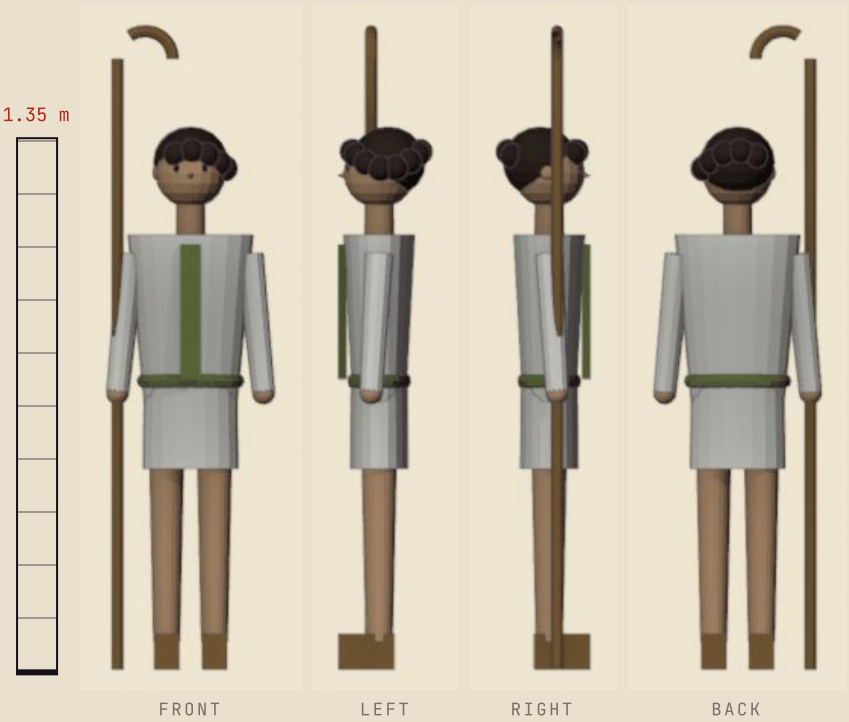
A patched blue peplos stitched with Basilica scrap, a tall staff of welded pipe.

CANON LOCKS

- Counts in composites, proudly

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

Niko



Olive
#7A8B4A

Chalk
#F4F1EA

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Goat-herd kid
LAND	Kroton Nova
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	12
HEIGHT	1.35 m

DESIGN

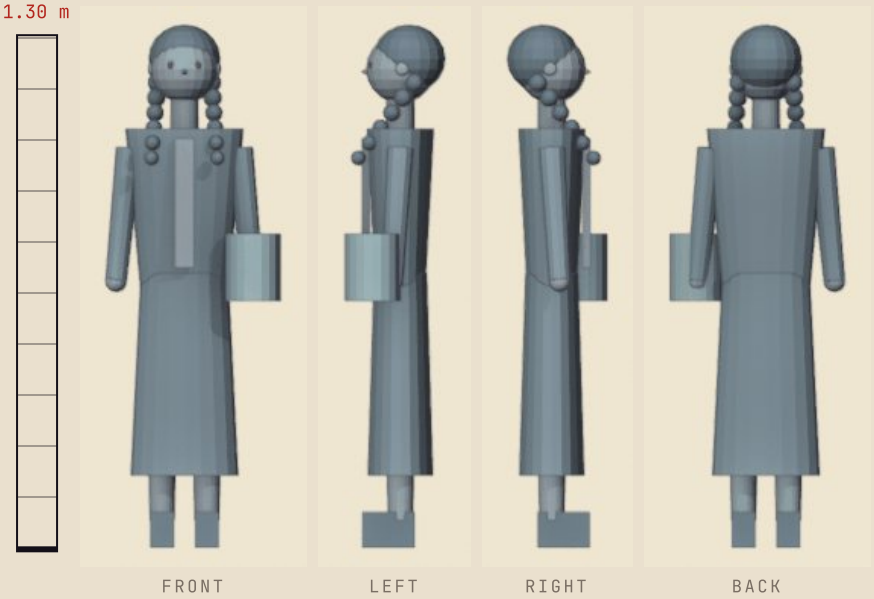
A chalk-white tunic with an olive sash, a crook taller than he is.

CANON LOCKS

- Always one goat short

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS Penny



Ghost blue
#C9D6DE

Copper
#B87333

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Ghost girl on the railway
LAND	The Crossroads
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	01
HEIGHT	1.30 m

DESIGN

A translucent pale-blue pinafore dress from another century, pigtails, a jar of 1,596 copper pennies.

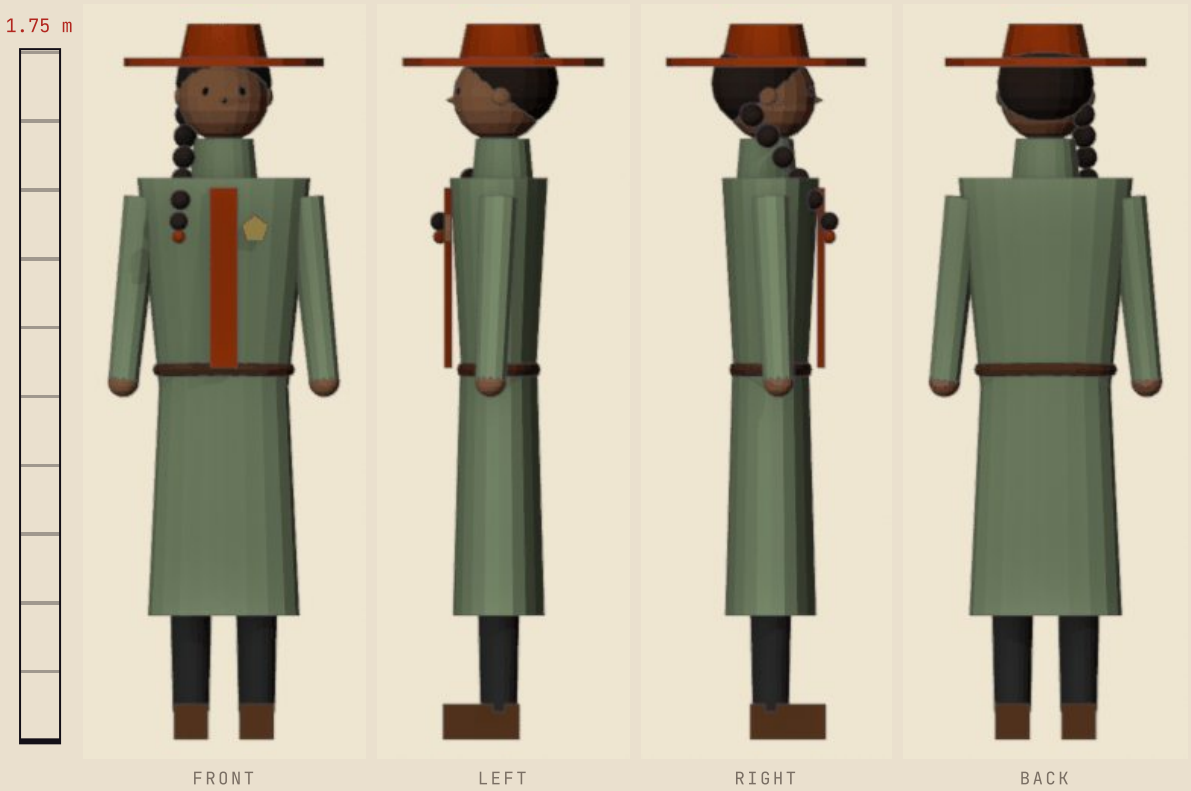
CANON LOCKS

- Never smiles until the 1,597th penny

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

Sheriff Dolores Vance



Sage	#9CAF88
Rust	#B7410E
Badge gold	#D4AF37

GROUP	Story characters
ROLE	Lucky Strike's sheriff
LAND	The Crossroads
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	11
HEIGHT	1.75 m

DESIGN

Sage duster, rust shirt, a notched star badge, a cattleman hat.

CANON LOCKS

- Notches her badge each night

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

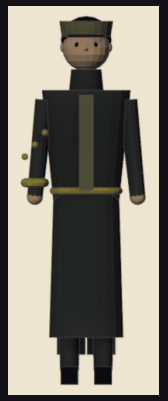
THE CAST

FACTIONS AND JOBS

9 models · front views at one shared scale.


Collector

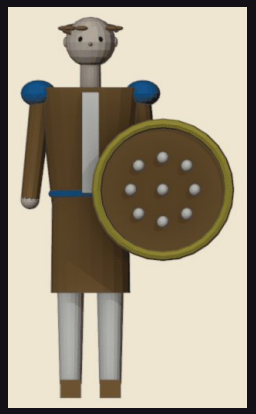

Ledger-priest


Basilica Auditor


Exchange Broker


Charm Bazaar local


Wards mechanic


Composite Knight


House dealer


Open Hand pilgrim

Collector



Rust
#B7410E

Gunmetal
#4A4E54

GROUP	Factions and jobs
ROLE	The Collectors · bailiff
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	40–60
HEIGHT	1.88 m

DESIGN

Rust armoured trench coat, peaked cap, a ledger chained to the belt, debt jars.

CANON LOCKS

- Never glowing numbers: Collectors wear steel

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

Ledger-priest



Steel white
#E8E6E1

Brass
#B5A642

GROUP	Factions and jobs
ROLE	The Basilica · clergy of the Dawn Tally
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	50
HEIGHT	1.80 m

DESIGN

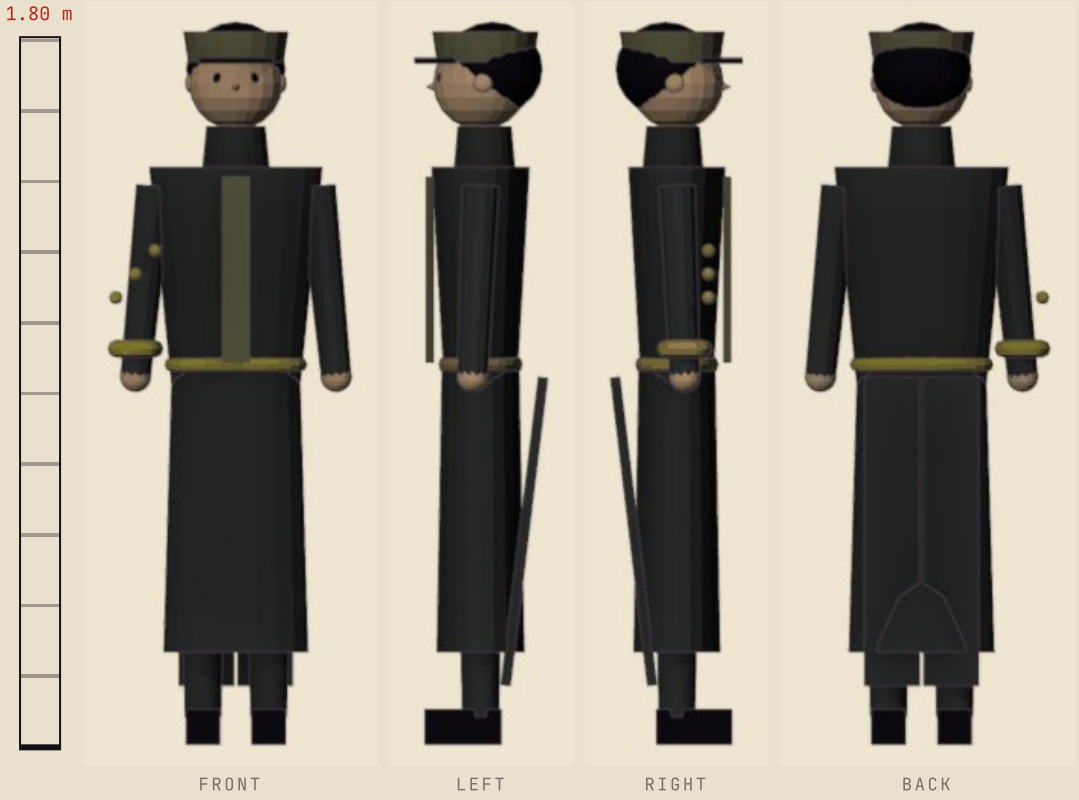
White-and-brass vestments, a tall gear-crested mitre, a chained ledger.

CANON LOCKS

- Steel numerals only

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

Basilica Auditor



Olive
#6E6B4E

Brass
#B5A642

Nixie
#FF7A2C

GROUP	Factions and jobs
ROLE	The Basilica · licensed Auditor
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	60–80
HEIGHT	1.80 m

DESIGN

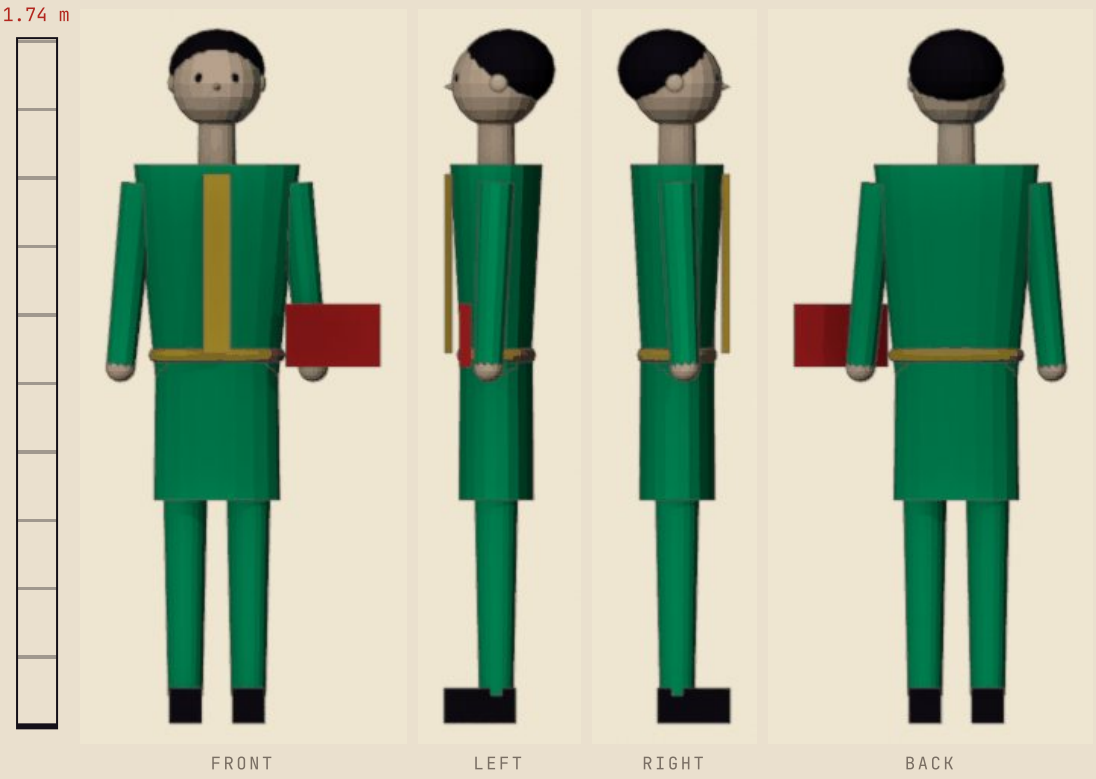
Dark field coat with a licensed brass wrist-wheel (a lawful decoder), olive cap. They summon Fate Wheels by law.

CANON LOCKS

- Licence number on the wrist-wheel

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

Exchange Broker



Jade
#00A86B

Gold
#D4AF37

GROUP	Factions and jobs
ROLE	The Luck Exchange · trader
LAND	River Empire
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	88
HEIGHT	1.74 m

DESIGN

Jade mandarin-collar suit, gold trim, a pocket abacus, an ear-clip price ticker.

CANON LOCKS

- Gold numerals: Gilded Fortune

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

FACTIONS AND JOBS

Charm Bazaar local



Magenta	#FF2E88
Sign yellow	#F5E400
Cyan	#00E5FF

GROUP	Factions and jobs
ROLE	Charm Bazaar guilds · street
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	17–77
HEIGHT	1.70 m

DESIGN

A puffer jacket hung with every culture's charms, a painted lucky number, a fake holo-halo.

CANON LOCKS

- Charmpunk: luck over sense

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

Wards mechanic



Ash
#8A7F72

Old brass
#C8963E

GROUP	Factions and jobs
ROLE	Remainder Wards · worker
LAND	Meridian
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	03–20
HEIGHT	1.76 m

DESIGN

Patched poncho, scrap-brass tools, a cracked Nixie tube on a cord instead of a glowing Omen.

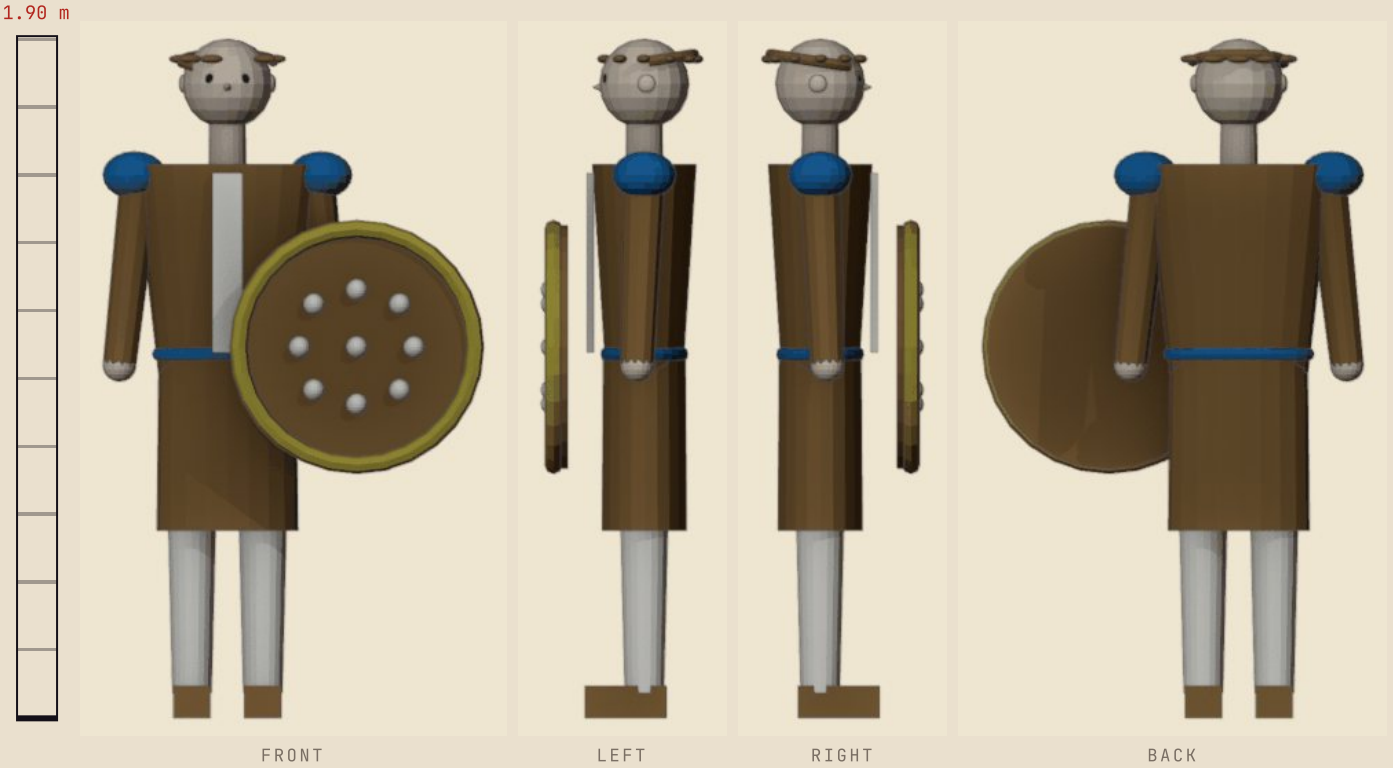
CANON LOCKS

- Remainder: survival over luck

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

FACTIONS AND JOBS

Composite Knight



Bronze
#8C6A3F

Chalk
#F4F1EA

Aegean
#1F6FB2

GROUP	Factions and jobs
ROLE	The Pythagorean Synod · guard
LAND	Kroton Nova
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	prime
HEIGHT	1.90 m

DESIGN

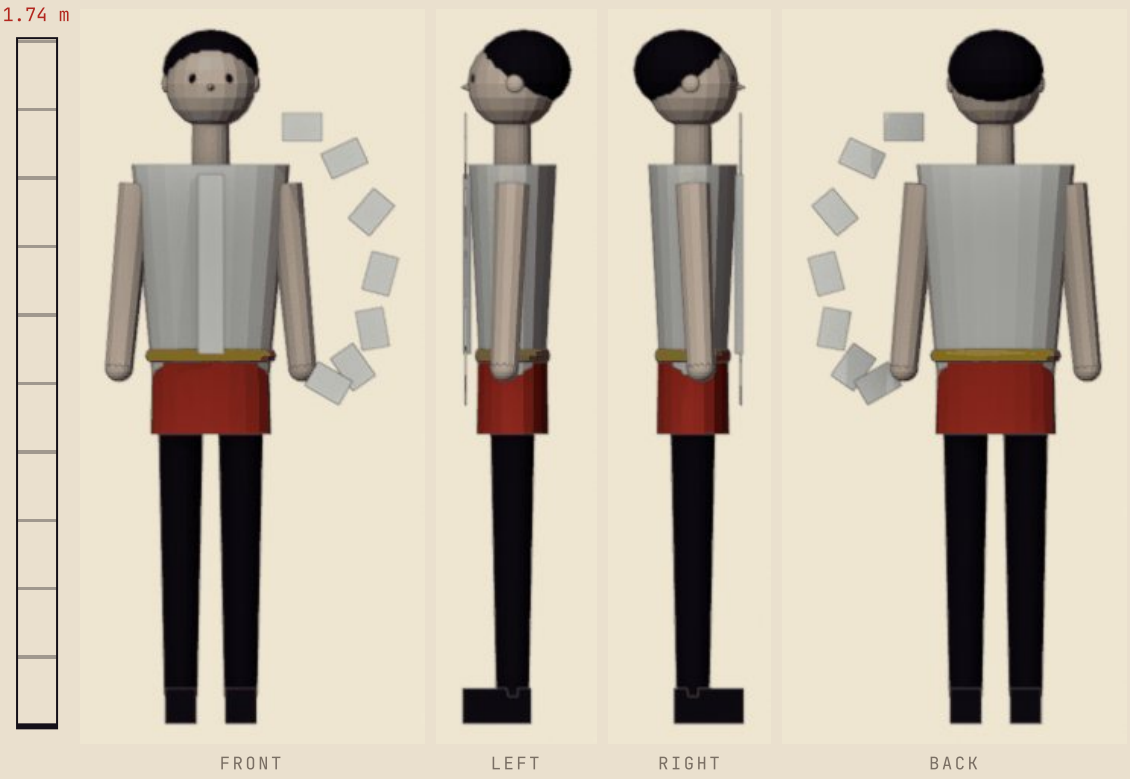
Bronze cuirass, chalk tunic, a round shield pierced like a sieve.

CANON LOCKS

- Shield glyph 4·6·8·9

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

House dealer



Casino red
#C0392B

Black
#141018

Gold
#D4AF37

GROUP	Factions and jobs
ROLE	The House · croupier
LAND	The Crossroads
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	21
HEIGHT	1.74 m

DESIGN

Red waistcoat, sleeve garters, a green-felt card tray.

CANON LOCKS

- Never counts money at the table

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

FACTIONS AND JOBS

Open Hand pilgrim



Road dust
#B9A58A

Open Hand gold
#D4AF37

GROUP	Factions and jobs
ROLE	The Open Hand · outlawed faith of Hap
LAND	Everywhere
LUCKY DIGIT	—
OMEN	any
HEIGHT	1.70 m

DESIGN

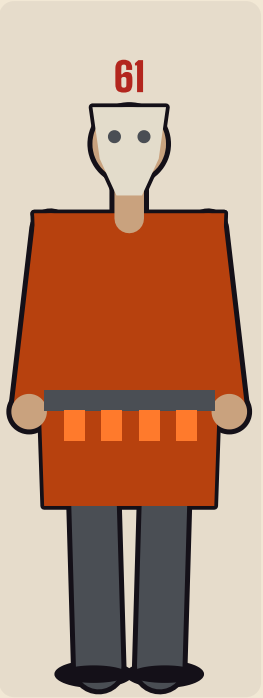
A travelling cloak, a carved open hand on a cord, a die worn smooth by thumbs.

CANON LOCKS

- The die is never weighted

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

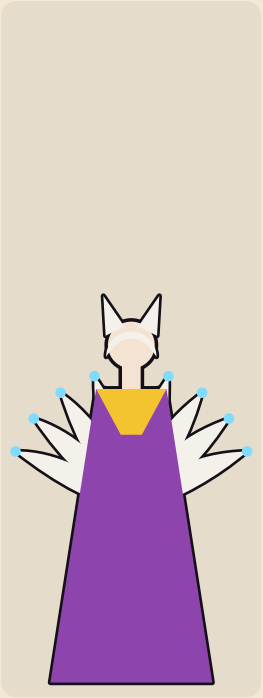
AUDITORS



Varro Kade

PROLOGUE BOSS → ALLY · MERIDIAN

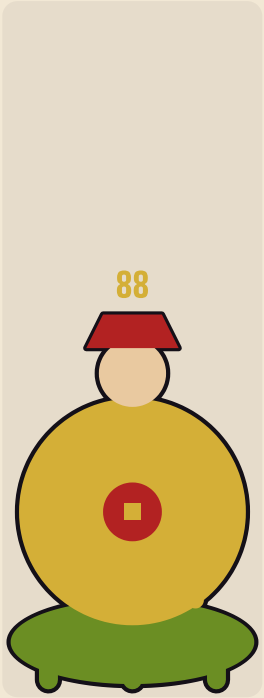
Steals your last reel digit into a debt jar; 3 parries shatter it



Tamamo

ACT I BOSS · HYAKKI

9 tails, each with its own small Balance; foxfire illusion faces on your wheels (show one digit, land as another); 9s curse you unless Hina is in the party



Chancellor Jin Chan

ACT II BOSS · RIVER EMPIRE

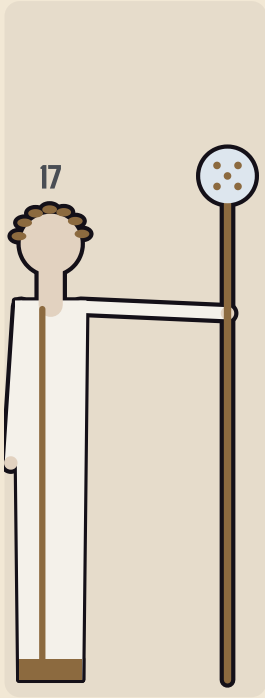
His Balance gains interest each round; taxes your Jackpots; phase 2 swallows a hero (land a Pair to free them)



Rahu & Ketu

ACT III BOSS · ŚŪNYAPURA

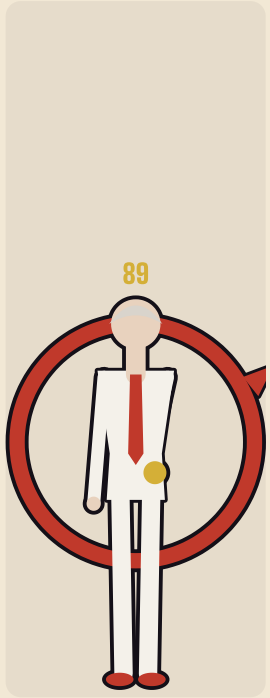
Two bodies: Rahu darkens one reel tube each round; Ketu strikes with a blind random wheel; if their Balances drift >10% apart they rejoin and heal



Archon Seventeen

ACT IV BOSS · KROTON NOVA

Strikes digits off your wheels each round (Sieve of Eratosthenes); composite strikes halved



The House

ACT V BOSS · CROSSROADS

Rewinds time every 3 rounds (your reel and charms persist); copies your last pattern; offers a mid-fight deal



Comptroller Lucan Thale

FINAL ANTAGONIST · MERIDIAN

P1 Regression to the Mean · P2 Fixed Fate (wheels don't spin: a puzzle) · P3 Zero (NIL alone; companions return as Link Arts)

Keepers, not villains. Enma (Hyakki) · Judge Cui (the Ten Courts) · Chitragupta (Śūnyapura) · the Moirai (Kroton Nova) · the Stranger (the Crossroads). Shown with reverence, never as monsters; they test the party and are never "defeated", only satisfied (World Bible §10).

FACTIONS & SYMBOLS



The Basilica

A brass gear around the Basilica's eye, which reads as a 0. Order, the Ledger, Fixed Fate.



The Collectors

A hound skull on a ledger seal. Debts and bounties.



Charm Bazaar guilds

A ring of mixed charms around a lucky 7. Folk luck, trade, survival.



The Yokai Courts

Nine foxfire flames around a violet heart. The spirits of Hyakki.



The Luck Exchange

The three-legged money toad with a coin. Luck as profit.



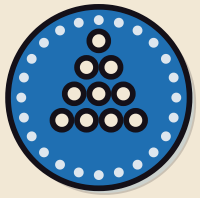
The Ten Courts

The Judge's brush over the river of the dead.



The Observatory

An astrolabe around a zero. Truth by measurement.



The Pythagorean Synod

The tetractys of ten dots inside a sieve ring. Purity of number.



The House

The ouroboros around 89. The night that never ends.

CHARMS OF THE WORLD



Beckoning Cat
HYAKKI
+1 fen per strike ending in your digit



Daruma
HYAKKI
When you land your digit three times in a fight, paint the second eye: ×2 Mult for the rest of the fight



Red Envelope
RIVER EMPIRE
+8 fen on a Jackpot



Door God
RIVER EMPIRE
Parries also deal the enemy's strike back



Lemon and Seven Chillies
ŚŪNYAPURA
Cancels one enemy curse per fight; +7 tens per 7 on the reel



108 Beads
ŚŪNYAPURA
Every 108th point of damage in a round counts double (rewards huge numbers)



Evil-Eye Bead
KROTON NOVA
The enemy's wheel shows its next digit faintly



Fortuna's Wheel
KROTON NOVA
Once per fight, spin the reel itself: all three digits re-roll



Horseshoe
CROSSROADS
Your digit's cells are 50% wider



Seven-Come-Eleven Dice
CROSSROADS
If a round's strikes total 7 or 11 (or 70/110/700…), ×7 Mult



Four-Leaf Clover
MERIDIAN (CELTIC)
1-in-4 chance per strike to duplicate its digit on the reel



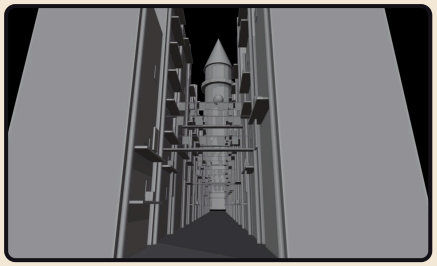
Black Cat
MERIDIAN
The first Bust each fight becomes a Pair

Rules quoted from GDD §3.1. Twelve of the ~90 planned; sets by land grant set bonuses.

PIPELINE · FROM BASE TO PAINTING

How every environment in this book is made (Art Book Production Guide §4): perspective and scale solved in 3D, colour decided on a flat key, then painted, then overpainted by hand.

REMAINDER WARDS



1 · 3D BASE (BLENDER)



1B · COLOUR KEY

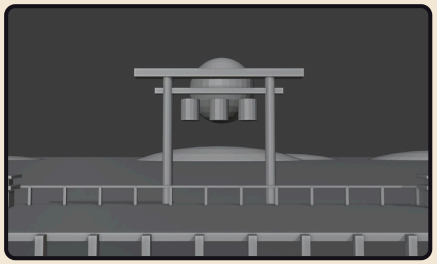
PENDING

2 · PAINT PASS (HIGGSFIELD / FLUX)

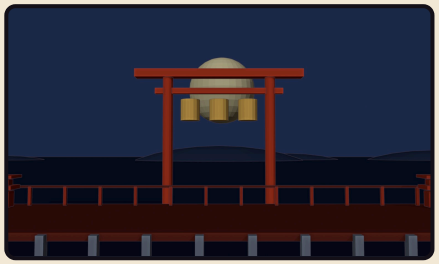
PENDING

3 · HUMAN OVERPAINT

MOON PIER



1 · 3D BASE (BLENDER)



1B · COLOUR KEY

PENDING

2 · PAINT PASS (HIGGSFIELD / FLUX)

PENDING

3 · HUMAN OVERPAINT

DRAFT v1.0

ART PENDING

v1.0 is complete as a design bible: every character and land exists as a first-draft 3D blockout at true scale with fixed specs. The register-A paintings fill in over these exact models and cameras, starting with these twelve (Art Book Production Guide §7). Rebuild: python3 tools/build_artbook.py (renders: tools/render_cast.py, tools/build_envs.py, tools/postprocess_renders.py).

1. Meridian Undercity environment painting (register A)
   `stand-in: colour key`
2. Remainder Wards line-up (6 locals)
   `stand-in: design figures + 3D base`
3. Four-eras comparison (4 figures)
   `stand-in: design figures`
4. NIL keyframe (action, graffiti overlay)
   `pass-1 placeholder`
5. NIL design sheet (front/side/back + callouts)
   `stand-in: design figure`
6. Vesper design sheet
   `stand-in: design figure`
7. Maeve design sheet
   `stand-in: design figure`
8. Hina design sheet
   `stand-in: design figure`
9. Hyakki Moon Pier environment painting
   `stand-in: colour key`
10. Hyakki yokai line-up (Night Parade)
    `pass-1 placeholder`
11. Varro keyframe
    `stand-in: design figure`
12. Tamamo keyframe
    `stand-in: design figure`